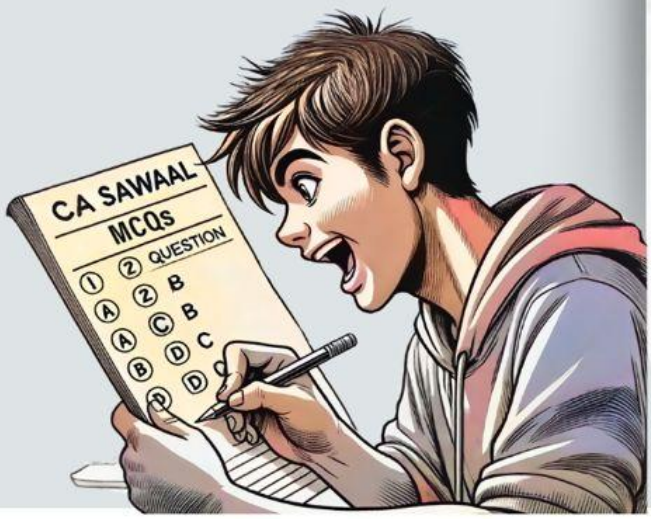
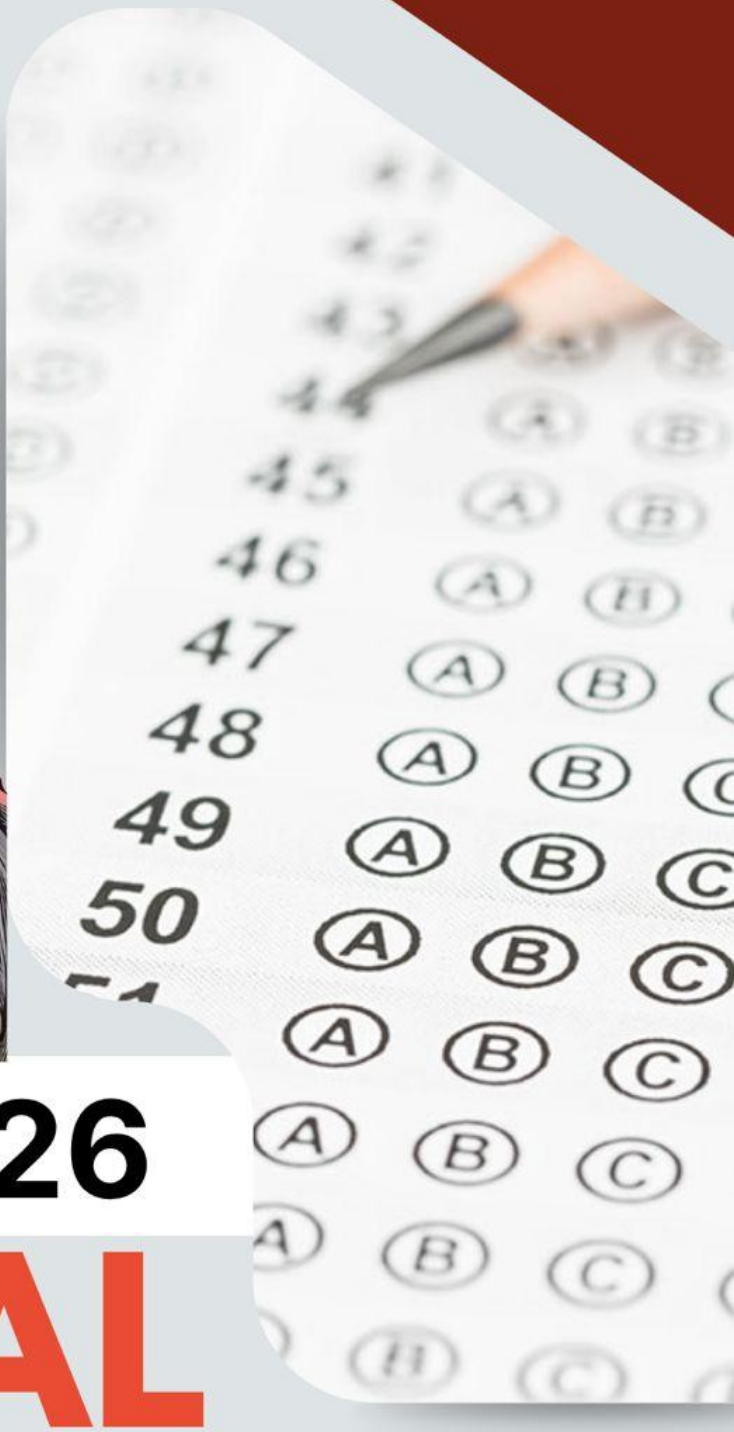
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Important Days

Q1. World Wide Web Day is observed annually on which date?
(a) 28 July
(b) 1 August
(c) 6 August
(d) 12 August
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: 1 August – World Wide Web Day**
- to commemorate the **invention of the World Wide Web by Tim Berners-Lee in 1989**
- By the end of 1990, **Berners-Lee** had successfully **developed the first web server and web browser at CERN**

Q2. World Breastfeeding Week is observed every year during:
(a) 1–7 July
(b) 1–7 August
(c) 7–14 August
(d) 1–10 September
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Since 1992** World Breastfeeding Week is celebrated every year in the **first week of August (1–7 August),** championed **by WHO, UNICEF**
- **THEME: Breastfeeding for a Sustainable Start in Life: Strengthen What Works**

Q3. CLOVES syndrome is best described as a:
(a) Viral infection
(b) Autoimmune disorder
(c) Rare genetic disorder
(d) Bacterial disease
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: 3 August - Cloves Syndrome Awareness Day**
- To spread awareness about the rare genetic disorder.
- It is a **rare genetic disorder** which causes enlargement of fatty tissues, vascular malformations, and other skin and **skeletal abnormalities.**

Q4. Consider the following statements regarding the atomic bombing of Hiroshima:
1. The atomic bomb dropped on Hiroshima was named Little Boy.
2. Hiroshima was bombed on 9 August 1945.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: 6 August** - Hiroshima Day commemorate **the anniversary of the atomic bombing of Hiroshima**, Japan, by the US during World War II on **August 6th, 1945.**
- In 1945, during World War II, the US dropped an atomic bomb called **"Little Boy,"** on Hiroshima **using the B-29 bomber Enola Gay.**

Q5. National Handloom Day commemorates which of the following historical events?
(a) Launch of the Quit India Movement
(b) Formation of the Indian National Congress
(c) Launch of the Swadeshi Movement
(d) Dandi March led by Mahatma Gandhi
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: 7 August - National Handloom Day**
- In a tribute to **Swadeshi Movement, which was launched on August 7, 1905,** at Town Hall, Kolkata
- **Government of India declared** August 7 as National Handloom Day **in 2015.**

Q6. National Javelin Day commemorates which historic sporting achievement?
(a) India's first Commonwealth Games gold in athletics
(b) Neeraj Chopra's Olympic gold medal in javelin throw at Tokyo 2020
(c) India's first Asian Games gold in athletics
(d) Launch of the Khelo India programme
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** National Javelin Day is celebrated annually in India on August 7.
- **It honors Neeraj Chopra and his historic gold medal win with a throw of 87.58 meters at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics on August 7, 2021**

Q7. The Quit India Movement was launched in which year?
(a) 1930
(b) 1940
(c) 1942
(d) 1947
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: 8 August – Quit India Movement Day**
- The Quit India Movement, **launched on August 8, 1942,** under Mahatma Gandhi's leadership, was a significant anti-colonial struggle.

Q8. What is the theme of the International Day of the World's Indigenous Peoples in 2026?
(a) Indigenous Peoples and Climate Action
(b) Protecting Indigenous Cultures and Heritage

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(c) Honouring Indigenous Midwives: Safeguarding Life and Well-being
(d) Indigenous Peoples for Sustainable Development
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: August 9 World Tribal Day**
- Also referred to as **World Indigenous Day or International Day of World's Indigenous People**
- Observed to support and protect the rights of the world's indigenous people.
- 2026 **Theme: "Honouring Indigenous Midwives: Safeguarding Life and Well-being"**

Q9. Which atomic bomb was dropped on Nagasaki in 1945?
(a) Little Boy
(b) Fat Man
(c) Trinity
(d) Gadget
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: 9 August Nagasaki Day**
- to commemorate the tragic atomic bombing of Nagasaki, Japan, by the United States during World War II in 1945
- **Bomb: "Fat Man" (plutonium-based)**
- Immediate deaths: Approx. 40,000; total by end of 1945: ~73,000

Q10. What is the IUCN Red List status of the Asiatic Lion?
(a) Endangered
(b) Critically Endangered
(c) Vulnerable
(d) Near Threatened
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: 10 August World Lion Day**
- Aims to raise awareness about the conservation and protection of lions worldwide.
- In Gujarat, the Asiatic are found only in the Saurashtra region.
- **IUCN Status: Vulnerable.**
- Listed in Schedule I and IV of Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972, in Appendix I of CITES.

Q11. Why is 10 August observed as World Biofuel Day?
(a) Launch of the Global Biofuels Alliance
(b) Rudolf Diesel's peanut-oil engine demonstration
(c) Adoption of the first global biofuel policy
(d) Development of the first commercial biodiesel
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: 10 August World Biofuel Day**
- To promote the use of biofuels as a sustainable alternative to fossil fuels.
- **On August 10, 1893, Sir Rudolf Diesel** successfully ran his engine using **peanut oil,** demonstrating for the first time that vegetable oil could power engines.

Q12. The theme of International Youth Day 2026 is:
(a) Youth for a Sustainable Future
(b) Youth and Digital Transformation
(c) Different Contexts, Common Aspirations
(d) Youth, Peace and Global Action
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: 12 August International Youth Day**
- **Theme 2026 - Different Contexts, Common Aspirations**
- In 1999 the UN General Assembly declared August 12 as International Youth Day

Q13. Which of the following correctly describes the conservation status of the Asian Elephant on the IUCN Red List?
(a) Vulnerable
(b) Endangered
(c) Critically Endangered
(d) Near Threatened
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** On **August 12, 2012,** the **inaugural World Elephant Day** was launched to bring attention to the urgent plight of Asian and African elephants.
- India is home to nearly 60% of the world's wild elephant population, with **33 Elephant Reserves and 150 identified Elephant Corridors**
- **Asian elephants** (Indian) are classified as **Endangered on the IUCN Red List**

Q14. When was 14 August officially declared as Partition Horrors Remembrance Day (Vibhajan Vibhishika Smriti Diwas) by the Government of India?
(a) 2019
(b) 2020
(c) 2021
(d) 2022
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Government declared 14th August as Partition Horrors Remembrance Day **(Vibhajan Vibhishika Smriti Diwas) in 2021**.
- 14th August is a day **to honor those who lost their lives** or **were displaced** during the partition.

Q15. What is the theme of the 2026 Independence Day celebrations?
(a) Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat
(b) Yuva Shakti for Viksit Bharat@2047
(c) Atmanirbhar Bharat@2047
(d) Nari Shakti for Viksit Bharat
Answer: (b)

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- **Explanation:** India celebrated its **80th Independence Day on August 15,** with a s**pecial focus on the 150th anniversary of 'Vande Mataram'** and the contribution of youth towards building a 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi led the celebrations at the historic Red Fort, **where he unfurled the National Flag and addressed the nation.**
- **For the first time, 'Vande Mataram' was sung from the ramparts of the Red Fort as the Prime Minister arrived at the venue.**

Q16. Which of the following is the theme of World Humanitarian Day 2026?

(a) Humanitarian Action in a Changing World
(b) Together for Humanity
(c) Honouring fallen humanitarians and calling for greater protection of health care
(d) Humanity at the Heart of Global Action

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: 19 August World Humanitarian Day**
- To honour humanitarian workers who risk their lives to help people in crises
- **Theme - "Honouring fallen humanitarians and calling for greater protection of health care.".**

Q17.The Nepali and Manipuri languages were included in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution through which Constitutional Amendment?

(a) 61st Amendment Act, 1989
(b) 71st Amendment Act, 1992
(c) 73rd Amendment Act, 1992
(d) 92nd Amendment Act, 2003

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The 35th Nepali Language Constitutional Recognition Day (Nepali Bhasha Manyata Diwas) was celebrated across India on August 20, 2026.
- The day marks the historic inclusion of the Nepali language in the Eighth Schedule of the Indian Constitution via the 71st Constitutional Amendment in 1992.

Q18. National Space Day is observed in India to commemorate which event?

(a) Launch of Aryabhata, India's first satellite
(b) Establishment of ISRO
(c) Successful soft landing of Chandrayaan-3's Vikram lander on the Moon
(d) Launch of India's first Mars mission

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: 23 August - National Space Day**
- India celebrated its **first National Space Day in 2024**
- Commemorates the **soft-landing** of **Vikram Lander** of **Chandrayaan-3** mission on the lunar surface on **August 23**, **2023** (The landing site was named as **'Shiv Shakti' point.**

Q19. What is the theme of World Lake Day 2026?

(a) Lakes for a Sustainable Future
(b) Protect Lakes, Protect Life
(c) Lakes: the Lifeblood of Our Planet
(d) Healthy Lakes, Healthy Planet

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation**: **27 August World Lake Day**
- **2026 Theme: Lakes: the lifeblood of our planet**
- **2025 is the first observance** of World Lake Day.

Q20. World Water Week 2026 was held from:

(a) 20–24 August
(b) 21–25 August
(c) 23–27 August
(d) 25–29 August

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** World Water Week 2026 took place from 23 to 27 August under the theme of **"Water for People and Progress", in Stockholm**
- Organized by the **Stockholm International Water Institute (SIWI).**

Q21. Sadbhavna Diwas is celebrated to commemorate the birth anniversary of:

(a) Jawaharlal Nehru
(b) Lal Bahadur Shastri
(c) Rajiv Gandhi
(d) Indira Gandhi

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: 20 August - Sadbhavna Diwas**
- This national observance commemorates the **birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi**, who was born on **August 20, 1944**, and served as the **sixth Prime Minister of India from 1984 to 1989.**

Q22. What is the theme of the International Day of Remembrance and Tribute to the Victims of Terrorism 2026?

(a) Healing Through Memory
(b) Preventing Terrorism Through Education
(c) Voices for Peace and Justice
(d) Building Resilience Against Terrorism

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: 21 August International Day of Remembrance and Tribute to the Victims of Terrorism**
- In 2017, the General Assembly, established the the day
- This year's theme: **Healing Through Memory**

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Q23. What was the theme of National Sports Day 2026?
(a) Khelega India, Badhega India
(b) Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat
(c) Fit India, Strong India
(d) Jeetega Bharat, Khelega Bharat
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: 29 August - National Sports Day**
- marks **hockey legend Major Dhyan Chand's birth anniversary**.
- The day has been nationally **recognised since 2012** and served as the launch platform for the Fit India Movement in 2019.
- **Celebration Theme 2026 - "Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat" (India Will Play, India Will Win).**

Q24. World Sanskrit Day is observed annually on which of the following days?
(a) **Shravana Amavasya**
(b) **Shravana Purnima**
(c) **Bhadrapada Purnima**
(d) **Ashadha Purnima**
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** World Sanskrit Day is observed on **Shravana Purnima** to celebrate Sanskrit and its extensive contribution to literature, philosophy, science, spirituality and India's broader intellectual heritage.
- In 2026 celebrated on **August 28**
- **Sanskrit Day is officially observed in India since 1969** when the Union Ministry of Education issued notifications for its celebration to the Central and State governments.

Books

Q1. Who is the author of the book Muslim Identity in Hindi Cinema: Poetics and Politics of Genre and Representation?
(a) Mohammad Asim Siddiqui
(b) Javed Akhtar
(c) Naseeruddin Shah
(d) Aamir Raza
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Muslim Identity in Hindi Cinema: Poetics and Politics of Genre and Representation by Mohammad Asim Siddiqui**
- **Published by Routledge**

Q2. Who is the author of the book China's Wars: The Politics and Diplomacy Behind Its Military Coercion?
(a) Vijay Gokhale
(b) Shyam Saran
(c) Nirupama Rao
(d) S. Jaishankar
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Book: China's Wars: The Politics and Diplomacy Behind Its Military Coercion
- Author: Former Indian Foreign Secretary Vijay Gokhale

Q3. The recently released book The Trees of My Country: A Natural History of India in 50 Trees has been illustrated by:
(a) B. G. Sharma
(b) Manali Patil
(c) Gurcharan Singh
(d) Anjali Mehta
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Book - The Trees of My Country: A Natural History of India in 50 Trees** by wildlife scientist T.R. Shankar Raman.
- illustrated by Manali Patil,
- The book explores in detail 50 native tree species across India

Q4. Game Changers: Lessons on Resilience and Success from Everyday Heroes has been published by:
(a) Penguin Random House India
(b) HarperCollins India
(c) Jaico Publishing House
(d) Rupa Publications
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Uday Shankar's new book, Game Changers: Lessons on Resilience and Success from Everyday Heroes,**
- Published by Jaico Publishing House

Q5. The autobiography "Triumph of the Indian Republic: My Life, My Struggles" is associated with which famous personality?
(a) Ram Nath Kovind
(b) Pranab Mukherjee
(c) A.P.J. Abdul Kalam
(d) Hamid Ansari
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi will release former **President Ram Nath Kovind's autobiography, "Triumph of the Indian Republic: My Life, My Struggles,"** at a function at Vigyan Bhavan in New Delhi
- The autobiography presents a personal account of **Kovind's life journey, tracing his experiences from his early years through his public life and tenure as the 14th President of India.**

Q6. Who authored the Hindi biography Janpriya Neta Venkaiah Naidu: Udayagiri Se Uparashtrapati Tak?
(a) Ram Nath Kovind
(b) Harivansh Narayan Singh
(c) M. Venkaiah Naidu

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(d) Y. Lakshmi Prasad

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** The Hindi biography of former Vice President M. Venkaiah Naidu, titled **"Janpriya Neta Venkaiah Naidu: Udayagiri Se Uparashtrapati Tak**" was officially released.
- It has been **written by former Rajya Sabha MP Y Lakshmi Prasad.**

Q7. Who are the authors of the book Regime Change: Inside the Imperial Presidency of Donald Trump?

(a) Bob Woodward and Carl Bernstein
(b) Maggie Haberman and Jonathan Swan
(c) David Remnick and Evan Osnos
(d) Michael Wolff and Ronan Farrow

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Book - **Regime Change: Inside the Imperial Presidency of Donald Trump**
- Written by : **Maggie Haberman and Jonathan Swan**

Q8. Belonging: A Journey of Love is the memoir of which prominent Indian political leader?

(a) **Sonia Gandhi**
(b) **Priyanka Gandhi Vadra**
(c) **Sushma Swaraj**
(d) **Meira Kumar**

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Sonia Gandhi's memoir **:Belonging: A Journey of Love.**
- Congress leaders claim the publisher caved in by demanding the removal of **sensitive passages critical of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the RSS, and Chinese intrusions into Indian territory**

Q9. Who is the author of the book Sankalp Se Siddhi Ka Modi Yug?

(a) Sudhanshu Mittal
(b) Ghanshyam Tiwari
(c) Shashi Tharoor
(d) Rajeev Chandrasekhar

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Vice President Shri CP Radhakrishnan released the book **' Sankalp Se Siddhi Ka Modi Yug'**
- written by Rajya Sabha **MP Shri Ghanshyam Tiwari at Upa-Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi**.

Appointments

Q1. Tewolde Gebremariam has been appointed as the Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director of which airline?

(a) IndiGo
(b) Air India
(c) SpiceJet
(d) Akasa Air

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Air India appointed Tewolde Gebremariam as its Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director on 5 August 2026.
- He will succeed Campbell Wilson, whose resignation took effect in April 2026 and whose departure is scheduled for 30 September 2026.

Q2. Govind Mohan, whose tenure has been extended, currently serves as the:

(a) Finance Secretary
(b) Culture Secretary
(c) Defence Secretary
(d) Union Home Secretary

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: Cabinet Secretary T.V. Somanathan and Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan's tenures have been extended for another year,**
- **Mr. Mohan, a 1989 batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer from the Sikkim cadre,** was appointed Home Secretary in 2024 and assumed office on August 23, 2024.

Q3. Who has been appointed as the next Director General Armed Forces Medical Services (DGAFMS)?

(a) Surgeon Vice Admiral Arti Sarin
(b) Air Marshal Sandeep Thareja
(c) Air Marshal Rajesh Anand
(d) Lieutenant General Daljit Singh

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Government has appointed **Air Marshal Sandeep Thareja,** SM, VSM & Bar, presently serving as the **Director General Medical Services (Air), as the Director General Armed Forces Medical Services (DGAFMS).**
- He **will assume the appointment upon the retirement** of the incumbent DGAFMS **Surgeon Vice Admiral Arti Sarin,** PVSM, AVSM, VSM on August 31, 2026.

Q4. Varsha Ashok Aglawe has recently been appointed as the Director General of which of the following organisations?

(a) Indian Bureau of Mines (IBM)
(b) Geological Survey of India (GSI)
(c) National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC)
(d) Central Ground Water Board (CGWB)

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Varsha Ashok Aglawe has become the **54th Director General of the Geological Survey of India (GSI),** becoming the **first woman to lead the organisation in its 176-year history.**

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- **Succeeds Asit Saha,** who served as the GSI director general for two years.

Q5. Recently, Vishwesh Negi was appointed as India's next Ambassador to which of the following countries?

(a) Iraq
(b) Iran
(c) Israel
(d) Oman

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** India has appointed senior diplomat Vishwesh Negi as its **next Ambassador to the Islamic Republic of Iran.**
- Negi, a **2002-batch Indian Foreign Service (IFS) officer,** is currently serving as a Joint Secretary in the MEA.

Q6. Who has been appointed as the Executive Director (ED) of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) ?

(a) Swaminathan J.
(b) Monisha Chakraborty
(c) M. Rajeshwar Rao
(d) T. Rabi Sankar

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has appointed **Monisha Chakraborty as Executive Director (ED),** with effect from August 3, 2026.
- Prior to being promoted as ED, Monisha Chakraborty **was serving as Chief General Manager -in- Charge in Department of Supervision.**

Q7. Who has recently assumed charge as the Director General Naval Operations (DGNO) of the Indian Navy?

(a) Vice Admiral Rajesh Pendharkar
(b) Vice Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi
(c) Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan
(d) Vice Admiral Manish Chadha

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: Vice Admiral Manish Chadha**, AVSM, VSM**, assumed charge as the Director General Naval Operations (DGNO)**
- **He was commissioned on 1 July 1991**

Q8. Willie Walsh, recently seen in the news, has been appointed as the:

(a) Chairman of Air India
(b) Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of IndiGo
(c) Director General of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)
(d) Chairman of Airports Authority of India

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Willie Walsh has assumed charge as IndiGo's new Chief Executive Officer (CEO),** following the sudden departure of Pieter Elbers
- The airline's promoter and managing director, Rahul Bhatia, had taken interim charge of the company's management.

Q9. Who is the current Director of the Enforcement Directorate (ED) whose tenure has been extended by one year up to August 13, 2027?

(a) Rahul Navin
(b) Sanjay Kumar Mishra
(c) Tushar Mehta
(d) Praveen Sood

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The tenure of **Enforcement Directorate (ED) Director Rahul Navin has been extended by a year beyond August 13.**
- **A 1993-batch Indian Revenue Service officer of the Income Tax cadre,** 59-year-old Navin has been leading the federal anti-money laundering agency as its full-time chief since August 14, 2024.

Q10. Justice Abha Nayar Patel recently became the first woman judge of Indian origin on which country's Supreme Court?

(a) Zambia
(b) Zimbabwe
(c) Uganda
(d) Kenya

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Justice Abha Nayar Patel**, the first woman judge of Indian origin on the Zambia Supreme Court,
- Moved from Delhi as a seven-year-old has said that India continues to hold a special place in her heart even after decades abroad.

Q11. Abelardo de la Espriella was sworn in as the 36th President of which country for the 2026–2030 term?

(a) Ecuador
(b) Colombia
(c) Venezuela
(d) Peru

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Abelardo de la Espriella was sworn in on 7 August 2026 as the 36th President of Colombia for the 2026–2030 term.
- He succeeded Gustavo Petro,
- Capital: Bogotá

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Q12. Who has been appointed as the representative of Iran's Supreme Leader to the Supreme National Security Council (SNSC)?
(a) Mohammad Baqir Zolghadr
(b) Ali Larijani
(c) Mohsen Rezaee
(d) Ali Shamkhani
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei has appointed former Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) chief Mohsen Rezaee as his **representative to the country's Supreme National Security Council (SNSC),** replacing Mohammad Baqir Zolghadr.
- The position was formerly held by Ali Larijani, who was assassinated in US-Israeli strikes in March, and then Mohammad Baqir Zolghadr.

Q13. Who has been appointed as the new Higher Education Secretary?
(a) Deepti Gaur Mukherjee
(b) K. Sanjay Murthy
(c) Anil Kumar
(d) Sanjay Kumar
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Centre appointed corporate affairs secretary Deepti Gaur Mukherjee, a 1993-batch Madhya Pradesh cadre Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer, as the higher education secretary.
- Mukherjee replaces Naresh Pal Gangwar.

Q14. Who has been elected as the next President of Hungary?
(a) Viktor Orbán
(b) András Baka
(c) János Áder
(d) Katalin Novák
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Hungary's parliament elected former Supreme Court chief **Andras Baka as the country's next President.**
- **Hungary, landlocked country of central Europe.**

Q15. V. Gopikrishna became the first Indian to head which international organisation?
(a) International Association for Dental Research
(b) World Dental Federation
(c) International Federation of Endodontic Associations
(d) International Society of Oral Surgery
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** A Chennai-based endodontist **V. Gopikrishna has reportedly become the first Indian** to head the **International Federation of Endodontic Associations (IFEA).**

Q16. Who was elected as the new president of the Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA)?
(a) Vikas Singh
(b) Rahul Kaushik
(c) Reepak Kansal
(d) Pradeep Rai
Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: Senior advocate Pradeep Rai** was elected as the new president of the **Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA).**
- Senior advocate Rahul Kaushik and advocate Pragya Baghel retained their posts as vice president and secretary .

Q17. Who became the first Sikh to graduate as a fighter pilot in Britain's Royal Air Force (RAF)?
(a) Arshdeep Singh Dang
(b) Jaspreet Singh Sandhu
(c) Harpreet Singh Gill
(d) Gurkirat Singh
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Indian-origin Flight Lieutenant Arshdeep Singh Dang, 28**, has become the **first Sikh to graduate as a fighter pilot in Britain's Royal Air Force** (RAF).
- He is the **first Sikh to attain wings from a Fighter Squadron of the RAF since World War II.**

Q18. Who has been sworn in as the new Chairman of the Maharashtra Lokayukta Institution?
(a) Justice Abhay S. Oka
(b) Justice Sunil Balkrishna Shukre
(c) Justice B. P. Dharmadhikari
(d) Justice Ranjit More
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Justice Sunil Balkrishna Shukre, former Judge of the Bombay High Court, was sworn in as **the new Chairman of the Maharashtra Lokayukta Institution**

Q19. Who was recently appointed as a part-time, non-official director on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)?
(a) S. Somanath
(b) Shaktikanta Das
(c) N. Chandrasekaran
(d) Sanjiv Bajaj
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Former Indian Space Research Organisation Chairman **S. Somanath was appointed as a part-time, non-official director on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India.**
- His appointment took effect **for a four-year term.**

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Q20. Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir, recently in the news, was elected as the 23rd President of which country?

(a) Nepal
(b) Myanmar
(c) Bhutan
(d) Bangladesh

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Veteran Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) leader **Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir was elected as the country's 23rd President.**
- It was the country's first contested presidential election since 1991.

Awards

Q1. Consider the following statements regarding the Jeevan Raksha Padak series:

1. The Jeevan Raksha Padak awards are open only to civilians.
2. The awards may be conferred for life-saving acts during drowning, fire accidents, electrocution, natural calamities, animal attacks, and mine rescue operations.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Union Minister of Road Transport and Highway conferred the Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak on 12 rat miners in recognition of their exceptional courage and selfless service during the Silkyara Tunnel Rescue Operation.
- It is conferred on individuals who undertake life-saving efforts during incidents such as drowning, fire accidents, electrocution, natural calamities including landslides, animal attacks, and rescue operations in mines.

Eligibility for Jeevan Raksha Padak

- The awards are open to individuals from all walks of life.
- Members of the Armed Forces, Police Forces and recognised Fire Services are also eligible, provided the **act of bravery is performed beyond the call of normal duty.**
- It is presented to the awardees by the respective Union Ministries/Organizations/State Government to which the awardee belongs.

Q2. Pechiyammal and Govindhammal received the Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award for Environment Protection 2026 for their contributions to _____ and _____, respectively.

(a) Marine Conservation & Ocean Plastic Management; Sustainable & Climate-Resilient Agriculture
(b) Biodiversity Conservation; Water Resource Management
(c) Wetland Restoration; Forest & Wildlife Conservation
(d) Air Pollution Control; Renewable Energy Promotion

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award for Environment Protection 2026**
- Two women changemakers**—P. Pechiyammal and Govindhammal were honored with the Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award** for Environment Protection 2026 at an event in Chennai.

Contributions:

Pechiyammal (Ramanathapuram, Tamil Nadu)

- Field: Marine Conservation & Ocean Plastic Management

Govindhammal (Villupuram, Tamil Nadu)

- Field: Sustainable & Climate-Resilient Agriculture

Q3. Recently, Professor Karthikeyan Lanka has been selected for the NASI Young Scientist Award 2026. He is associated with which institution?

(a) IIT Delhi
(b) IIT Madras
(c) IIT Bombay
(d) IISc Bengaluru

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Professor **Karthikeyan Lanka** of the Indian Institute of Technology Bombay has been selected for the **NASI Young Scientist Award 2026.**
- He is an Associate Professor at the Centre of Studies in Resources Engineering and an associate faculty member in the Interdisciplinary Programme in Climate Studies at IIT Bombay.

Q4. Ram Meher, recipient of the Sant Kabir Handloom Award 2025, is associated with which of the following handloom products?

(a) Muga Silk Saree
(b) Bichitpar Khadi Saree
(c) Banarasi Brocade
(d) Pochampally Ikat Saree

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** President Droupadi Murmu will present the prestigious Handloom Awards 2025 during the National Handloom Day celebrations on August 7.
- This year, **22 awardees will be honoured, including three recipients of the Sant Kabir Handloom Award and 19 recipients of the National Handloom Award,**

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- for their **exceptional work in preserving traditional craftsmanship** while advancing innovation, design development, marketing, entrepreneurship and the overall growth of the handloom sector.

The Sant Kabir Handloom Award

Sl. No.	State	Category	Sub-Category	Applicant Name	Name of the Craft/Product
1	Odisha	Weaving	Weaving	Ram Meher	Bichitpar Khadi Saree
2	Assam	Weaving	Women	Runima Chetiya Choudhury	Muga Silk Saree
3	Uttar Pradesh	Weaving	Languishing Weaves	Shah Muhammad Ansari	Zarbaft Shewatambari Awadh Jamdhani Saree

Q5. Which one of the following correctly describes the distinction achieved by Annapurni Subramaniam?

(a) First Indian scientist to receive the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal

(b) First Indian woman scientist and fourth Indian overall to receive the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal

(c) First Asian woman to receive the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal

(d) Youngest recipient of the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, astrophysicist **Annapurni Subramaniam has been awarded the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal – 2026.**
- She is the director of Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA), Bengaluru, and holds the additional charge as director of the Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences (CeNS).
- **Annapurni Subramaniam is the only fourth Indian to receive this medal, in addition to being the first Indian woman scientist and only the third female recipient of this honour.**

Q6. Consider the following statements regarding the Fields Medal:

1. It is awarded every year by the International Mathematical Union.
2. All awardees must be below 50 years of age at the time of the award.
3. Hong Wang is only the third woman to receive the Fields Medal.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) Only 1

(b) Only 3

(c) Only 2 and 3

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The 2026 Fields Medal—mathematics' highest honor—was awarded to **Yu Deng, John Pardon, Jacob Tsimerman, and Hong Wang at the International Congress of Mathematicians.**
- Hong Wang made history as only the third woman in the medal's 90-year history to receive the honor, while she and Yu Deng became the first Chinese nationals awarded since 1982.
- **Candidates must be younger than 40 years old on January 1st of the award year,** celebrating early-career breakthroughs and future potential.
- **Funded through the J.C. Fields Trust at the University of Toronto,** supplemented by institutional partners and the Fields Institute.

Q7. Nathan Thomas, recently recognised by the Guinness World Records as the world's youngest male professor, achieved the feat at the age of:

(a) 18 years and 346 days

(b) 18 years and 362 days

(c) 19 years and 16 days

(d) 19 years and 346 days

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: At just 18 years and 346 days old, Nathan Thomas has become the world's youngest male professor** after landing a teaching position.
- Thomas, a Florida, US, resident, also shattered a Guinness World Records milestone that had remained unbroken for more than 300 years.
- **Thomas bagged a teaching role at Miami Dade College in August 2023** and began instructing students in the course COP 2270: C For Engineers.

Q8. Harry Kane is set to receive the prestigious 'Golden Shoe' honour for becoming the top scorer in which competition?

(a) UEFA Champions League

(b) Premier League

(c) European football leagues

(d) FIFA Club World Cup

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Harry Kane** is set to receive the prestigious **'Golden Shoe' honour for emerging as top scorer in European football for the 2025-26 season.**
- this is the **second time Harry is going to receive the prestigious honour,** joining the elite list of players having won it twice, **with only legends Lionel Messi and Cristiano Ronaldo having won it more.**

Q9. Which of the following Indian physicists was among the four recipients of the 2026 ICTP Dirac Medal?

(a) Deepak Dhar

(b) Ashoke Sen

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(c) S. N. Bose
(d) K. S. Krishnan
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Theoretical physicist Deepak** Dhar has been awarded the 2026 Dirac Medal by the International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) for his contributions to statistical mechanics and complex systems.
- **The ICTP Dirac Medal was first awarded in 1985 in memory of British physicist P.A.M. Dirac**, one of the leading physicists of the 20th century.
- The award recognises scientists who have made major contributions to theoretical physics.
- **Previous recipients include renowned physicists such as Stephen Hawking.**
- The other recipients are **Bernard Derrida**, Honorary Professor at the College de France; **Marc Mezard,** Professor of Theoretical Physics at Bocconi University; and **Haim Sompolinsky,** Professor of Neuroscience and Physics at the Hebrew University of Jerusalem and Visiting Professor at Harvard University.

Q10. Who became the first Indian to receive the Lifetime Libertarian Award?
(a) Ramachandra Guha
(b) Gurcharan Das
(c) Shashi Tharoor
(d) N. S. Madhavan
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Gurcharan Das, the author and public intellectual, has become **the first Indian to receive the Lifetime Libertarian Award,** handed to him at the 40th Liberty International World Conference in Kathmandu.
- The citation recognised his **"lasting contribution to the advancement of liberty,"** a theme that has run through his writing for over three decades, spanning freedom, entrepreneurship, and individual responsibility.

Q11. Consider the following statements regarding the National Gopal Ratna Award:
1. It was established in 2021 under the Rashtriya Gokul Mission.
2. A special award is provided for the North Eastern Region and Himalayan States.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation**: Recently, the **department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying under the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry** has invited nominations for the National Gopal Ratna Award 2026.
- NGRA are the **country's highest honours in the livestock and dairy sector.**
- It was **established under the Rashtriya Gokul Mission in 2021.**
- The **"Rashtriya Gokul Mission (RGM)", was launched in December 2014,** with a view to conserve and develop **indigenous bovine breeds in a scientific manner.**
- There is also a provision of **Special award for the North Eastern Region (NER) and Himalayan States so as to encourage and boost the dairy development activities in these States/UTs.**

Q12. Which of the following correctly represents the gallantry awards approved in 2026?
(a) 9 Kirti Chakras, 19 Shaurya Chakras and 36 Sena Medals
(b) 9 Kirti Chakras, 19 Shaurya Chakras and 26 Sena Medals
(c) 7 Kirti Chakras, 19 Shaurya Chakras and 36 Sena Medals
(d) 9 Kirti Chakras, 29 Shaurya Chakras and 36 Sena Medals
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** President Droupadi Murmu on August 14 approved 78 gallantry awards, including 13 awarded posthumously, for personnel from the Defence Forces and Central Armed Police Forces.
- The awards include **nine Kirti Chakras**, of which **seven are posthumous; one Bar (conferred second time) to the Shaurya Chakra; and 19 Shaurya Chakras, including one posthumous**
- The awards include **five Bars to the Sena Medals (Gallantry);** 36 Sena Medals (Gallantry), five of them posthumous; three Nau Sena Medals (Gallantry), and five Vayu Sena Medals (Gallantry).

Q13. Consider the following statements regarding the Medal for Gallantry (GM):
1. The Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM) is awarded for valuable service characterised by resource and devotion to duty.
2. The President's Medal for Distinguished Service (PSM) and Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM) are classified as Gallantry Medals.
3. Police Service received the highest number of MSM.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3
Answer: (b)

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- **Explanation:** Medal for Gallantry (GM) is awarded **on the ground of Conspicuous act of Gallantry in saving life and property**, or in **preventing crime or arresting criminals**, the risk incurred being estimated with due regard to the obligations and duties of the officer concerned.
- President's Medal for Distinguished Service (PSM) is awarded for **special distinguished record in Service and Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM)** is awarded for valuable service characterized by resource and devotion to duty.
- **Chhattisgarh Police received 141 Gallantry Medals, which was the highest among state police forces.**

Q14. Which Union Ministry hosted the ceremony for the Gaj Gaurav Awards 2026?

(a) Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
(b) Ministry of Rural Development
(c) Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change
(d) Ministry of Science and Technology

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The Gaj Gaurav Awards 2026 were conferred **during the national celebrations of World Elephant Day in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh.**
- The ceremony was **hosted by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change** and recognised frontline contributions to elephant conservation and management in India.

Q15. Consider the following statements about the Sangeet Natak Akademi:

1. It was established in 1952.
2. Akademi Fellowship carries ₹3 lakh, while Akademi Award carries ₹1 lakh.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** President Droupadi Murmu will confer the Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowships (Akademi Ratna) and Awards (Akademi Puraskar) for **2024 and 2025 on 115 artists** at a special investiture ceremony at **Vigyan Bhawan in New Delhi.**
- It was **set up by the Indian education ministry in 1952** and became functional the following year, with the **appointment of its first chairman, Dr. P. V. Rajamannar.**
- The honour of **Akademi Fellow carries a purse money of Rs. 3,00,000/- (Rupees three lakh only) while the Akademi Award carries a purse money of Rs. 1,00,000/- (Rupees one lakh only),** besides a Tamrapatra and Angavastram.

Q16. Who was conferred the UT Ladakh State Award 2025 for his contribution to the preservation, promotion and development of Sowa-Rigpa in Ladakh?

(a) Dr. Padma Gurmet
(b) Dr. Tashi Norbu
(c) Dr. Sonam Dorje
(d) Dr. Tsewang Angchuk

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Dr. Padma Gurmet, Director, National Institute of Sowa-Rigpa, Leh**, has been conferred the UT Ladakh State Award for the year 2025 in recognition of his contribution to the **preservation, promotion and development of the Sowa-Rigpa system** of medicine in Ladakh.
- The award was conferred by the Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh, Vinai Kumar Saxena, during the UT State Awards ceremony,

Q17. Consider the following statements regarding the National Anubhav Awards 2026:

1. It is open to retiring or retired employees of Central Government Ministries/Departments.
2. Only write-ups submitted during the current financial year are evaluated.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Union Minister of State for Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, Dr. Jitendra Singh, will confer the National Anubhav Awards 2026 at the 9th National Anubhav Awards Ceremony held at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.

Eligibility Criteria:

- **Retiring/retired employees of Central Government Ministries/Departments, Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs), and 12 Public Sector Banks (PSBs).**
- Open to employees **who are retiring within the next 8 months or pensioners who have retired within the past 3 years.**
- All write-ups published on the Anubhav Portal within the preceding financial year are evaluated.

Q18. What Guinness World Record was achieved by three UAE-based Indian skydivers over Benghazi, Libya?

(a) Most skydivers jumping simultaneously with national flags from a single aircraft
(b) Most skydivers jumping simultaneously from multiple aircraft
(c) Largest skydiving formation in the world

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(d) Highest-altitude group skydive

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Three UAE-based Indian skydivers participated in a Guinness World Record skydive over **Benghazi, Libya**, on **7 August 2026**.
- **Aircraft:** All skydivers exited a single **Ilyushin Il-76TD military aircraft**.
- **Altitude:** The jump was conducted from **13,000 feet**.
- **Record:** The team set a **new global record for the most skydivers simultaneously jumping with national flags from a single aircraft**.

Q19. Match the Following: Indian Football Awards 2026

Match List-I with List-II:

Codes:

List-I: Award	List-II: Winner
1. Indian Player of the Year	A. Owen Coyle
2. Indian Women's Player of the Year	B. Manisha Kalyan
3. Young Player of the Year	C. Lallianzuala Chhangte
4. Coach of the Year	D. Sanan Mohammed K

(a) 1-C, 2-B, 3-D, 4-A

(b) 1-B, 2-C, 3-A, 4-D

(c) 1-D, 2-A, 3-C, 4-B

(d) 1-A, 2-D, 3-B, 4-C

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** India midfielder and Mohun Bagan player Lallianzuala Chhangte was named **Indian Player of the Year** at the **Football Players' Association of India's Indian Football Awards 2026,** while **Manisha Kalyan took home the Indian Women's Player of the Year honour.**
- **Organised by the Football Players Association of India,** the award is decided through votes from fellow players.
- **Indian Player of the Year**: Lallianzuala Chhangte
- **Indian Women's Player of the Year:** Manisha Kalyan
- **Young Player of the Year**: Sanan Mohammed K
- **Coach of the Year**: Owen Coyle

Q20. Who among the following was recently conferred Ukraine's 'Order of Freedom', one of the country's highest state honours?

(a) Jeff Bezos

(b) Elon Musk

(c) Sundar Pichai

(d) Mark Zuckerberg

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy awarded Elon Musk the **Order of Freedom, one of Ukraine's highest state honours, for his "outstanding personal merits" in protecting human life and freedom** and strengthening ties between Ukraine and the United States.
- The award recognises Musk's role in Ukraine's war effort through **Starlink, SpaceX's satellite internet network, which has become a crucial communications lifeline for both the military and civilians** since Russia's full-scale invasion in 2022.

Q21. The book The Tsar in Propria Persona: How Vladimir Putin Deceived Us All, which won the Prix Strasbourg, was authored by:

(a) Roman Badanin and Mikhail Rubin

(b) Garry Kasparov and Boris Akunin

(c) Mikhail Gorbachev and Roman Badanin

(d) Alexei Navalny and Mikhail Rubin

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The newly established **French literary award, the Prix Strasbourg**, has been won by a book about Russian President Vladimir Putin titled **The Tsar in Propria Persona: How Vladimir Putin Deceived Us All.**
- Authored by - **Russian investigative journalists Roman Badanin and Mikhail Rubin,**
- The prize, awarded **by EBRA, France's largest regional newspaper group**

Q22. Consider the following statements regarding the National Sports Awards 2025:

1. No sportsperson was selected for the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award in 2025.

2. Dharmendra Singh Yadav received the Dronacharya Award (Lifetime) in Boxing.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports announced the National Sports Awards 2025, **with 17 sportspersons given the Arjuna Award and one receiving the lifetime honour.**
- **The Sports Ministry, however, did not name any athlete for the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award this year.**
- The awards were announced based on the **recommendations of a selection committee** chaired by the former **Supreme Court judge Justice (Retd.) Arun Kumar Mishra.**

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Dronacharya Award for outstanding coaches in Sports and Games 2025

Regular Category:

S. No.	Name of the Coach	Discipline
1.	Shri Parveer Singh	Athletics
2.	Shri Chhote Lal Yadav	Boxing
3.	Ms Neha Nandkumar Chavan	Shooting

Lifetime Category:

S. No.	Name of the Coach	Discipline
1.	Shri. Dharmendra Singh Yadav	Boxing
2.	Shri. Virender Kumar	Wrestling

Q23. Who was crowned Miss Universe India 2026?

(a) Anushri Satavlekar
(b) Vaishnavi Gannesh
(c) Manushi Chhillar
(d) Kaziah Liz Mejo

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: Kaziah Liz Mejo of Kerala** has been crowned **Miss Universe India 2026,** emerging from 53 contestants at the prestigious pageant finale held in Jaipur .

Q24. Consider the following statements regarding the National Teachers' Awards 2026:

1. **48 teachers** have been selected.
2. The awardees include **26 male and 22 female teachers**.
3. The awards were **instituted in 1958**.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** National Teachers' Awards 2026 will be conferred **by President Droupadi Murmu on 5 September 2026 (Teachers' Day) at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.**
- 5 September is observed as **Teachers' Day in India (Dr Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan was born on 5 September 1888.)**
- This year, **48 outstanding school teachers from across India have been selected for their exceptional contribution to education,** innovation in teaching, and positive impact on students' lives.
- Of the 48 awardees, 26 are male and 22 are female teachers
- Each award carries a certificate of merit, a **cash award of Rs. 50,000** and a silver medal.
- **The award was instituted in 1958** and is presented every year on Teachers' Day (5 September) to celebrate the contribution of teachers towards nation-building.

Q25. Ashutosh Parida has been selected for the 2026 Sarala Puraskar for which of the following works?

(a) Bishwas De Pruthwi
(b) Pruthwi O Prakriti
(c) Nila Akashara Tale
(d) Samayara Swara

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Noted Odia poet, essayist and fomer scientist at CSIR-IMMT **Ashutosh Parida** has been selected for the **prestigious Sarala Puraskar for his poetry collection 'Bishwas De Pruthwi'.**
- The award, **given annually by the Indian Metals Public Charitable Trust (IMPaCT)** for the best literary achievement
- His poetry collection 'Bishwas De Pruthwi', **published by Prabha Publication** in year 2024.
- the writer will be presented with a citation, **copper plaque and award amount of ₹7 lakh**

Q26. Which publication was recognised in the 'General and Trade Books – English' category at the FIP Awards for Excellence in Book Production 2026?

(a) Bharat 2026
(b) Dharti Ki Sehat
(c) Wings to Our Hopes – Volume 2
(d) Rangoli Roop Sur Lay Ki

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: The Publications Division of the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting** has won **seven awards at the Federation of Indian Publishers (FIP) Awards** for Excellence in Book Production 2026, recognising its editorial and publishing work **across Hindi, English and Urdu.**
- The Division secured **four second prizes** and **three third prizes in various categories** covering reference books, general and trade books, journals, children's publications and art and coffee-table books.
- Among the publications receiving second prizes, **'Bharat 2026'** won in the Reference Books – Hindi category, while '**Wings to Our Hopes – Volume 2**' was recognised in the General and Trade Books – English category.

Q27. Which organisation has been selected for the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Award-2026?

(a) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
(b) M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation
(c) Indian Council of Agricultural Research
(d) National Institute of Rural Development

Answer: (b)

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- **Explanation:** The Dr. YSR & Dr. KVP Foundation will confer the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Award-2026, **carrying a cash prize of ₹25 lakh,** on **the M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF)** in recognition of its **contribution to agriculture, food security, sustainable development and rural livelihoods.**
- **MSSRF chairperson Soumya Swaminathan will receive the award.**

Q28. Which company entered the Asia Book of Records for creating 'Mundukalam', a Pookkalam made using dhotis?

(a) Kalyan Silks
(b) Manyavar
(c) Nalli Silks
(d) Ramraj Cotton

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: Tiruppur-based Ramraj Cotton textiles** has entered the **Asia Book of Records for creating Mundukalam,** a **display of pookkalam using dhotis.**
- The company created a **Mundukalam that was 30 feet long in diametre using as many as 3,000 dhotis at** Forum Mall, Kochi, Keralam.

Q29. How many underwater push-ups did Kamal Kaloi perform on a single breath to set the Guinness World Record?

(a) 76
(b) 82
(c) 86
(d) 92

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Kamal Kaloi**, a 38-year-old yoga teacher and aquatic athlete hailing from Hisar, Haryana, has set a new Guinness World Record for performing 86 underwater push-ups on a single breath

Q30. Which company was named the Overall Industry Champion at the Prime Minister Internship Scheme (PMIS) award 2026?

(a) POWERGRID
(b) Tata Motors
(c) Mahindra & Mahindra Limited
(d) Larsen & Toubro

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID), a Maharatna public sector undertaking** under the Ministry of Power, **received the PMIS Recognition of Partner Company Award** in the category of Innovation in Exit Pathways
- The award ceremony was held by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs at the India Habitat Centre in New Delhi
- **Mahindra & Mahindra Limited was named the Overall Industry Champion at the same event.**

Obituary

Q1. Recently deceased former Governor and educationist D.Y. Patil served as the Governor of which of the following states?

1. Tripura
2. Bihar
3. West Bengal

Select the correct answer using the code below:

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Former West Bengal Governor and senior Congress leader D.Y. Patil passed away due to prolonged illness at his residence in Maharashtra's Kolhapur
- Widely recognised in **Maharashtra as "Shikshanmaharshi," or visionary educationist**
- served as the **Governor of Tripura, Bihar, and West Bengal.**

Q2. Justice M. S. Liberhan, recently seen in the news, is best known for heading the commission that investigated the:

(a) 1984 Anti-Sikh riots
(b) Godhra train burning incident
(c) Emergency excesses (1975–77)
(d) Babri Masjid demolition

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Justice M S Liberhan, who achieved national prominence as the **head of the judicial commission** constituted **to investigate the Babri Masjid demolition,** died at age 87 in Chandigarh.
- Justice Manmohan Singh Liberhan was a **former judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court** and **a former Chief Justice of the Andhra Pradesh and Madras High Courts.**
- The Justice Liberhan Commission submitted its report on the December 6, 1992, demolition of the Babri mosque by kar sevaks after nearly 17 years, becoming **one of the longest-running commissions of inquiry in India's history.**

Q3. Nirmal Purja, who was recently in news, was associated with which profession?

(a) Mountaineering

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(b) Cricket
(c) Aviation
(d) Journalism
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Veteran Nepalese mountaineer Nirmal Purja died in an avalanche on Broad Peak, located in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir's Gilgit Baltistan,
- Born in Nepal, Purja, 43, was among 10 climbers swept away by the avalanche that **struck Broad Peak, located in the Karakoram range near K2,** at an altitude of around 7,000 metres

Q4. Franco Baresi, who recently passed away, was associated with which football club throughout his professional playing career?
(a) Real Madrid
(b) FC Barcelona
(c) AC Milan
(d) Juventus
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Franco Baresi, the **former AC Milan defender and World Cup winner with Italy**, has died. He was 66.
- In 2020, Baresi became **honorary vice-president of AC Milan,**
- He also lifted four **Supercoppa Italianas,** two **European Super Cups** and **the Intercontinental Cup** twice.

Q5. General Vishwa Nath Sharma, who recently passed away, served as the Chief of Army Staff (COAS) of India during which period?
(a) 1985–1987
(b) 1988–1990
(c) 1990–1992
(d) 1992–1994
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** General Vishwa Nath Sharma, **former Chief of Army Staff**, passed away in New Delhi at the age of 97.
- He served as the 14th Chief of Army Staff (COAS) from 1 May 1988 to 30 June 1990.
- He was the **first President's Commissioned Officer** to rise to the position of Army Chief.

Q6. Who authored Swadeshi Movement in Bengal, 1903–1908?
(a) Bipan Chandra
(b) Sumit Sarkar
(c) R.C. Majumdar
(d) Ranajit Guha
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Eminent Marxist historian and scholar of modern Indian history, Sumit Sarkar, died**
- He spent several years **teaching History at the University of Delhi, and was a Fellow of Wolfson College, Oxford.**
- His works include **Swadeshi Movement in Bengal, 1903-1908 (1973), Modern India (1989), and Writing Social History (1998)**, among others.

Q7. King Harald V, who recently passed away, was the monarch of which country?
(a) Sweden
(b) Denmark
(c) Norway
(d) Finland
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Norway's King Harald V has died at the age of 89, the royal palace in Oslo announced
- Harald, who **became Norway's ceremonial head of state in 1991, was Europe's oldest reigning monarch.**

Q8. Sonya Gill, who recently passed away, was associated with which organisation as a former Maharashtra Secretary?
(a) National Federation of Indian Women
(b) All India Democratic Women's Association
(c) Self-Employed Women's Association
(d) National Commission for Women
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Sonya Gill, women's rights activist and former Maharashtra Secretary of All India Democratic Women's Association (AIDWA), died.
- **She was the co-founder and trustee of PARI (People's Archive of Rural India).**

Q9. Tim Curry is best known for his contributions to which of the following fields?
(a) Theatre, cinema and television
(b) Literature, journalism and publishing
(c) Music, archaeology and anthropology
(d) Diplomacy, law and public administration
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Tim Curry, the British actor whose flamboyant performances in The Rocky Horror Picture Show and Stephen King's It made him a cult icon across generations, has died at the age of 80.
- His career included work in television, music and voice acting across more than five decades, including **including Star Wars: The Clone Wars, The Wild Thornberrys and The Adventures of Jimmy Neutron, Boy Genius.**

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Q1. Consider the following statements regarding the GOBARdhan Scheme:

1. It is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme.
2. The Compressed Biogas (CBG) blending obligation will reach 5% from FY 2029 onwards.
3. Only eligible greenfield CBG projects are entitled to financial support under the scheme, while brownfield projects are not eligible.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 2 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The GOBARdhan (Galvanising Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan) is a National Circular Bioenergy Scheme that creates a nationwide **waste-to-energy ecosystem.**
- It aims to **increase domestic Compressed Biogas (CBG) production nearly ten-fold,** mobilize large-scale private investment and create a vibrant circular bioeconomy across the country.
- **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.**
- Under this, a dedicated framework requires **City Gas Distribution entities to meet a notified CBG blending obligation of 3% in FY27, 4% in FY28, and 5% from FY29 onwards in CNG and PNG segments.**
- **Brownfield projects** expanding their production capacity **will also be eligible.**

Q2. The Payment and Settlement Systems (Amendment) Bill, 2026 primarily seeks to:

(a) Make UPI transactions mandatory for all merchants
(b) Permit the government to authorise charges on notified electronic payment modes
(c) Abolish the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on all digital payments
(d) Bring cryptocurrency transactions under the RBI

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Lok Sabha passed a Bill to amend the **Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007** that authorises the **government to permit banks and other service providers to levy charges on payments through unified payments interface (UPI)** and other notified electronic payment modes.
- The amendment seeks to remove the existing legal provision **that prevents banks and payment service providers from charging Merchant Discount Rate (MDR)** on notified electronic payment modes.

Q3. Consider the following statements regarding the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026:

1. Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) will be exempted from income tax on interest earned from investments in government securities.
2. The Bill proposes to raise the surcharge from 10% to 25% for a special purpose vehicle of a business trust.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Parliament has passed the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026.
- **The Bill seeks to repeal and replace the Income-tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026 issued on June 5, 2026.**
- The Ordinance amended the Income-tax Act, 2025 to **provide exemptions to certain foreign investors in government securities.**
- The Bill exempts **foreign institutional investors (FIIs) and the Bank for International Settlements (BIS)** from paying income tax on:
  (i) **interest earned on investments in government securities**, and
  (ii) **capital gains arising from sale, exchange or transfer of such securities.**
- The exemption will **apply to income arising on or after April 1, 2026.**
- The Finance Act, 2026 levies a **surcharge of 10% on income-tax payable by every domestic company** opting for concessional tax rates.
- The **Bill raises surcharge rate to 25%** for a special purpose vehicle of a business trust.

Q4. At which institution was the AI-powered high-performance computing facility "Param Pragya" inaugurated?

(a) IIT Bombay
(b) IIT Delhi
(c) IIT Madras
(d) IIT Kanpur

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi held its 57th Convocation Ceremony, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi in attendance as the chief guest.
- PM Modi also inaugurated Param Pragya, an AI-powered high-performance supercomputing facility set up at IIT Delhi's Sonipat campus. Sonipat is a city in the state of Haryana.

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Q5. AAERI Verify is primarily aimed at enabling Indian students to:

(a) Digitally verify documents for Australian universities

(b) Access overseas education counselling services

(c) Authenticate credentials for foreign employment

(d) Apply for international student exchange programmes

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: The National e-Governance Division-NeGD,** under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, has **partnered with the Association of Australian Education** Representatives in India, AAERI, to launch **a new digital platform, AAERI Verify.**
- The platform is **integrated with DigiLocker**, will enable Indian students applying to Australian universities to **securely and digitally verify their academic, identity and financial documents.**

Q6. Consider the following statements regarding the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026:

1. It retains the upper age limits of 70 years for Chairpersons and 67 years for Members.

2. It increases the tenure of tribunal Chairpersons and Members from four years to six years.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Lok Sabha passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, which seeks to **replace the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021,** with a new framework for **appointments, tenure and functioning of tribunals.**
- It comes after the Supreme Court struck down key provisions of the 2021 law in its **November 2025 judgment in Madras Bar Association vs Union of India.**
- The 2021 Act had introduced a common framework for the appointment and service conditions of tribunal Chairpersons and Members. **It prescribed a minimum age of 50 years, a four-year term and required selection committees to recommend a panel of two names for each vacancy.**
- The 2021 Act provided a **four-year term for both Chairpersons and Members, subject to the upper age limits of 70 years and 67 years respectively.**
- The 2026 Bill increases **the tenure to five years,** while retaining the existing upper age limits.

Q7. Samudra Manthan Scheme is a Central Sector Scheme of which Union Ministry?

(a) Ministry of Coal

(b) Ministry of New and Renewable Energy

(c) Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas

(d) Ministry of Earth Sciences

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Union Cabinet has approved **'Samudra Manthan' – the National Offshore Exploration Scheme** with a total outlay of ₹84,084 crore.
- It is also called the National Offshore Exploration Scheme.
- Nodal Ministry: It is a **Central Sector Scheme of the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas.**
- Implementation Period: Up to **FY 2030–31.**
- The scheme aims at unlocking India's vast offshore energy potential

Q8. The sanctioning period for projects under the Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana has been fixed from which financial years?

(a) FY 2025–26 to FY 2029–30

(b) FY 2026–27 to FY 2030–31

(c) FY 2027–28 to FY 2032–33

(d) FY 2028–29 to FY 2035–36

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Cabinet Approves Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana**
- It is a scheme for the **development of Floating Solar Photovoltaic (FSPV) Projects** with Energy Storage Systems (ESS).
- It envisages the **development of 5,000 MW of Floating Solar Photovoltaic projects** with co-located Energy Storage Systems having a **minimum storage capacity of two hours i.e.,10,000 MWh.**
- Time Period: **The projects will be sanctioned during FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31,** with disbursement of financial support continuing up to FY 2032-33.

Q9. Consider the following statements regarding the PM-KISAN Scheme:

1. Under the scheme, eligible farmer families receive ₹6,000 per year in three equal installments.

2. PM-KISAN is a Central Sponsored Scheme.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) Only 1

(b) Only 2

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

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- **Explanation:** The Union Cabinet has approved the **continuation of the PM-KISAN for the next 5 years,** reaffirming the Government's commitment to farmers' prosperity as the foundation of national prosperity.
- **PM-KISAN** is a **Central Sector Scheme** launched in **2019** to provide assured **income support to landholding farmer families with cultivable land.**
- The **Union Budget 2026–27 allocated ₹60,000 crore** for PM-KISAN, reflecting continued support for farmers' income security.

Q10. Which two dedicated school initiatives have been launched under the revamped Khelo India Scheme?

(a) Khelo India Model Schools and Khelo India Sports Academies

(b) Khelo India Feeder Schools and Khelo India Utkrishta Vidyalayas

(c) Khelo India Talent Schools and Khelo India Olympic Schools

(d) Khelo India Rural Schools and Khelo India Elite Schools

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The Revamped Khelo India Scheme**
- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister of India, **approved an expanded, revamped Khelo India Scheme** along with an enhanced **Assistance to National Sports Federations (ANSFs) scheme.**
- The Khelo India Scheme is the central flagship initiative of the **Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.**
- It is designed to **revive India's sports culture at the grassroots level, identify athletic talent, construct modern sports infrastructure,** and establish a structured pathway to national and international excellence.
- Introduces the **Emerging Khelo India Athletes** (E-KIAs) category alongside existing Khelo India Athletes (KIAs), **expanding the structured athlete development ecosystem nearly ten-fold under professional coaching and scientific support.**
- Launches two dedicated school initiatives—**Khelo India Feeder Schools (KIFS) and Khelo India Utkrishta Vidyalayas (KIUV)—**to embed physical education into mainstream school curricula and enable early talent identification.

Q11. Consider the following statements regarding the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026:

1. It removes fixed statutory investment thresholds for MSME classification.
2. Payment-related mediation must be completed within 90 days from the first hearing.
3. Minimum monetary penalty amounts will automatically increase by 10% every three years.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only

(b) 2 and 3 only

(c) 1 and 3 only

(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Parliament passed the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026, after its approval by the Rajya Sabha.
- The MSME Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026 amends the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development Act, 2006 to **improve the business environment for MSMEs through faster payments, streamlined dispute resolution, flexible classification, and decriminalised compliance.**
- Removes fixed statutory investment thresholds.
- Empowers the **Central Government to classify MSMEs based on investment in plant & machinery/equipment and turnover through notifications.**
- Mandates **that payment-related mediation before MSME Facilitation Councils or mediation providers must be completed within 90 days from the first hearing.**
- **Minimum penalty** amounts will automatically **increase by 10% every three years**
- **Replaces criminal penalties** with a graded system of warnings and monetary penalties.

Q12. The 'GI & Beyond 2.0 Summit' is being organised by the:

(a) Ministry of Commerce and Industry

(b) Ministry of Textiles

(c) Ministry of MSME

(d) Ministry of Culture

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The **Ministry of Textiles** will organise the **'GI & Beyond 2.0 Summit' in New Delhi** on August 5 to **promote India's Geographical Indication (GI)-tagged handloom and handicraft products** and strengthen their presence in domestic and international markets.
- The summit, being **organised by the Office of the Development Commissioner (Handlooms) in association with the Handloom Export Promotion Council (HEPC),** will be held at the Dr. Ambedkar International Centre.

Q13. The Vessel Communication and Support System (VCSS) has been launched under which scheme?

(a) Blue Revolution Scheme

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(b) Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY)
(c) Sagarmala Programme
(d) Fisheries and Aquaculture Infrastructure Development Fund (FIDF)

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Union Department of Fisheries approved the national rollout of the **Vessel Communication and Support System (VCSS)** under the **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana.**
- It also focuses **on establishment of the required earth station and associated communication infrastructure** and development of the 'Nabhmitra' application in regional languages.
- The transponders are **provided free of cost to eligible fishermen under the project.**

Q14. The primary objective of the Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026 is to:

(a) Strengthen prudential regulation and supervision of banking companies
(b) Facilitate the resolution of stressed assets and non-performing loans
(c) Provide an updated legal framework for admitting bank records as evidence in judicial proceedings
(d) Regulate digital payment systems and electronic fund transfers

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The Lok Sabha passed The Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026 by voice vote amid Opposition protests.
- The Bill seeks to repeal and **replace the Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891.**
- The Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026, is an updated legislative **framework that regulates how bank records are admitted as valid, primary evidence in legal proceedings.**
- Allows certified physical and electronic bank records as admissible evidence without producing original ledgers.

Q15. The second edition of the Bharat International Rice Conference (BIRC) will be held from:

(a) 20–22 October 2026
(b) 23–25 October 2026
(c) 25–27 October 2026
(d) 30–31 October 2026

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Bharat International Rice Conference (BIRC) 2026 is the second edition of the event and will be held from 23 to 25 October 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.
- BIRC is a trade platform for the rice sector and is linked to international rice commerce, price discovery, and supply-chain discussions.

Q16. The 'As Seen on Netflix' section was launched on which portal?

(a) National Digital Library Portal
(b) India.gov.in
(c) Dekho Apna Desh Portal
(d) Incredible India Portal

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** The Ministry of Culture and the Ministry of Tourism launched the '**As Seen on Netflix' section on the Incredible India portal on 5 August 2026.**
- The feature was developed with **Netflix India to connect films and series with real locations, cultural traditions, and travel experiences in India.**

Q17. On which date did Mahatma Gandhi launch the Non-Cooperation Movement?

(a) 1 August 1919
(b) 1 August 1920
(c) 11 February 1922
(d) 13 April 1920

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: On August 1, 1920, Mahatma Gandhi launched the Non-Cooperation (Asahayog) Movement**
- The Non-Cooperation Movement (NCM) was the **first nationwide movement launched by Gandhiji in 1920** during British rule.
- **Rowlatt Act and the brutal Jaliawala Bagh Massacre were the immediate causes** for launching the movement.

Q18. Who among the following drafted Article 370 of the Indian Constitution?

(a) B. R. Ambedkar
(b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar
(d) Alladi Krishnaswamy Ayyar

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** It is now seven years since the abrogation of Article 370 of the Constitution and the reorganisation of the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir into two Union Territories (UTs).
- **Article 370** in the Indian constitution **gave special status to Jammu and Kashmir,** a region disputed by India, Pakistan and China.
- It **was drafted by N Gopalaswami Ayyangar**, a member of the Constituent Assembly of India, and was **added to the constitution as a 'temporary provision' in 1949.**

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Q19. The 'Har Ghar Tiranga' campaign 2026 is being observed during which period?

(a) August 1–10
(b) August 5–15
(c) August 9–17
(d) August 10–20

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Ahead of Independence Day, the **'Har Ghar Tiranga' campaign is bringing a strong feeling of patriotism across the country.**
- Tiranga rallies and many other programmes are being organised across the state.
- **The campaign is being held from August 9 to 17**

Q20. Consider the following statements regarding the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026:

1. It aims to impose reasonable limitations on State-level taxation related to mineral development.
2. Entry 23 of the State List empowers States to regulate mines and mineral development without interference from the Centre.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Parliament passed the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to **restrict the power of state governments to levy taxes on mineral rights and mineral-bearing lands.**
- Under the Constitution, **Parliament has the power to regulate mines and mineral development,** to the extent Parliament declares such regulation expedient in the public interest by law **(Entry 54 of Union List).**
- **States** have the power to **regulate mines and mineral development, subject to the provisions of the Union List (Entry 23 of the State List).**

Q21. 'Srijan: Voices from the Loom' is being organised in which city?

(a) Mumbai
(b) Jaipur
(c) New Delhi
(d) Varanasi

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The Ministry of Textiles is organising **'Srijan: Voices from the Loom'** in New Delhi to **celebrate the contribution of women weavers to India's handloom heritage.**
- Srijan: Voices from the Loom is a special programme **recognising the stories, skills and contributions of women weavers engaged in India's handloom sector.**

Q22. Which two ministries have renewed their partnership under the 'One Herb, One Standard' initiative?

(a) Ministry of Ayush and Ministry of Agriculture
(b) Ministry of Ayush and Ministry of Health and Family Welfare
(c) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and Ministry of Environment
(d) Ministry of Ayush and Ministry of Science and Technology

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The Ministry of Ayush and the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** renewed their partnership under the **'One Herb, One Standard' initiative for an additional three years**.
- The 'One Herb, One Standard' initiative is an inter-ministerial collaborative framework designed to establish **unified, scientifically synchronized quality and testing standards (monographs) for medicinal plants used across different systems of medicine in India.**

Q23. What is 'Saptadhara' associated with?

(a) A seven-point development vision
(b) A seven-year economic plan
(c) A seven-state industrial corridor
(d) A seven-nation strategic alliance

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Saptadhara is a **seven-point development vision announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi** on India's 80th Independence Day, August 15, 2026.
- It focuses on **manufacturing, agriculture and food processing, technology and innovation, Gati Shakti, defence, green and blue economy, and soft power** as key drivers of India's future growth.
- The framework aims to strengthen India's economic and strategic capabilities and accelerate the country's journey towards Viksit Bharat.

Q24. Consider the following statements regarding PM Vishwakarma:

1. It is a Central Sector Scheme.
2. The scheme has an implementation period of five years, from FY 2023–24 to FY 2027–28.
3. It is implemented exclusively in rural areas.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

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- **Explanation:** The Government of India has invited **100 beneficiaries of PM Vishwakarma from the Delhi-NCR region as 'Special Guests'** to witness the 80th Independence Day Ceremony at the Red Fort, Delhi.
- It is a **central sector scheme launched in 2023.**
- It is aimed at **providing comprehensive support to artisans and craftspeople engaged in traditional trades**.
- Objective: Promoting the socio-economic empowerment of artisans, strengthening traditional crafts and ensuring sustainable livelihoods.
- **Time period: Five years (FY 2023-24 to FY 2027-28).**

Q25. 'Patoleo', featured in the special menu at the President's 'At Home' reception, is best described as:

(a) Rice-flour parcels filled with coconut and jaggery
(b) Fermented rice cakes served with lentils
(c) A potato-tomato preparation sautéed in ghee
(d) A millet-based savoury preparation

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The parcel comprised some rare craft items and an invite — to participate in the At Home reception hosted by President Draupadi Murmu on August 15.
- Around 650 guests, including over 100 eminent citizens, invited to the 80th Independence Day high tea.
- The focus of this year is to highlight the heritage and traditions of four states — **Maharashtra, Goa, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh**
- The specially curated menu includes '**patoleo' from the Konkan region,** comprising rice-flour parcels filled with coconut and jaggery**; mini farra from Chhattisgarh; khamang Kakdi from Maharashtra** and **Jabalpur's gatpat, a tangy mix of potatoes and tomatoes sauteed in ghee**, from Madhya Pradesh.

Q26. Consider the following statements regarding the e-Shram Portal:

1. It is exclusively designed to provide pension benefits to unorganised workers.
2. It assigns registered workers a portable 12-digit Universal Account Number (UAN).

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The e-Shram Portal is **India's first comprehensive, Aadhaar-authenticated National Database of Unorganised Workers (NDUW).**
- It assigns **every registered worker a portable 12-digit Universal Account Number (UAN)** and serves as a unified digital platform connecting the informal workforce to social security benefits, job portals, skilling opportunities, and pension plans.
- Aim: To build a **centralized, verifiable national registry of the unorganised workforce**, facilitate the convergence and portability of multi-ministerial **welfare schemes, and ensure seamless delivery of social security benefits**—especially during economic disruptions and national emergencies.
- **The One-Stop Solution brings together 15 Social Security and Welfare Schemes on a single platform**.

Q27. At the apex level of the PRAGATI mechanism, who chairs the review meetings with Chief Secretaries of States and Secretaries of Central Ministries/Departments?

(a) Cabinet Secretary
(b) Prime Minister
(c) Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister
(d) Secretary, Department of Administrative Reforms

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The Prime Minister of India chaired the 53rd meeting of the PRAGATI platform**
- **PRAGATI** (Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation) is the Government of India's flagship **platform launched in 2015.**
- It focuses on **fast-tracking projects, schemes, and grievance redressal through direct, real-time review by the Prime Minister,** in partnership with States and Union Ministries.
- The system has been **designed in-house by the PMO team with the help of the National Informatics Center (NIC).**
- At the **apex level**, the **Prime Minister chairs PRAGATI review meetings with Chief Secretaries of States and Secretaries of Central Ministries/Departments** to resolve issues related to identified projects and schemes.

Q28. What does "MITRA" stand for in Dak MITRA?

(a) Mobile Interface for Transactions & Rural Assistance
(b) Mobile Integration for Technology & Rural Administration
(c) Modern Interface for Transactions & Regional Assistance
(d) Mobile Information Technology for Rural Administration

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Dak MITRA App**
- The **upgraded Dak MITRA** (Mobile Interface for Transactions & Rural Assistance) application **serves as a unified operational platform for more than 1.4 lakh Branch Post Offices.**

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- It is developed **indigenously by the Centre for Excellence in Postal Technology (CEPT) under the Advanced Postal Technology (APT) platform** as part of DoP IT 2.0 Modernization,

Q29. 'Sankalp Shakti', recently released under the National Campaign on Entrepreneurship-II, is:
(a) A rural entrepreneurship portal
(b) A monthly Rural Enterprise Technical Bulletin
(c) A financial assistance scheme
(d) A digital marketing platform for SHGs
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Ministry of Rural Development** launched the **'National Campaign on Entrepreneurship- II'** under **the Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana–National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM)** for another **three months**, from 21 August to 21 November 2026, with an expanded **focus on both Farm, Non-Farm enterprises and marketing of SHG products.**
- The campaign has been designed to promote and focus intensively on promoting rural women entrepreneurship.
- 'Sankalp Shakti', the first Rural Enterprise Technical Bulletin, was also released , This Bulletin will be a monthly feature.

Q30. Under the Entrepreneur-in-Residence (EIR) component of the GENESIS scheme, selected innovators are eligible to receive financial assistance of up to:
(a) ₹5 lakh
(b) ₹10 lakh
(c) ₹25 lakh
(d) ₹50 lakh
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY),** through **MeitY Startup Hub (MSH),** has launched the third cohort of its **GENESIS Entrepreneur-in-Residence** (EIR) **programme** to support **aspiring entrepreneurs, innovators, researchers, students and early-stage startup founders** in turning technology-driven ideas into viable ventures.
- GENESIS EIR 3.0 was launched at the GENESIS NextGen Startup Summit – Coimbatore Edition.
- Under the Entrepreneur-in-Residence component, selected innovators will **receive financial assistance of up to Rs 10 lakh through participating GENESIS incubators, along with incubation, mentorship and access to the wider startup ecosystem.**

Q31. 'Vigyan Pragati' was launched in which year?
(a) 1947
(b) 1950
(c) 1952
(d) 1955
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: CSIR-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR)** organised a Platinum Jubilee Ceremony to mark 75 years of its popular **Hindi science magazine, 'Vigyan Pragati'.**
- **Launched in 1952**, 'Vigyan Pragati' has played a significant role over the past 75 years in disseminating scientific information among the public in simple and accessible language, promoting scientific temper and awareness, and communicating scientific achievements to society.

Q32. The government has decided to remove the _____ advertisement duration cap for television channels.
(a) 10-minute
(b) 12-minute
(c) 15-minute
(d) 20-minute
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The government has decided to remove the 12-minute advertisement duration cap for television channels to promote fair competition and ease of doing business.
- **Dependence on Advertising: In India, television channels—both pay and free-to-air (FTA)—are heavily dependent on advertising revenue.**
- **The 12-minute cap was introduced in 2006 under the Cable Television Networks Rules, 1994, when India had only 62 TV channels.**

Q33. What is the theme of Semicon India 2026?
(a) Chips for a Digital India
(b) Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem
(c) Semiconductors for Global Growth
(d) From Chips to Digital Transformation
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the fifth edition of Semicon India 2026 on September 17.
- The three-day event, to be held between September 17 and 19 in New Delhi,
- **the theme 'Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem',**

Q34. Consider the following statements regarding AppCoMS 2.0:
1. It was launched by the Central Information Commission (CIC).
2. It is an online case-management platform.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only

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(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (c)

- Explanation: The Central Information Commission (CIC) launched the **upgraded Appeal and Complaint Management System 2.0 (AppCoMS 2.0) in New Delhi.**
- AppCoMS is the CIC's **online case-management platform for registration, scheduling, notice generation, and decision upload.**

Q35. Consider the following statements regarding the RSVC AMRIT platform:
1. It is developed by NITI Aayog.
2. It is aimed at facilitating the adoption of appropriate technologies in rural areas.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the **Principal Scientific Adviser** to the Government of India **launched the RSVC AMRIT platform.**
- It is **developed by NABARD** in **collaboration with the Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser** (OPSA) to the Government of India.
- **AMRIT Platform serves as the digital backbone of the RuTAGe Smart Village Centre (RSVC) ecosystem.**
- It supports rural innovation and technology transfer and enables **wider adoption of appropriate technologies in rural areas.**

Q36. Consider the following statements regarding the Growers' Welfare Scheme of the Tobacco Board:
1. The interest-free loan for major illness or accident requiring surgery has been increased to ₹1 lakh.
2. The interest-free loan for education of dependent children has been increased to ₹1 lakh.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The Tobacco Board has increased the **interest-free loans offered under its Growers' Welfare Scheme** for various purposes, including **medical treatment, marriage of daughters, education, and repair of damaged barns.**
- The government has enhanced **not just the interest-free loans but also the death grant,** following amendments to the Board's Growers' Welfare Schemes.
- **The interest-free loan for treatment of major illness** or accident cases requiring surgery has been increased from **₹50,000 to ₹1,00,000.**
- A similar enhancement **— from ₹50,000 to ₹1,00,000** — has been **made for the marriage of daughters and the education of dependent children of growers.**
- For **repair of barns damaged by natural calamity or fire,** the loan amount has **been increased from ₹20,000 to ₹40,000 for partial damage, and from ₹50,000 to ₹1,00,000 for full or heavy damage.**

Q37. Which Union Ministry launched the 'Friends of MY Bharat' initiative?
(a) Ministry of External Affairs
(b) Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
(c) Ministry of Education
(d) Ministry of Culture
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the **Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports** has launched a new digital initiative, **'Friends of MY Bharat' initiative.**
- It is an initiative of the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.
- It strengthens **engagement with Indian-origin youth living across the world and provides them opportunities to participate in India's nation-building and youth-led programmes.**

Q38. Consider the following statements regarding the proposed NMC registration system:
1. State-registered doctors would receive a UID in the National Medical Register.
2. The UID would allow them to practise across India without fresh State registration.
3. It would remove the need for State Medical Council registration.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The National Medical Commission (NMC) has proposed a **registration system under which a medical practitioner**, once **registered with a State Medical Council** and **allotted a Unique Identification** (UID) number in the National Medical Register, would be **eligible to practise across India without obtaining fresh registration or a licence in another State.**

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- It is a **statutory body constituted by the National Medical Commission Act, 2019**, which came into force on September 25, 2020.
- It replaced the **Medical Council of India (MCI)** and serves as the **top regulatory authority for medical education, medical professionals, and medical institutions in India.**
- It grants recognition of medical qualifications, gives accreditation to medical schools, grants registration to medical practitioners, monitors medical practice, and assesses the medical infrastructure in India.

Q39. Which organisation launched the digital CO_2 Dashboard?

(a) National Mineral Development Corporation (NMDC)
(b) Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL)
(c) Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL)
(d) Hindustan Steelworks Construction Limited (HSCL)

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL) launched a digital CO2 Dashboard at Bhilai Steel Plant.**
- **SAIL is a Maharatna public sector undertaking** under the **Ministry of Steel.**

Q40. 'Gnani Artha' integrates which of the following two core components?

(a) BharatGPT and IndiaAI
(b) Evon 3.3 and Plexus
(c) Bhashini and DigiLocker
(d) Sarvam and Krutrim

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Vice President of India launched **'Gnani Artha', an indigenously developed sovereign Artificial Intelligence (AI) stack** comprising the Evon 3.3 language model and the Plexus agentic platform.
- Gnani Artha is an **end-to-end, indigenous sovereign AI technology stack designed specifically for Indian enterprises and public institutions**.

Q41. 'Jago AI Assistant' is best described as a:

(a) Digital identity platform
(b) Conversational AI assistant
(c) Satellite-based communication system
(d) Blockchain-based welfare portal

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The Union Ministry of Tribal Affairs launched the Jago AI Assistant.**
  It is an **AI conversational assistant to extend the reach of tribal welfare schemes and programmes**.
- It is an initiative of the **Ministry of Tribal Affairs.**

Q42. Consider the following statements regarding the Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026:

1. They mandate Indian Standard Time as the single reference for legal, administrative and commercial purposes.
2. They provide a 160-day transition period after publication in the Official Gazette.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Union government has notified the **Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026**, mandating Indian Standard Time (IST) as the **single reference for legal, administrative, commercial and official purposes.**
- The Rules will **come into force 180 days after publication in the Official Gazette.**
- **Single National Standard:** Makes IST the mandatory reference for legal, administrative, commercial and other official purposes.
- **180-Day Transition:** Provides organisations time to upgrade and synchronise existing systems.

Eminent Personalities in News

Q1. Who was the author of the booklet A National Flag for India, published in 1916?

(a) Mahatma Gandhi
(b) Pingali Venkayya
(c) Jawaharlal Nehru
(d) Lala Lajpat Rai

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Pingali Venkayya was born on 2nd August 1876 in a village near Machilipatnam in Krishna District, Andhra Pradesh.**
- **In 1916**, Pingali Venkayya published a **booklet titled A National Flag for India**, featuring nearly 30 designs for a **potential Indian flag**, inspired by flags of other nations.

Q2. Which of the following statements about V. V. Giri is correct?

(a) He was the first President of India to be elected as an independent candidate.
(b) He was the first Vice-President of India.
(c) He was the first President to receive the Bharat Ratna.
(d) He served as President for only one year.

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: President V V Giri birth anniversary on 10th August 1894,** Varahagiri Venkata Giri was **born in Berhampur, Odisha.**

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- VV Giri served as the **4th president of India from 24 August 1969 to 24 August 1974** and **3rd vice president of India** from 13 May 1967 to 3 May 1969.
- He is the **first president to be elected as an independent candidate.**

Q3. With reference to Vikram Sarabhai, consider the following statements:

1. He founded the Physical Research Laboratory (PRL) in Ahmedabad in 1947.
2. He was awarded the Padma Vibhushan in 1972, posthumously.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Vikram Sarabhai was **born on August 12, 1919.**
- Based on his persuasion, the Indian government agreed to set up **the Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR)in 1962.** He was the **first chairman of the committee.**
- **Sarabhai founded the Physical Research Laboratory in Ahmedabad in 1947.**
- Vikram Sarabhai received the **Padma Bhushan in 1966** for his contribution to India's progress. He was also awarded the **Padma Vibhushan in 1972, posthumously.**

Q4. Who wrote Savitri: A Legend and a Symbol?

(a) Rabindranath Tagore
(b) Sri Aurobindo
(c) Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay
(d) Sarojini Naidu

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: PM paid tributes on Sri Aurobindo's Birth Anniversary**
- **Sri Aurobindo was** a yogi, **philosopher, spiritual leader, and freedom fighter** who linked nation-building with spiritual evolution.
- **Full Name**: **Aurobindo Ghose**
- **Born: 15 August 1872, Kolkata** (then Calcutta)

Literary Contributions:

- **Philosophical Works** – The Life Divine, The Synthesis of Yoga, Essays on the Gita.
- **Poetry and Epics** – Savitri: A Legend and a Symbol.
- **Political and Cultural Writings** – The Human Cycle, The Ideal of Human Unity.

Q5. Consider the following statements regarding Mother Teresa:

1. She established the Missionaries of Charity in Kolkata in 1952.
2. She received the Nobel Peace Prize in **1980**.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: 26 August - Mother Teresa Birth Anniversary**
- **Born on August 26, 1910, in Skopje, Macedonia**
- **On October 7, 1950, Mother Teresa established** the **Missionaries of Charity in Kolkata**
- Mother Teresa garnered numerous awards, including the **Ramon Magsaysay Peace Prize in 1962** and the **Nobel Peace Prize in 1979**

Q6. Bir Bikram Kishore Manikya Bahadur is popularly known as the:

(a) Architect of Modern Tripura
(b) Father of Modern Northeast India
(c) Pioneer of Tribal Administration in Northeast India
(d) Builder of Modern Princely States in Northeast India

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Birth Anniversary Maharaja Bir Bikram Kishore Manikya Bahadur**
- Bir Bikram Kishore Manikya Bahadur was a **king of Tripura State - born on 19th August 1908** in Tripura
- He is known as **"the architect of modern Tripura".**
- He **established the first higher educational institution,** advocated for **land reforms, and reserved land for the indigenous people**, leading to the formation of the **Tripura Tribal Areas Autonomous District Council (TTAADC).**

State

Q1. India's first guided high-altitude wildlife safari has been approved by which of the following States/Union Territories?

(a) Jammu & Kashmir
(b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Uttarakhand
(d) Ladakh

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Ladakh approved India's first guided high-altitude wildlife safari on 6 August 2026.
- The plan covers **snow-leopard and bird-watching trails in Hemis National Park, Changthang, Karakoram Wildlife Sanctuary, Nubra, Zanskar, Sham, Kargil and Drass.**

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Q2. In which State/Union Territory is India's inaugural Black-Necked Crane Festival being held in 2026?
(a) Himachal Pradesh
(b) Uttarakhand
(c) Ladakh
(d) Jammu and Kashmir
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: I**ndia's inaugural **Black-Necked Crane Festival** takes place from August 11–14, 2026, **across Leh, Tso Kar, and Hanle in Ladakh.**
- There are around 16,000 Black-Necked Cranes distributed across **India, Bhutan, China and Nepal.**
- **IUCN: Near Threatened**

Q3. The Bhairav Yatra, recently included in the National Inventory of Intangible Cultural Heritage of India, is celebrated in which of the following States/Union Territories?
(a) Himachal Pradesh
(b) Uttarakhand
(c) Jammu and Kashmir
(d) Ladakh
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The historic Bhairav Yatra of **Rajouri district in Jammu and Kashmir** has been added to the National Inventory of Intangible Cultural Heritage of India.
- **Rajouri's Bhairav Yatra is a centuries-old sacred procession.**
- While its exact origin year is not historically documented, generations have celebrated the vibrant festival.
- The procession **is dedicated to Lord Kaal Bhairav, an avatar of Lord Shiva.**

Q4. The Ujh River is a tributary of the:
(a) Beas River
(b) Ravi River
(c) Chenab River
(d) Sutlej River
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Union Minister of State for Prime Minister's Office recently reviewed the status and phased implementation roadmap of the **Ujh Multipurpose Project in the Kathua district of Jammu and Kashmir.**
- It is a multipurpose (Hydropower, Irrigation, and Drinking) project in the Kathua District of Jammu and Kashmir on the River Ujh, which **is a major tributary of River Ravi.**
- The project, which was declared as a **"national project" in the year 2008**, involves the construction of a 116-metre-high concrete-faced rockfill dam.

Q5. Shipki La, recently in news due to the resumption of India-China border trade, is located in which Indian state?
(a) Uttarakhand
(b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Arunachal Pradesh
(d) Sikkim
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The cross-border trade between India and China through **Shipki La**, known as the ancient Silk Route joining India with Tibet, **resumed (August 1, 2026) after a gap of six years.**
- It is a high mountain pass, **bordering India and China in the tribal district of Kinnaur in Himachal Pradesh.**
- Situated at an altitude of 3,930 meters, **it is one of the highest motorable passes.**

Q6. The newspaper 'The Samaja', founded by Pandit Gopabandhu Das in 1919, was primarily published in:
(a) Bengali
(b) Hindi
(c) Odia
(d) English
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** President of India unveiled the statue of eminent freedom fighter, social reformer, and pioneer **journalist Utkalmani Pandit Gopabandhu Das** at Lajpat Bhawan in New Delhi.
- Utkalmani Pandit Gopabandhu Das (1877–1928) was an iconic freedom fighter, social reformer, educationist, poet, and pioneering journalist from Odisha.
- Revered with the title **Utkalmani (meaning The Jewel of Odisha), he dedicated his life to national independence, linguistic consolidation of Odia-speaking regions**, open-air education, and the selfless service of flood and famine victims.
- Started the historic **Odia newspaper The Samaja** in 1919, Written in simple, lucid Odia prose.

Q7. The Uttar Pradesh Government renamed the 'Kakori Kand' as:
(a) Kakori Revolutionary Action
(b) Kakori Train Action
(c) Kakori Freedom Action
(d) Kakori National Action
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah and Defence Minister Rajnath Singh paid tribute to the freedom fighters who participated in the Quit India Movement and the Kakori Train Action.
- Recently, the **Government of Uttar Pradesh has renamed 'Kakori Kand'**, an important movement

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in the history of India's freedom struggle, **to 'Kakori Train Action'.**

- The **Kakori Rail Conspiracy** — often referred to as the Kakori Train Robbery — took place on **August 9, 1925,**

Q8. Recently, the Government of Uttar Pradesh announced free travel in UPSRTC buses for which of the following categories?

(a) All women above 50 years
(b) Women aged 60 years and above
(c) All senior citizens above 60 years
(d) Women belonging to BPL families only

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Uttar Pradesh government provides free travel in state-run roadways (UPSRTC) buses for **women aged 60 years and above.**
- **The state government allocated ₹100 crore in the First Supplementary Budget** of the financial year 2026–27 to implement this scheme and compensate the Uttar Pradesh State Road Transport Corporation (UPSRTC)
- **Eligible Passengers: Only women who are 60 years of age or older.**

Q9. Consider the following statements regarding the Dhabaleswar Temple:

1. It is built in the Dravidian style of architecture.
2. The entrance hall of the temple is known as Jagamohan.
3. The temple is located on the banks of the Godavari River.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 2 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The president recently offered prayers at the **Dhabaleswar Temple near Berhampur, marking the final engagement of her three-day visit to Odisha.**
- The famous, ancient island temple of the same name is a Hindu temple dedicated to **Lord Shiva.**
- It is located **on an island on River Mahanadi near Cuttack, Odisha .**
- It is one of the oldest temples in Odisha. **It dates back to the early 10th and 11th century.**
- The temple structure was constructed during the rule of the **Somavamshi dynasty by King Yayati Keshari.**
- It is built in the **Kalinga style of architecture.**
- The temple has a **beautiful entrance known as Jagamohan.**

Q10. With the establishment of its first police station in West Bengal, the National Investigation Agency (NIA) will have how many operational police stations across India?

(a) 15
(b) 16
(c) 17
(d) 18

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** West Bengal is set to get its first dedicated police station for the National Investigation Agency (NIA) at **National Buildings Construction Corporation Square in Kolkata's New Town.**
- With this new police station, NIA will now be able to lodge FIRs in connection with any case in West Bengal immediately in Kolkata.
- **This will be the 17th police station of the NIA across the country.**

Q11. Consider the following statements regarding the Nyishi tribe:

1. The Nyishi are the largest ethnic group in Sikkim.
2. Social distinctions among the Nyishi are not determined by birth or occupation.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Researchers named Begonia neelamorum after the Neelam clan of the Nyishi tribe, whose members helped them navigate rugged terrain and locate the plant during a difficult expedition.
- The Nyishi are the largest ethnic group in Arunachal Pradesh.
- **The Nyishi support themselves with slash-and-burn agriculture and hunting and fishing.**
- One striking feature of Nyishi society is that it is neither based on a caste system nor stratified into classes, except for a loose type of social distinction which is not determined by birth or occupation.

Q12. Consider the following statements regarding Glaw (Glow) Lake:

1. It is India's 101st Ramsar Site.
2. It originated due to tectonic activity and land-block warping.
3. It is located within the Namdapha National Park.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only

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(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, announced the designation of **Glaw Lake (also known as Glow Lake) in Arunachal Pradesh as India's 101st Ramsar Site.**
- This landmark recognition marks **Arunachal Pradesh's very first Ramsar Site.**
- Spread across an estimated area of 8 square kilometers at an elevation of approximately 1,168 meters above sea level, it serves as a **major source for the perennial Kamlang River.**
- Formed through **natural tectonic activity** and land-block warping typical of the Eastern Himalayan structural fold belt, creating a **natural high-altitude depression that impounds alpine run-off.**
- Lies deep inside the **Kamlang Tiger Reserve and Wildlife Sanctuary** (bounded by the Lang River to the north and **Namdapha National Park** to the south).

Q13. Which state government has rolled out the e-Bhavishya Pension Sanction and Tracking System?

(a) Assam

(b) Arunachal Pradesh

(c) Sikkim

(d) Meghalaya

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Arunachal Pradesh Government has rolled out the **e-Bhavishya Pension Sanction and Tracking System, a paperless platform to streamline pension processing and ensure timely retirement benefits for government employees.**
- the initiative included a **three-day training programme conducted by the National Informatics Centre (NIC) for officials from 25 pilot departments.**

Q14. Which State has recently imposed a one-year ban on the manufacture, storage, distribution, transportation and sale of analogue (artificial/non-dairy) paneer?

(a) Gujarat

(b) Tamil Nadu

(c) Karnataka

(d) Maharashtra

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Maharashtra, has imposed an immediate, state-wide ban on the manufacture, storage, distribution, transportation, and sale of analogue or artificial (non-dairy) paneer for a period of one year.
- The directive, issued under the leadership of FDA Commissioner Tukaram Mundhe, signals a major crackdown on adulterated dairy products in restaurants, hotels, and catering services.

Q15. Consider the following statements regarding the Thoti tribe:

1. The Thoti community is known to practice endogamy.
2. The Thoti community is classified as a Scheduled Caste.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Thoti Tribe Faces Rapid Population Decline in Telangana**
- It is a small tribal community concentrated in northern Telangana.
- **They are classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG).**
- They have historically served as **village messengers, ballad singers, and folk artists,** maintaining a rich heritage of storytelling and indigenous cultural practices.
- They speak **Gonti as their mother tongue.**
- The Thotis have been known to practice endogamy.

Q16. ANUGYAN – NTOP was launched through a collaboration between:

(a) IIT Hyderabad and Nuclear Power Corporation of India Limited (NPCIL)

(b) IIT Hyderabad and Crimson Energy Experts Private Limited (CEEPL)

(c) IIT Bombay and Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC)

(d) IIT Madras and Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The **Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad (IITH) launched ANUGYAN** – Nuclear Technology Orientation Programme (NTOP) **in collaboration with the Crimson Energy Experts Private Limited (CEEPL).**
- Anugyan is India's first industry – academia programme introduced **to provide engineers and industry professionals for the civil nuclear energy sector growing at a rapid pace.**

Q17. Which company has become the first in India to deploy 4,000 electric buses on the country's roads?

(a) Tata Motors Limited

(b) Ashok Leyland Limited

(c) JBM Auto Limited

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(d) Olectra Greentech Limited

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Hyderabad-based **Olectra Greentech Limited has become the first company in India to deploy 4,000 electric buses on the country's roads.**
- The company stated that its fleet of 4,000 electric buses has collectively travelled more than 730 million green kilometres, preventing over 6.5 lakh tonnes of carbon dioxide (CO_2) emissions.

Q18. The Guinness World Record for the "largest _____ dance" was achieved by more than _____ tribal women and girl students.

(a) Dhimsa; 13,000

(b) Garba; 10,000

(c) Ghoomar; 8,000

(d) Bihu; 5,000

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **Visakhapatnam Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport at Bhogapuram** and announced that the Centre will extend all its support to the upcoming Visakhapatnam Economic Region.
- The Bhogapuram airport had been named after freedom fighter Alluri Sitarama Raju, who sacrificed his life for the rights of tribal communities..
- A recent performance of the **traditional Dhimsa dance** by more than **13,000 tribal women** and girl students at the Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport in Bhogapuram was **recognised by Guinness World Records as the "largest Dhimsa dance".**
- It is a popular tribal dance performed by tribes, including **Bagata, Valmiki, Poraja, Khond, Gadaba, Kondadora, Mukadora, and Kotia in Andhra Pradesh .**

Q19. What is Operation Mukta, recently launched by the Bengaluru City Police?

(a) A drive to identify suspected illegal immigrants

(b) A campaign against cybercrime

(c) A drive against human trafficking

(d) A citywide traffic enforcement campaign

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Bengaluru City Police launched Operation Mukta on 8 August 2026 to identify and track suspected illegal immigrants across the city.
- The drive focused on suspected Bangladeshi nationals .
- The operation, conducted across six police station limits, marked one of the biggest recent verification drives in the city amid heightened scrutiny of undocumented foreign nationals.

Q20. Consider the following statements regarding the Cholanaikkan tribe:

1. They live in rock caves known as Kallulai.
2. Their language belongs to the Dravidian language family.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Recently, members of the Cholanaikkan tribe came out from the forest to receive essential government documents at an event organised by the district administration in Kerala.
- **Cholanaikkans are an ethnic tribal community distributed only in the Nilambur valley of Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve, Western Ghats of Kerala state.**
- The Cholanaikkans (coolanaaykkan) are called the **Cavemen of Kerala.**
- **They live deep in dense forest, mostly in rock caves called Kallulai** (Kallu – rock, aalai – cave), near the banks of streams.
- They speak **the Cholanaikkan language, which is categorised into the Dravidian family by linguistic experts,**

Q21. Which of the following ports has become the first port in India to receive ISO 50001:2018 certification for its Energy Management System?

(a) Chennai Port Authority

(b) Visakhapatnam Port Authority

(c) Cochin Port Authority

(d) V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** The V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority in Thoothukudi has become the first port in the country to be accredited with the ISO 50001:2018 certification for energy management system.
- **This certification marks a significant milestone in the port's commitment to energy efficiency and sustainable port operations.**
- The port became the **first Indian major port to obtain Quality Management System (QMS) certification under ISO 9001 in 1996** and the second to obtain **Environmental Management** System **(EMS) certification under ISO 14001 in 2005.**

Q22. Aadi Perukku, a traditional festival celebrated in Tamil Nadu, is primarily dedicated to:

(a) Lord Murugan, the Tamil God of War

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(b) Goddess Amman, the female deity associated with prosperity and well-being
(c) Lord Shiva, the deity of destruction and transformation
(d) Lord Vishnu, the preserver in the Hindu Trinity
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Aadi Perukku festival celebrated with religious fervour across Tamil Nadu**
- In Tamil Nadu, on the **18th day in the auspicious month of Aadi.**
- It is called Aadi Perukku and is devoted to the **female deity Amman.**
- The festival involves **prayers on river banks for an increase in water**, the basis for agriculture.

Q23. Consider the following statements regarding the Moken people:
1. They follow a seafaring, semi-nomadic lifestyle.
2. They traditionally travel in wooden vessels known as kabang.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Scientists recently confirmed that **Moken sea nomad children living on the Andaman Sea** can see underwater with **twice the clarity of other children, constricting their pupils to dolphin-like precision** through years of ocean training.
- Often called **sea nomads or sea gypsies**, the Moken are seafaring people who have been living off the **coast of Thailand and Myanmar on the Andaman Sea.**
- Their name, in their own language, means "sea drowned."
- The Moken have **lived across the Andaman Sea for centuries**, moving between the **roughly 800 islands that stretch along the coastlines of Myanmar and Thailand.**
- They are one of the last sea nomad peoples in the world.
- Traditionally, **they travel in wooden vessels called kabang,** moving with the seasons and tides.

Q24. Consider the following statements regarding Dahi Handi:
1. Participants known as Govindas form human pyramids to break a suspended earthen pot.
2. The Uttar Pradesh Government has announced efforts to secure a UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage tag for the Dahi Handi festival.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Maharashtra government announced that it will make formal efforts to **secure a UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage tag for the traditional Dahi Handi festival.**
- Dahi Handi (also known as Gopalakala or Utlotsavam) is a **traditional socio-cultural festival and adventure sport celebrated as part of Krishna Janmashtami** (marking the birth of Lord Krishna).
- Teams of participants, known as Govindas, form multi-tier **human pyramids to reach and break an earthen pot (handi) suspended high in the air, filled with curd (dahi), milk, butter, and fruits.**

Q25. Which state government has organised the 'Reel for Soil and Water Conservation' competition across all its districts?
(a) Gujarat
(b) Maharashtra
(c) Madhya Pradesh
(d) Rajasthan
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Maharashtra government has organised a state-level 'Reel for Soil and Water Conservation' competition across all 36 districts to spread awareness about soil and water conservation among young people and the wider public.
- **Youth aged 15 to 30 can participate by uploading 30 to 60-second Instagram reels between August 15 and 19.**

Q26. SAMASTA platform, recently approved by the Karnataka Government, is primarily associated with which sector?
(a) Agriculture
(b) Education
(c) Healthcare
(d) Rural Development
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Karnataka approved the **phased rollout of SAMASTA**, an integrated community

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digital health platform **for digitising health records and replacing manual paper-based record-keeping.**

- The platform is linked with the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and is designed for use at Ayushman Arogya Kendras and Primary Health Centres.**

Q27. Consider the following statements about Kannauj's traditional perfumery:

1. It uses the Deg-Bhapka method of hydro-distillation.
2. Copper vessels are traditionally used in the process.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Kannauj perfume gets GI protection: The centuries-old craft behind the scent**
- For centuries**, Kannauj in Uttar Pradesh has been associated with the art of making traditional fragrances.**
- Kannauj's traditional perfumery is the **deg-bhapka method, a form of hydro-distillation that uses copper vessels to extract and blend fragrances.**

Q28. Consider the following statements regarding the Parichha Weir:

1. It is constructed across the Betwa River.
2. The associated canal system was commissioned in 1886.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The International Commission on Irrigation and Drainage (ICID) designated the **140-year-old Parichha Weir in Jhansi as a World Heritage Irrigation Structure (WHIS)**
- The heritage recognition will be formally presented in France in October during the **26th ICID International Congress and 77th International Executive Council meeting.**
- The structure **is linked to the Betwa Canal system, which irrigates land in Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh.**
- the project go back to **1855, when Captain Strachey proposed a canal system for Bundelkhand after conducting a detailed survey.**
- The canal system **was commissioned in 1886.**

Q29. The "Rang De Basanti" campaign, aimed at engaging Gen Z through poetry and creative expression, was launched in which State?

(a) Bihar
(b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Rajasthan
(d) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** In Uttar Pradesh, a unique initiative to connect with **young people, particularly Gen Z and understand their thoughts through the medium of poetry** has been launched in **Prayagraj.**
- **The "Rang De Basanti" campaign started and will continue in various cities across the state until August 14.**

Q30. The 'Sprite Tejas Express', India's first privately branded, fully air-conditioned corporate superfast train, operates between which two cities?

(a) Lucknow and New Delhi
(b) Kanpur and New Delhi
(c) Lucknow and Mumbai
(d) Varanasi and New Delhi

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Indian Railways and IRCTC awarded **full commercial train-branding rights for the Lucknow–Delhi–Lucknow Tejas Express (Sprite Tejas Express)** to beverage brand Sprite for **six months.**
- The 'Sprite' Tejas Express is **India's first privately branded, fully air-conditioned corporate superfast train operated by the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) featuring full external/internal brand advertising rights.**

Q31. The 8th Meeting of the BRICS Working Group on Ocean and Polar Science and Technology (OPST) is being held in which Indian state?

(a) Kerala
(b) Goa
(c) Tamil Nadu
(d) Odisha

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** As part of India's BRICS Presidency 2026, the **8th Meeting of the BRICS Working Group on Ocean and Polar Science and Technology (OPST) is being held in Goa** from August 12 to 14.
- The meeting is being **hosted by the National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR)** under the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES).

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Q32. The 'Gramin Gyan Setu' app is aimed at interconnecting libraries across which Lok Sabha constituency in Gujarat?

(a) Ahmedabad
(b) Surat
(c) Gandhinagar
(d) Vadodara

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched the '**Gramin Gyan Setu' app, an initiative aimed at interconnecting libraries across the Gandhinagar Lok Sabha constituency of Gujarat** and promoting a **culture of reading among children and young people.**
- the initiative seeks to **establish a library in every village, preferably at a central location near schools**, and provide rural readers access to a much larger pool of books through a **technology-enabled hub-and-spoke model.**

Q33. What is 'Sandhya Kiran', recently approved by the Karnataka Cabinet?

(a) A cashless healthcare scheme for pensioners and their eligible dependents
(b) A pension enhancement scheme for retired government employees
(c) A health insurance scheme for farmers and agricultural workers
(d) A financial assistance scheme for senior citizens

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Karnataka Cabinet approved the **'Sandhya Kiran' cashless healthcare scheme for state pensioners below 70 years, family pensioners and their eligible dependents.**
- The scheme aims to provide **financial and health security to retired employees** and their families and will initially cover State Government pensioners below 70 years and their eligible dependents.

Q34. What is the upper-age relaxation provided to candidates belonging to the first batch of the Agnipath Scheme for recruitment to the specified posts in Delhi?

(a) Three years
(b) Four years
(c) Five years
(d) Seven years

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Delhi Lieutenant Governor (LG) Taranjit Singh Sandhu has **approved a 20% horizontal reservation for former Agniveers in direct recruitment to the post of fire operator in the Delhi Fire Services and to posts of warder and matron in the Prison department.**
- **Age Relaxation**: Former Agniveers will receive an exemption of **three years over** and above the regular upper age limit.
- **First Batch Benefit: Candidates belonging to the very first batch of the Agnipath scheme will get an extended five-year age relaxation.**

Q35. The High Court of Jammu and Kashmir has its existing seats at _____ and _____, with _____ set to become its third location.

(a) Leh, Jammu, Srinagar
(b) Srinagar, Jammu, Ladakh
(c) Jammu, Leh, Srinagar
(d) Srinagar, Leh, Jammu

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Union Cabinet has decided to establish a High Court Bench in Ladakh, a move aimed at improving access to justice in the Union Territory.
- The High Court currently functions from Srinagar and Jammu, and the Ladakh bench will become its third location.

Q36. Consider the following statements regarding Mushk Budji rice:

1. It is a highly aromatic short-grain rice variety, known for its delicate, nutty flavour.
2. It received the Geographical Indication (GI) tag from Bihar.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Kashmir's indigenous aromatic rice variety, 'Mushk Budji',** which was **granted the GI tag three years ago**, is facing the problem of plenty with the government's crop expansion to **"unsuitable" areas hitting prices**, farmers said recently.
- It is a **highly aromatic short-grain rice variety native to Kashmir.**
- It is **usually grown at an altitude ranging from 5000 to 7000 ft** above mean sea level in the Highland Himalayas in the higher reaches of the Kashmir Valley.
- **It has a delicate, nutty flavour.**

Q37. The National Commission for Women (NCW) recently launched the "Yashoda AI" initiative in which city?

(a) Ludhiana
(b) Amritsar
(c) Jalandhar

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(d) Patiala

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** In Punjab, **National Commission for Women (NCW)** launched its "Yashoda AI" initiative in Jalandhar to promote digital empowerment and greater participation of women in emerging technologies.

Q38. India will host the 12th BRICS Environment Ministers Meeting in:

(a) Mumbai
(b) Bengaluru
(c) New Delhi
(d) Hyderabad

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** India will host the twelfth BRICS Environment Ministers Meeting in New Delhi
- The event will be held under the overarching theme of India's BRICS Chairship 2026 **– Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.**
- The BRICS Environment Ministers' Meeting would be presided over by Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Bhupender Yadav.
- The priority areas are **Promoting Sustainable Lifestyles, Afforestation, Forest Fire Management and Disaster Resilience, Circular Economy, and Adaptation.**

Q39. The National Security Strategies Conference has been held annually since:

(a) 2019
(b) 2020
(c) 2021
(d) 2022

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated the **ninth two-day National Security Strategies Conference-2026 in New Delhi**
- To **discuss key national security issues, including detection and deportation of illegal migrants**, a policy framework to **combat cyber crime, and proxy warfare by Pakistan**
- **The National Security Strategies Conference has been held every year since 2021**.

Q40. AIKosh, recently in news, is primarily associated with which of the following?

(a) AI datasets, models and related resources
(b) Semiconductor manufacturing
(c) Digital payment infrastructure
(d) Cybercrime investigation

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: A workshop on the AIKosh platform was organised at the India Habitat Centre, New Delhi**
- It is a **national platform for datasets, AI models and related resources.**
- It aims to enhance access to datasets and models from various **sources to boost AI innovation, support AI solution development with shared toolkits**, and showcase use cases to inspire new applications.

Q41. 'MALHAR 2026' was primarily associated with which form of art?

(a) Indian classical music
(b) Classical dance
(c) Folk theatre
(d) Contemporary art

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Vice President, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, inaugurated 'MALHAR 2026', a youth-centric, monsoon-themed celebration of Indian classical music by Antar Hriday Connect, in New Delhi.

Q42. The 18th BRICS Academic Forum was recently inaugurated in which Indian city?

(a) New Delhi
(b) Bengaluru
(c) Mumbai
(d) Lucknow

Answer: (d)

- Explanation: **18th BRICS Academic Forum started in Lucknow** as part of India's BRICS Presidency.
- The **Observer Research Foundation (ORF),** in partnership with the **Research and Information System for Developing Countries (RIS) and the University of Lucknow, are the convener of the forum.**

Q43. Under the amended provision approved by the Uttar Pradesh Cabinet, eligible women state government employees can avail 180-day maternity leave up to how many times during their entire service period?

(a) Once
(b) Twice
(c) Thrice
(d) Four times

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet approved a proposal to allow **180-day maternity leave to state government women employees, twice during their entire service period (including in cases of adopted children)** without the condition of a two-year gap between the two leaves.

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- **The Maternity Benefit Act, 1961**, is a central law that regulates **maternity leave and related benefits for women employees in India.**

Q44. India's first large-scale biopolymer plant, currently under construction, is located in which state?

(a) Maharashtra
(b) Gujarat
(c) Karnataka
(d) Uttar Pradesh

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** India's first large-scale biopolymer plant is under construction in Lakhimpur Kheri district of Uttar Pradesh and is scheduled for commissioning in October 2026.
- **Biopolymers are polymers derived from renewable biological sources such as plant biomass, starch, or sugar-based feedstock.**
- The plant will **convert locally grown sugarcane into sugar and then into Polylactic Acid, commonly called PLA**, which is a biodegradable thermoplastic used in packaging and disposable products.

Q45. What is the name of the longest-ever freight train operated by the North Eastern Railway (NER)?

(a) Rudrastra
(b) Awadh Mahashakti
(c) Bharat Shakti
(d) Rail Mahashakti

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** North Eastern Railway's longest freight train: North Eastern Railway (NER) has operated its longest-ever freight train**, 'Awadh Mahashakti'.**
- The train**, operated by the Lucknow division**, is aimed at increasing the railway's freight carrying capacity.
- the zonal railway operated the long-haul freight train from Gonda to Sitapur in Uttar Pradesh.
- The train covered a distance of around 160 km in 3 hours and 50 minutes. It was operated at an average speed of 42 kmph.

Q46. Under the amended Uttar Pradesh Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Rules, 2014, complaints regarding neglect or abuse of senior citizens can be submitted to which authority?

(a) District Magistrate
(b) District Judge
(c) Superintendent of Police
(d) Chief Secretary

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet has approved amendments to the **Uttar Pradesh Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Rules, 2014,** strengthening provisions to protect elderly parents from neglect and abuse.
- Under the amended rules, **parents can seek disinheritance of children who fail to provide proper care or subject them to abuse.**
- The procedure has been made **clearer and time-bound, with complaints to be heard within 30 days.**
- **Complaints can be submitted to the District Magistrate (DM),** who will submit a monthly report on such cases to the State Government.

Q47. The 'Youth Brigade Scheme' (Mukhyamantri Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan) has been launched by which state government?

(a) Bihar
(b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Uttar Pradesh
(d) Rajasthan

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath announced the launch of the 'Youth Brigade Scheme' (**Mukhyamantri Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan)** to provide robust support to the state's **younger generation in business and enterprise**.
- To provide significant support to our youth in the realms of employment and business."
- **The proposed Integrated Youth Policy will cover those in the 16-35 age group.**

Q48. Vaishya Tekri, a Buddhist archaeological site, is located in which Indian state?

(a) Rajasthan
(b) Madhya Pradesh
(c) Uttar Pradesh
(d) Bihar

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Madhya Pradesh government has begun **restoring Buddhist monuments linked to the Mauryan emperor Ashoka**, starting with a fresh excavation at Vaishya Tekri.
- In his 2011 paper, Aśoka and Buddhist Nuns: Early Buddhism in Ujjain and Malwa, academic Peter Skilling wrote: "**The largest stupa, popularly called Vaisya Tekri, is about 350 feet at its base and 100 feet high.**
- **Nearby is a smaller stupa, called Kumbhar (or Kumhar) Tekri.**

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Q49. Consider the following statements regarding Dimna Lake:

1. It is an artificial lake located in, Jharkhand.
2. The lake was created by damming the Rapti River.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation**: **Dimna Lake, Jamshedpur's iconic reservoir** and lifeline, was among 25 lakes across the country after which **spectator galleries were named during** the **80th Independence Day celebrations at Delhi's Red Fort.**
- It is an **artificial lake located in the city of Jamshedpur in Jharkhand.**
- It is located in the foothills of the **Dalma mountain range.**
- The lake was created by **damming the Subarnarekha River .**

Q50. Consider the following statements regarding Kolkata:

1. Kolkata celebrates its birthday on **28 August**.
2. **Job Charnock** founded the city in **1690**.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

- Explanation: Kolkata, the capital city of West Bengal, celebrates its birthday on August 24 every year.
- Calcutta, an Anglicized version of the Bengali name Kolikata.
- **British merchant Job Charnock founded the city on August 24, 1690, merging three villages — Gobindapur, Sutanuti and Kolikata.**

Q51. 'Arjun Bahini', recently announced by the West Bengal government, is primarily intended to:

(a) Assist in border security
(b) Conduct counter-terrorism operations
(c) Respond to disasters and emergencies
(d) Provide coastal security

Answer: (c)

- Explanation: The West Bengal government is set to form a **new disaster-response force** called the **"Arjun Bahini" by recruiting the Agniveers to deal with emergencies.**
- The force will become operational in September.
- So far, 200 personnel have been selected through the Sainik Board.
- The force will be equipped with modern machinery, and they will be able to **respond immediately to any kind of disaster.**

Q52. The Kaushal Mahotsav is best described as a:

(a) National-level skill certification examination
(b) Large-scale job fair connecting employers with job seekers
(c) Government-funded vocational training programme
(d) Entrepreneurship development scheme

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** West Bengal hosted its **first Kaushal Mahotsav at Balurghat Stadium in Dakshin Dinajpur district.**
- **Kaushal Mahotsav is a large-scale job fair linked to the Skill India Mission.**
- It **connects employers with job seekers for recruitment, screening, and placement across multiple sectors.**

Q53. The CM-IMPACT Read & Rise programme was launched by which state government?

(a) Assam
(b) Meghalaya
(c) Tripura
(d) Mizoram

Answer: (b)

- Explanation: The Meghalaya government launched the **CM-IMPACT Read & Rise Meghalaya programme** to **improve foundational reading skills and address learning gaps among schoolchildren**.
- The goal is that every child should be able to read and write by the age of seven.

Q54. Consider the following statements regarding the Jojari River:

1. Jojari is a seasonal river originating in Rajasthan.
2. It is the only right-bank tributary of the Luni River.
3. It originates in the Aravalli Mountains.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Jojari River is a seasonal river** which originates in **Pandalu village of Nagaur, Rajasthan.**
- Course: It passes **through Jodhpur and merges with the Luni River near Balotra city.**
- It is the **only right-bank tributary of the Luni River**.

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- It is the only branch of the Luni River **which does not come from the Aravalli Mountains.**

Q55. Maharashtra recently declared snakebite as a:
(a) Communicable disease
(b) Notifiable disease
(c) Occupational disease
(d) Water-borne disease
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Maharashtra declared **snakebite a notifiable disease** under the state public health framework.
- A notifiable disease is a disease that **health authorities require medical institutions to report to the government.**

Q56. The newly re-developed Hutatma Smruti Smarak at Patradevi is associated with which of the following?
(a) Goa's liberation struggle from Portuguese rule
(b) The Quit India Movement
(c) The Civil Disobedience Movement
(d) The Revolt of 1857
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh, inaugurated the newly re-developed **Hutatma Smruti Smarak at Patradevi, a historic site associated with the state's liberation struggle from Portuguese rule.**
- On August 15, 1955, thousands of volunteers from across **India participated in a peaceful satyagraha in Goa**

Q57. The 'Carbon Pathshala' workshop was primarily focused on:
(a) Carbon taxation for industries
(b) Voluntary Carbon Market (VCM) for farmers
(c) Carbon trading in the energy sector
(d) Forest conservation policies
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The ICAR–Central Coastal Agricultural Research Institute (ICAR-CCARI), Goa**, in collaboration **with Core CarbonX Solutions Pvt. Ltd., Hyderabad.**
- Organised a **one-day workshop on 'Carbon Pathshala**: Voluntary Carbon Market (VCM) for Farmers' at ICAR-KVK, Old Goa, on August 21.
- the programme aimed **to familiarise farmers with carbon markets, carbon sequestration and the potential of biochar-based carbon credits.**

Q58. Consider the following statements regarding Medak Fort:
1. The fort was exclusively used by the Kakatiyas and never came under any later dynasty.
2. The main entrance features the double-headed Gandabherundam emblem associated with the Vijayanagara Empire.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The postal department launched a postal cover and a postal stamp on the historical Medak fort**
- It is a historic hill fort located in Medak town, Telangana.
- The **fort was built during the 12th century** under the reign of the **Kakatiya ruler, Pratapa Rudra**, and it was initially called **'MethukuDurgam' in Telugu.**
- It has three main entrances, namely the "**Prathama Dwaram**", the "**SimhaDwaram"** which features two snarling lions at the top of these entrances while the "**GajaDwaram**", or the Elephant's Entrance features a sculpture where two elephants are majestically interlocked on both sides of this entrance.
- The main entrance features the double-headed **"Gandabherundam", the emblem of Vijayanagara Empire** built by the great ruler Srikrishna Devaraya.
- The fort also has a 17th-century mosque on its premises built by the Qutub Shahis, as well as granaries

Q59. Reliance Industries Limited has proposed India's first integrated Underground Coal Gasification (UCG) complex in which district?
(a) Kurnool
(b) Eluru
(c) Visakhapatnam
(d) Anantapur
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Reliance Industries Limited** has proposed an investment of about ₹2.73 lakh crore over 30 years for **India's first integrated Underground Coal Gasification (UCG) complex in Eluru district, Andhra Pradesh.**
- Underground Coal Gasification is an in-situ process that **converts coal into synthesis gas, or syngas, without conventional mining.**

Q60. The National Conclave on Tribal Languages & Museums was held in:
(a) Ranchi, Jharkhand
(b) Mysuru, Karnataka
(c) Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh

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(d) Guwahati, Assam

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs began the three-day National Conclave on Tribal Languages & Museums in Mysuru, Karnataka in which a full-fledged **Adi Vaani Platform was launched.**
- Adi Vaani Platform is **India's first AI-powered translator for tribal languages.**

Q61. The India International Coffee Festival (IICF) 2027 is scheduled to be held during:

(a) February 20–22, 2027
(b) February 24–26, 2027
(c) February 26–28, 2027
(d) March 1–3, 2027

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The third edition of the India International Coffee Festival (IICF) 2027 will be held in Bengaluru from February 26–28, 2027.
- Organised by the **Coffee Board of India** in association with the Specialty Coffee Association of India (SCAI).

Q62. What is 'Uthrada Paachil' associated with during the Onam celebrations in Kerala?

(a) Traditional boat races
(b) Final shopping and preparations
(c) Temple procession
(d) Harvesting of rice

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Kerala is celebrating **Uthradam**, the penultimate day of the ten-day Onam festival, as the state prepares to welcome Thiru Onam.
- Known **widely as First Onam,** Uthradam marks the auspicious day when the **spirit of the righteous Asura King Mahabali is believed to arrive in Kerala.**
- The traditional Uthrada Paachil has brought markets and shopping centres across the state to life, with people making their final purchases for the celebrations.
- **Homes are being decorated with colourful Ona Pookkalams,** while preparations are underway for the traditional Ona Sadya to be served.

Q63. Consider the following statements about the Tamirabharani River:

1. It flows through both Tamil Nadu and Kerala.
2. It drains into the Gulf of Mannar.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the **Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court** has declared **Tamil Nadu's Tamirabharani (Porunai) river a deity and granted it legal personhood** to curb pollution.
- It is a perennial river of southern India flowing entirely within Tamil Nadu.
- It originates from the Agastyarkoodam peak of Pothigai hills of the Western Ghats.
- It drains into the Gulf of Mannar.

Q64. Which state government announced the Annapoorani Super Six Scheme for domestic LPG cylinder reimbursement?

(a) Kerala
(b) Andhra Pradesh
(c) Karnataka
(d) Tamil Nadu

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Tamil Nadu announced the **Annapoorani Super Six Scheme in the State Assembly for domestic LPG cylinder reimbursement to eligible families**.
- The scheme provides reimbursement for domestic LPG cylinders after purchase, and the subsidy is credited directly to the bank accounts of beneficiaries.
- The government fixed eligibility for families with annual income below ₹2.5 lakh, middle farmers, marginal farmers, and families of persons with disabilities.

Q65. Madras Day is observed every year on which date?

(a) August 15
(b) August 20
(c) August 22
(d) August 23

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Madras Day 2026 is observed every year on August 22 to commemorate the founding of Madras, now Chennai.
- The occasion marks the **1639 grant through which the East India Company acquired land at Madraspatnam from local rulers.**

Q66. The 31st meeting of the Southern Zonal Council (SZC) was held in which state?

(a) Tamil Nadu
(b) Kerala
(c) Karnataka
(d) Andhra Pradesh

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Union Home Minister Amit Shah chaired the 31st Southern Zonal Council (SZC)**

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meeting on August 20, 2026, in Mahabalipuram, Tamil Nadu.

- **Zonal Councils are high-level statutory deliberative bodies** created to promote **interstate cooperation, resolve disputes**, and ensure coordinated socioeconomic planning among States and Union Territories grouped into distinct geographic zones.
- **Established In: 1956.**

Q67. The Tamil Nadu government has extended maternity leave for the birth of a third child from 12 weeks to:

(a) 180 days
(b) 240 days
(c) 300 days
(d) 365 days

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** The Tamil Nadu government on Tuesday announced extending the **maternity leave for its women employees for the birth of their third child from 12 weeks to 365 days**, the same duration that they get for the first two children.
- Currently, married women government employees with fewer than **two surviving children are granted 365 days of maternity leave,** while those with two or more surviving children receive up to 12 weeks of maternity leave.

Q68. "Euphoria – An Evening to Celebrate Culture" was recently organised by which Union Territory?

(a) Ladakh
(b) Delhi
(c) Jammu and Kashmir
(d) Chandigarh

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Jammu Smart City Limited (JSCL)** recently hosted a massive cultural event titled **"Euphoria – An Evening to Celebrate Culture"** at the newly inaugurated **Tawi Wonderland Park** in Bhagwati Nagar, Jammu.
- Organised by Jammu Smart City Limited.

Q69. Which State government is set to introduce 'Janatar Darbar' (Public Hearing) for quicker redressal of public grievances?

(a) Odisha
(b) Bihar
(c) West Bengal
(d) Assam

Answer: (c)

Explanation: West Bengal government is all set to introduce **'Janatar Darbar' (Public Hearing) at government offices to ensure quicker redressal of public grievances.**

Defence

Q1. Exercise Talisman Sabre is a major multinational military exercise led by:

(a) India and Japan
(b) Australia and the United States
(c) United States and Japan
(d) Australia and India

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Exercise Talisman Sabre 2027 is scheduled from 9 August 2027 to 22 August 2027.
- **Exercise Talisman Sabre is a major military exercise led by Australia and the United States.**
- Significantly, **India will participate in the Exercise Talisman Sabre 2027.**

Q2. The Indian Navy and U.S. Navy have been conducting joint Salvage and Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD) exercises since:

(a) 1998
(b) 2001
(c) 2005
(d) 2010

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The **Indian Navy–U.S. Navy Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD) Exercise 2026** will be held at the Southern Naval Command here from August 10 to 14.
- **The Indian Navy and the U.S. Navy have been conducting joint salvage and EOD exercises since 2005.**

Q3. Recently, which airport became the first in India to operationalise the Required Navigation Performance–Category H (RNP CAT H) helicopter approach procedure?

(a) Kempegowda International Airport
(b) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited Airport
(c) Rajiv Gandhi International Airport
(d) Cochin International Airport

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) airport in Bengaluru** has become the first airport in India to operationalise the **Required Navigation Performance – Category H** (RNP CAT H) helicopter approach procedure.
- RNP CAT H helicopter approach procedure is a satellite-guided precision navigation system designed exclusively for helicopters.
- **Developed by the Airports Authority of India (AAI).**

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Q4. Agni-4, recently seen in the news, has a maximum strike range of approximately:
(a) 1,500 km
(b) 2,000 km
(c) 3,000 km
(d) 4,000 km
Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Recently, Agni-4' was successfully test-fired from the Integrated Test Range, Chandipur in Odisha.
- It is **an indigenously developed Medium-Range Ballistic Missile (MRBM).**
- It is developed by the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).**
- It is capable of striking targets at a **range of up to 4,000 kilometres.**

Q5. Who became the first woman pilot in India to successfully clear the Fighter Combat Leader (FCL) course?
(a) Avani Chaturvedi
(b) Mohana Singh
(c) Shivangi Singh
(d) Bhawana Kanth
Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Indian Air Force Squadron Leader **Bhawana Kanth became the first woman pilot in India to clear the Fighter Combat Leader (FCL) course**
- She **completed the course at the Tactics and Air Combat Development Establishment (TACDE) in Gwalior,** which trains selected IAF pilots in air combat tactics and leadership

Q6. What was Operation Gibraltar?
(a) A Pakistani infiltration operation in J&K
(b) An Indian counter-insurgency operation
(c) A Pakistani naval operation
(d) An Indian military operation in Punjab
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Operation Gibraltar was a covert military operation launched by Pakistan in August 1965 to infiltrate Jammu & Kashmir and incite a popular uprising against India.
- The operation was named after the Muslim conquest of Spain in 711 AD, led by a small force that crossed the Strait of Gibraltar.

Q7. DSC A24 (Yard 329) was launched at the:
(a) Cochin Shipyard, Kochi
(b) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders, Mumbai
(c) Titagarh Shipyard, Kolkata
(d) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers, Kolkata
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** DSC A24 (Yard 329)—the fifth and final ship of the Diving Support Craft (DSC) project—was launched at the **Titagarh shipyard in Kolkata (West Bengal).**
- DSC A24 (Yard 329) is a specialized catamaran-hulled naval vessel built to perform underwater diving support, salvage operations, and coastal deployments.
- **Manufacturer / Shipbuilder: M/s Titagarh Rail Systems Limited (TRSL) / Titagarh Naval Systems Limited, Kolkata.**

Q8. Xtreme Weather Grade (XWG) Diesel is:
(a) A biofuel developed for civilian transport
(b) A specialised diesel fuel designed for extreme cold conditions
(c) A high-performance aviation fuel developed by ISRO
(d) A renewable energy fuel for naval vessels
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** General Dhiraj Seth, Chief of the Army Staff (COAS), launched the indigenously developed **Xtreme Weather Grade (XWG) Diesel in New Delhi.**
- Developed jointly by the **Indian Army and Oil Marketing Companies,** the specialised fuel will enhance the mobility, safety and operational availability of combat and logistics **vehicles in extreme climatic conditions.**
- Conventional diesel can thicken and clog fuel filters at very low temperatures, affecting the operation of vehicles in high-altitude and snow-bound areas.
- XWG Diesel overcomes this challenge and remains effective at **temperatures as low as minus 42 degrees Celsius.**

Q9. INS Nipun, recently delivered to the Indian Navy, is a:
(a) Guided Missile Destroyer
(b) Offshore Patrol Vessel
(c) Aircraft Carrier
(d) Diving Support Vessel
Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the INS Nipun was delivered to the Indian Navy at Visakhapatnam.
- It is the **second Diving Support Vessel (DSV) built by Hindustan Shipyard Limited.**
- 'Nipun' draws her name from Sanskrit signifying 'one who is adept, capable, and well versed in a particular discipline'.

Q10. Exercise ROTOR CLAP III is conducted by which of the following forces?
(a) Indian Army
(b) Indian Navy
(c) Border Security Force
(d) Indian Air Force
Answer: (d)

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- **Explanation:** The Indian Air Force (IAF) recently concluded the week-long **Exercise ROTOR CLAP III at the Pokhran Field Firing Range in Rajasthan's Jaisalmer district.**
- It is a specialised helicopter exercise themed "Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems (Counter-UAS)" conducted by the Indian Air Force (IAF).
- It is the third edition of a series the IAF has built around rotary-wing counter-drone work.

Q11. The fourth edition of the Tri-Services Future Warfare Course will commence in which city?

(a) Mumbai
(b) New Delhi
(c) Hyderabad
(d) Bengaluru

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The fourth edition of the Tri-Services Future Warfare Course will commence in New Delhi.
- **The four-week course** is being conducted under the aegis of the **Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff and coordinated by the Centre for Joint Warfare Studies.**

Q12. The Kh-101 missile has been developed by which country?

(a) Russia
(b) China
(c) United States
(d) France

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** A Russian Kh-101 missile landed in eastern Poland recently, creating security tensions on NATO's eastern flank.
- **The Kh-101 (NATO: AS-23A Kodiak) is a Russian-made advanced stealthy long-range subsonic cruise missile that is launched from a strategic bomber**.

Q13. Operation Trishul, recently seen in the news, is primarily associated with:

(a) Counter-piracy operations in the Indian Ocean
(b) Tracking and extradition of fugitives from abroad
(c) Disaster relief operations in South Asia
(d) Counter-insurgency operations in Northeast India

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Operation Trishul is an Indian fugitive-tracking and extradition initiative linked to the return of 274 fugitives from 36 countries since 2019.
- The fugitives were wanted in cases involving **terrorism, organised crime, narco-terrorism, sexual offences, financial fraud, murder, and human trafficking.**
- Operation Trishul uses satellite imagery, surveillance inputs, and digital footprints to locate fugitives who change names or identities abroad.

Q14. Indian Army Chief General Dhiraj Seth was recently conferred which honorary rank by Nepal?

(a) Field Marshal of the Nepali Army
(b) Honorary Rank of General of the Nepali Army
(c) Honorary Marshal of Nepal
(d) Honorary Chief of the Nepali Army

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Indian Army Chief General Dhiraj Seth was conferred the **Honorary Rank of General of the Nepali Army** by Nepal President Ram Chandra Paudel on **17 August 2026** at Sheetal Niwas, Kathmandu.
- He is on a **three-day official visit to Nepal from August 17–19**, at the invitation of Nepali Army Chief General Ashok Raj Sigdel.

Q15. Exercise MAITREE-XV is a bilateral military exercise between India and:

(a) Vietnam
(b) Thailand
(c) Indonesia
(d) Malaysia

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The 15th edition of the India-Thailand bilateral military exercise, MAITREE-XV, is scheduled from 18 August to 31 August 2026 at **Vibhavadi Rangsit Camp in Surat Thani, Thailand.**
- **Exercise Maitree is a bilateral army exercise between India and Thailand that began in 2006.**

Q16. Exercise 'Pitch Black', in which the Indian Air Force recently participated, is hosted by which country?

(a) India
(b) Australia
(c) United States
(d) United Kingdom

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: The Indian Air Force (IAF)** recently said its contingent at the **multi-nation exercise 'Pitch Black' in Australia** had "accomplished the mission" and "mastered" the skies, while several partnerships were "strengthened".
- **It is a biennial and multinational exercise hosted by the Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF).**

Q17. Which country is hosting the bilateral air exercise Udara Shakti 2026?

(a) India
(b) Singapore
(c) Indonesia
(d) Malaysia

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: The Indian Air Force (IAF)** and the **Royal Malaysian Air Force (RMAF)** commenced the **bilateral air exercise Udara Shakti 2026** on 10 August 2026.

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- Udara Shakti is a bilateral air exercise between India and Malaysia.
- **The five-day exercise** is scheduled to continue until 14 August 2026 at **Subang Air Base in Malaysia.**

Q18. The name 'Shruti' given to the Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV) is derived from which of the following?

(a) Four Vedas
(b) Six Vedangas
(c) Eighteen Puranas
(d) Four Upanishads

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Recently the **Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel** (NGOPV) **Shruti** was launched at **M/s GRSE, Kolkata**.
- Construction by: The construction of NGOPVs is concurrently being undertaken **at two shipyards — Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) and Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Ltd (GRSE), Kolkata.**

These ships derive their name from India's rich heritage, with this ship being **named as 'Shruti', referring to four Vedas.**

Q19. 'Aravalli', recently in the news, is associated with which of the following?

(a) A domestically developed radar system
(b) A high-power helicopter engine
(c) A naval propulsion system
(d) An air-defence missile

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** State-owned **Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) and France's Safran Helicopter Engines** have signed a deal to jointly develop a new **high-power engine for India's next-generation helicopters, Called 'Aravalli'**
- The **engine will power the 13-tonne Indian Multi-Role Helicopter** (IMRH) and its **12.5-ton naval version,** the Deck-Based Multi-Role Helicopter (DBMRH).
- This marks the first instance of a high-power helicopter engine being designed and developed in India

Q20. Vehicle Factory Jabalpur (VFJ) operates under which of the following organisations?

(a) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)
(b) Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)
(c) Armoured Vehicles Nigam Limited (AVNL)
(d) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Defence Minister Rajnath Singh laid the **foundation stone of a Rs 472-crore facility for the overhaul of T-series battle tanks at Vehicle Factory Jabalpur (VFJ),** an ordnance unit in Madhya Pradesh.
- VFJ is a premier military vehicle manufacturing unit **operating under Armoured Vehicles Nigam Limited and the Ministry of Defence.**
- The project is expected to boost self-reliance in the maintenance and production of defence equipment.

Q21. The "Eagles of Civilisation 2026" joint air exercise is being conducted between the air forces of which two countries?

(a) Egypt and China
(b) India and Russia
(c) China and France
(d) Egypt and India

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The **"Eagles of Civilisation 2026"** joint air exercise began between the Egyptian Air Force and the People's Liberation Army Air Force in August 2026 in Egypt
- The exercise was the **second bilateral air drill between Egypt and China.**
- The **J-16 and the Dassault Rafale** are taking part in this year's Eagles of Civilization joint air exercise

Q22. Which organisation delivered the third Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft, Mangrol, to the Indian Navy?

(a) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
(b) Hindustan Shipyard Limited
(c) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
(d) Cochin Shipyard Limited

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: Kochi-based Cochin Shipyard** Limited has delivered the **third Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft, Mangrol**, to the Indian Navy.
- The warship has been named 'Mangrol' after the historic and strategically significant **coastal township of Mangrol in Gujarat's Surat district.**
- Mangrol is a 78-metre vessel powered by a Diesel Engine-Waterjet Propulsion system.

Q23. Divyastra Mk3, recently in the news, is best described as which of the following?

(a) An unmanned surveillance aircraft
(b) An indigenous loitering munition
(c) A surface-to-air missile
(d) An electronic warfare system

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Kawa UAV Pvt. Ltd., a defence start-up** based in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, announced that it successfully conducted **a maiden flight test of the Divyastra Mk3.**

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- It is an **indigenous loitering munition (kamikaze drone or suicide drone).**
- It is designed to destroy high-value enemy assets, infrastructure, and personnel in a warzone by striking the target directly with an onboard explosive warhead.

Q24. The Indian Army organised 'Adab Aur Saqafat – Literary Festival 2026' in which region?

(a) Leh
(b) Kargil
(c) Nubra
(d) Zanskar

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** In Ladakh, Indian Army organised the '**Adab Aur Saqafat – Literary Festival 2026**' in Kargil to **celebrate the rich literary heritage**, cultural traditions and artistic spirit of Ladakh under the theme **"Celebrating the Culture of Ladakh Highland" at GDC Kargil.**
- The festival witnessed participation from Army officers, college faculty members, students, poets, writers and literature enthusiasts from different parts of Kargil.

Q25. Which of the following best describes the AK-203 'Sher'?

(a) Gas-operated, magazine-fed assault rifle
(b) Bolt-action sniper rifle
(c) Recoil-operated machine gun
(d) Semi-automatic carbine

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** India has manufactured and tested a prototype of the 100 per cent indigenised AK-203 'Sher' rifle, with army trials for the weapon to begin in September this year.
- **The rifles are manufactured by the Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited, a joint-venture of the Indian Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs), along with Concern Kalashnikov and Rosoboron export from Russia.**
- The AK-203 is a gas-operated, magazine-fed assault rifle chambered for the **7.62x39 mm cartridge** and belongs to the **Kalashnikov AK-100 series.**

Q26. The MQ-9B Sea Guardian is classified as which type of system?

(a) Medium-Altitude Long-Endurance (MALE) fighter aircraft
(b) High-Altitude Long-Endurance (HALE) Remotely Piloted Aircraft System
(c) Short-Range Unmanned Combat Aerial Vehicle
(d) Hypersonic reconnaissance aircraft

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Ministry of Defence inked a Rs 1,943-crore contract **with American defence major General Atomics Aeronautical** to lease **two MQ-9B Sea Guardian High-Altitude Long-Endurance (HALE) Remotely Piloted Aircraft Systems (RPAS)** for the Indian Navy for 30 months.
- The MQ-9B Sea Guardian HALE RPAS, equipped with advanced systems, state-of-the-art sensors and sophisticated payloads, will significantly enhance the Indian Navy's Maritime Domain Awareness capabilities.

Q27. The term 'KN-30', recently mentioned in the news, is associated with which of the following?

(a) A Russian cruise missile
(b) A Chinese air-defence system
(c) A North Korean ballistic missile
(d) A Ukrainian anti-tank missile

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Russia recently received **North Korea's KN-30 ballistic missile** for the first time, according to Ukraine's defence intelligence directorate (HUR).
- **The KN-30 is the Western designation for the North Korean Hwasong-11C ballistic missile, also known as the Hwasong-11Da.**

Q28. The ICGS Ajit, recently handed over to the Indian Coast Guard, was built by which organisation?

(a) Cochin Shipyard Limited
(b) Goa Shipyard Limited
(c) Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers
(d) Hindustan Shipyard Limited

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) has handed over the **ICGS Ajit** to the Indian Coast Guard.
- **It is an indigenously built Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs).**
- **Built By: It is built by the Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL).**

Q29. 'Aparajita – Parang La 2026' is a flagship adventure activity of which organisation?

(a) Bharat Scouts and Guides
(b) National Cadet Corps
(c) Border Security Force
(d) Nehru Yuva Kendra Sangathan

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh flagged-off the All India Girls High Altitude Long Trek **'Aparajita - Parang La 2026', a flagship adventure activity of the National Cadet Corps (NCC).**

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- The trek will traverse the Parang La Pass (5,578 metres, 18,300 feet), **connecting the Spiti Valley of Himachal Pradesh with the Changthang region of Ladakh**

Q30. Which company constructed 'Samarthak' for the Indian Navy?

(a) Cochin Shipyard Limited
(b) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited
(c) Larsen & Toubro Limited
(d) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Samarthak**, the first indigenously designed and constructed **Multi-Purpose Vessel (MPV)** built by **Larsen & Toubro (L&T)** at its Kattupalli shipyard, was formally delivered to the Indian Navy.
- Samarthak is the lead ship of the Indian Navy's new class of Multi-Purpose Vessels (MPVs).

Science & Technology

Q1. The recent spacewalk by NASA astronauts Jessica Meir and Anil Menon was the _____ spacewalk in support of the International Space Station (ISS).

(a) 250th
(b) 265th
(c) 281st
(d) 300th

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** NASA astronauts **Jessica Meir** and **Anil Menon** began a spacewalk outside the **International Space Station** to prepare the **3B power channel for the future installation of new roll-out solar arrays.**
- It marked **the 281st spacewalk conducted in support of the space station, Meir's sixth and Menon's first.**
- The **spacewalk lasts six hours and 27 minutes.**

Q2. Which Indian institution has been designated as the Indian shareholder in FAIR GmbH and the nodal institution for implementing the FAIR programme in India?

(a) Tata Institute of Fundamental Research
(b) Bose Institute, Kolkata
(c) Indian Institute of Science
(d) Saha Institute of Nuclear Physics

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the **first of three units of beam catcher equipment, an integral part of the beam line, has reached the International Mega Science Project, Facility for Antiproton and Ion Research (FAIR) site**.
- It is a large multipurpose particle accelerator facility being built at Darmstadt, Germany.
- **Bose institute, Kolkata has been designated as the Indian shareholder** in the FAIR GmbH and the nodal Indian Institution for the implementation of FAIR programme in India.

Q3. EVEREST, India's first privately built 80-tonne-class FFSC rocket engine, is primarily designed to power:

(a) Small satellite launch vehicles
(b) Reusable medium-lift launch vehicles
(c) Heavy-lift space launch vehicles
(d) Suborbital sounding rockets

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Bengaluru-based Astrobase Space Technologies unveiled EVEREST as India's first privately built 80-tonne-class Full-Flow Staged Combustion rocket engine.
- India has become the fourth nation to have FFSC engine technology after Russia, the U.S., and China.
- The engine uses liquid oxygen and liquid methane, produces 800 kilonewtons of thrust, and is designed for reusable medium-lift launch vehicles.

Q4. Which of the following best describes the Artemis Accords?

(a) A legally binding space treaty
(b) A non-binding set of principles for civil space exploration
(c) A military alliance for space security
(d) A UN convention on space exploration

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** India and the United States are set to strengthen their cooperation in space exploration, with **NASA inviting ISRO to join its ambitious Moon Base program, building on the two countries' partnership under the Artemis Accords.**
- **Artemis Accord** was launched **in 2020.**
- The Artemis Accords are a **non-binding set of principles designed to guide civil space exploration.**

Q5. Consider the following statements regarding Chandipura virus (CHPV):

1. Most outbreaks in India have occurred during the winter season.
2. A WHO-approved vaccine is available for its prevention.
3. It is primarily transmitted through the bite of infected sand flies.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 3 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Chandipura virus (CHPV) is an arbovirus in the genus Vesiculovirus that spreads

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mainly through **sandflies and can cause acute encephalitis.**

- Most reported outbreaks have occurred in **western and central India, particularly during the rainy season.**
- It is **vector-borne and primarily spread through the bite of infected sand flies, which are tiny blood-feeding insects.**
- There is **currently no specific antiviral medicine or vaccine to treat the infection.**

Q6. The variety 'Asha', recently seen in the news for becoming India's first fully annotated telomere-to-telomere (T2T) reference genome developed by ICAR, belongs to which of the following crops?

(a) Pigeonpea
(b) Chickpea
(c) Soybean
(d) Black gram

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) developed India's first fully annotated telomere-to-telomere (T2T) reference genome of pigeonpea variety 'Asha'.
- The genome assembly, designated NIPB_CcT2T_4, was released on 20 April 2026 and is available in the National Center for Biotechnology Information database under accession number GCF_000230855.1.

Q7. The recently discovered system in the Magellanic Bridge was identified using the:

(a) James Webb Space Telescope
(b) Hubble Space Telescope
(c) eROSITA X-ray Telescope
(d) Chandra X-ray Observatory

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** A team led by **Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics (IUCAA)** team has discovered the first known system of its kind in the **Magellanic Bridge by using eROSITA X-ray telescope.**
- Magellanic Bridge is a **stream of stars and gas created by the close encounter of two nearby galaxies**, the Large and Small Magellanic Clouds.
- It is mainly a **gaseous feature connecting the two galaxies**, with a small fraction of in situ formed young stars.

Q8. PowerBank-50, recently seen in the news, is a:

(a) Compact lithium-ion battery pack designed for small satellites
(b) Reusable propulsion module for launch vehicles
(c) Indigenous navigation payload for Low Earth Orbit satellites
(d) Solar power generation system for space stations

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Hyderabad-based space startup **TakeMe2Space** recently announced that **its PowerBank-50 satellite battery pack has now earned the 'flight heritage' tag.**
- It is an indigenously built satellite battery pack developed by Hyderabad-based spacetech startup TakeMe2Space.
- It is a compact **lithium-ion battery pack designed specifically for small satellites.**

Q9. Alanine Aminotransferase (ALT) is primarily associated with which organ of the human body?

(a) Heart
(b) Kidney
(c) Liver
(d) Brain

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Union Health Ministry has urged people to monitor alanine aminotransferase (ALT) levels as an early indicator of liver injury.
- It is also known as **serum glutamic-pyruvic transaminase (SGPT), is** an enzyme found predominantly inside liver cells.
- It is also found in other tissues such as the kidneys, heart, and muscle cells.
- **It plays a crucial role in metabolism, turning food into energy.**

Q10. Which institution has developed India's first indigenous MA-104 Cell Line-Based Live Attenuated African Swine Fever (ASF) vaccine for pigs?

(a) Indian Veterinary Research Institute (IVRI), Bareilly
(b) ICAR–National Institute of High Security Animal Diseases (ICAR-NIHSAD), Bhopal
(c) National Dairy Research Institute (NDRI), Karnal
(d) National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC)

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: ICAR–National Institute of High Security Animal Diseases (ICAR-NIHSAD), Bhopal,** have developed **India's first indigenous MA-104_Cell_Line-Based Live Attenuated African Swine Fever (ASF) Vaccine for pigs.**
- Developed using a novel attenuated ASFV Genotype II virus with unique gene deletions in the MA-104 cell line, the vaccine is a major breakthrough in veterinary research and is well suited for large-scale production.
- At present, **only a couple of commercially licensed ASF vaccines are available in Vietnam.**

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Q11. Recently, the International Agency for Research on Cancer (IARC) classified which of the following medicines as "Carcinogenic to Humans" (Group 1)?

1. Hydrochlorothiazide
2. Voriconazole
3. Tacrolimus

Select the correct answer using the code below:

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Three widely-prescribed medicines used to treat high blood pressure, fungal infections, and organ transplant rejection have been classified as "carcinogenic to humans" (Group 1) by the International Agency for Research on Cancer (IARC), the World Health Organisation's (WHO) cancer research agency.
- The three medicines — **hydrochlorothiazide (hypertension), voriconazole (fungal infections), and tacrolimus (an immunosuppressant preventing transplant rejection)** — are on the WHO Model List of Essential Medicines, prescribed to millions worldwide.

Q12. Which one of the following crops was recently harvested in low Earth orbit (LEO) aboard China's Tiangong Space Station?

(a) Wheat
(b) Rice
(c) Maize
(d) Soybean

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Chinese astronauts aboard the Tiangong space station harvested the first batch of rice grown in orbit.
- The harvest formed part of the Shenzhou-23 mission, which launched on 24 May 2026, and the rice samples were collected for further scientific study.
- Tiangong is China's modular space station, and it has supported long-duration human missions and biological experiments in low Earth orbit.

Q13. Consider the following statements regarding the Hexavalent (Six-in-One) Vaccine:

1. It combines six different antigens in a single vaccine formulation.
2. It is intended for infant immunisation.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Introducing the hexavalent (six-in-one) vaccine into India's Universal Immunisation Programme (UIP) could improve the efficiency of the country's childhood immunisation programme,** according to a recent study conducted by the Union Health Ministry.
- It is a **combination vaccine that protects infants against six different diseases with a single injection.**
- The hexavalent vaccine protects against: **Diphtheria, Tetanus, Pertussis (Whooping Cough), Hepatitis B, Polio, Haemophilus influenzae type b (Hib) infections.**

Q14. What is VIHAAN, recently developed by Aheesa Digital Innovations?

(a) India's first domestically designed broadband networking System-on-Chip (SoC)
(b) India's first indigenous artificial intelligence processor
(c) India's first domestically developed 5G smartphone chipset
(d) India's first quantum computing processor

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Chennai-based fabless semiconductor startup **Aheesa Digital Innovations, supported under the Ministry of Electronics and IT's (MeitY) Design Linked Incentive (DLI) Scheme**, achieved first-pass silicon success for its indigenous **broadband networking System-on-Chip (SoC) named 'VIHAAN'.**
- **VIHAAN is India's first domestically designed broadband networking System-on-Chip (SoC).**

Q15. What was the primary mission of Voyager 2?

(a) Study the Sun and solar flares
(b) Study the outer planets and their moons
(c) Search for exoplanets
(d) Study Earth's atmosphere

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Voyager 2** is an unmanned space probe launched by NASA in 1977.
- Primary mission: Its mission was to **study the outer planets of our solar system, including Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune and their moons,** and then continue on an interstellar mission.

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- **It is the only spacecraft to have ever visited Uranus and Neptune.**

Q16. What is the key significance of SraVaani in the context of Indian language technology?

(a) It focuses only on improving speech recognition for widely spoken Indian languages
(b) It expands automatic speech recognition to several regional and non-scheduled Indian languages
(c) It replaces existing Indian language translation systems
(d) It standardises all Indian languages under a common linguistic framework

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Researchers at **IISc's SPIRE Lab, in collaboration with ARTPARK and Google, have released SraVaani**, the **first multilingual Indian speech recognition model** trained on 65 Indian languages and dialects, including over 40 languages that today's speech recognition systems do not officially support.
- **SraVaani extends automatic speech recognition to several regional and non-scheduled Indian languages.**

Q17. The 'GARUD' high-resolution binoculars were launched by which organisation?

(a) Bharat Electronics Limited
(b) India Optel Limited
(c) Hindustan Aeronautics Limited
(d) Bharat Dynamics Limited

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: India Optel Limited (IOL), a Mini Ratna** Category-I Defence Public Sector Undertaking (DPSU), officially **launched the indigenous 'GARUD' High Resolution Binoculars for the civil market** at DPSU Bhawan, New Delhi.
- GARUD is an **indigenous, defense-grade high-resolution binocular platform adapted for civilian use.**

Q18. Consider the following statements regarding Pusa Rice DST1:

1. Its genome edit targets the Drought and Salt Tolerance (DST) gene.
2. It is specifically suited for cultivation during the kharif season in northern India.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: Pusa DST Rice 1**
- It is derived from **MTU1010, which is suitable for rabi season in southern states.**
- It is developed by **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)-Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI),** New Delhi.
- The edit in its genome targets the **Drought and Salt Tolerance (DST) gene,** with the aim of improving the plant's ability to **cope with drought and salt-affected soils.**
- It is expected to be grown in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal.

Q19. S301, recently identified as the fastest-moving star on a secure orbit, is located in which galaxy?

(a) Andromeda Galaxy
(b) Triangulum Galaxy
(c) Milky Way Galaxy
(d) Sombrero Galaxy

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** S301 is a star in the Milky Way galaxy that has been identified as the fastest-moving star recorded on a secure orbit.
- **S301 reaches a maximum speed of about 15,500 miles per second, or 25,000 kilometres per second.**
- The discovery used the **European Southern Observatory's Very Large Telescope Interferometer at the Paranal Observatory in Chile**

Q20. GJ 523b, recently in the news, is best described as which of the following?

(a) A newly discovered asteroid
(b) A rogue planet
(c) A potentially habitable moon
(d) A "mega-Earth" exoplanet

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: GJ 523b** is an exoplanet **identified as a "mega-Earth" with a radius about 2.55 times that of Earth** and a mass of 23.5 Earth masses.
- **It orbits a mid-K dwarf star** and has an estimated bulk density of about 7.8 grams per cubic centimetre.
- It is the **first exoplanet discovered** and cataloged by researchers **with the Wisconsin Center for Origins Research (WiCOR),**

Q21. Consider the following statements regarding GISAT-1A (EOS-05):

1. It is a Geo-Imaging Satellite designed to operate from Low Earth Orbit.
2. It is capable of capturing images of the entire Indian mainland every 30 minutes.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

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(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (B)

- **Explanation:** The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) is preparing to **launch the GISAT-1A (EOS-05) Earth observation satellite** aboard the GSLV-F17 rocket in September 2026.
- GISAT-1A (designated as EOS-05) is a state-of-the-art, agile **Geo-Imaging Satellite designed to operate from a Geostationary Orbit (36,000 km altitude).**
- Unlike conventional remote sensing satellites operating in Low Earth Orbit (LEO), GISAT-1A remains **stationed over the Indian subcontinent, enabling continuous, near real-time optical surveillance and environmental monitoring.**
- **Nodal Agency: Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO).**
- **Capable of capturing images of the entire Indian mainland every 30 minutes at a spatial resolution of 42 metres**, with rapid target steering capable of capturing designated high-priority areas every 5 minutes.

Q22. Why is the Moon's far side ideal for CosmoCube observations?

(a) To ensure continuous solar exposure
(b) To avoid extreme temperatures
(c) To shield instruments from Earth's radio interference
(d) To enable direct deep-space communication

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: The mission, called CosmoCube, would operate near the Moon and use the lunar far side as a natural shield against radio interference from Earth.**
- A proposed suitcase-sized satellite could give astronomers a new way to study the universe's earliest stages by listening for faint radio signals from more than 13.5 billion years ago.

Q23. Sophie Adenot became the first woman from which country to perform a spacewalk?

(a) Germany
(b) Italy
(c) France
(d) Spain

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: European Space Agency astronaut Sophie Adenot** became the **first French woman and the second European woman to perform a spacewalk** on 18 August 2026.
- She carried out U.S. Spacewalk 97 **outside the International Space Station with NASA astronaut Anil Menon** during a 6-hour and 23-minute extravehicular activity.

Q24. RK-251, recently mentioned by the Ministry of Science and Technology, is associated with which of the following?

(a) Cancer treatment
(b) Vaccine development
(c) Gene therapy
(d) Antibiotic resistance

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Ministry of Science and Technology informed, about a new **smart drug named RK-251 that can replace traditional chemotherapy**.
- It is a **smart cancer drug designed to activate primarily in cancer cells and does not harm healthy cells**.
- It is developed in collaboration with Dr. Asis Bala from the Institute of Advanced Study in Science and Technology (IASST) and Dr. K.P. Bhabak from the Indian Institute of Technology-Guwahati.

Q25. Chlorpheniramine maleate is primarily used for the management of symptoms associated with:

(a) Bacterial infections
(b) Upper respiratory allergies
(c) Hypertension
(d) Fungal infections

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Union ministry of health and family welfare announced that it has banned **Fixed Dose Combinations (FDCs)** containing **chlorpheniramine maleate and phenylephrine hydrochloride** for use in **children below four years of age.**
- The government has imposed restrictions on the manufacture, sale and distribution of all fixed dose combinations (FDCs) containing Chlorpheniramine Maleate and Phenylephrine Hydrochloride, mandating a clear warning that these medicines shall not be used in children below four years of age,"
- **Chlorpheniramine** is a histamine-H1 receptor antagonist indicated for the management of symptoms associated with **upper respiratory allergies.**

Q26. Why is the newly launched popcorn maize hybrid classified as 'non-GMO'?

(a) It is developed without using breeding techniques
(b) It is developed through conventional breeding without genetic modification

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(c) It contains only naturally occurring foreign genes
(d) It is produced exclusively through tissue culture
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan launched India's first non-GMO, high-expansion popcorn maize hybrid seed at Musunuru in Andhra Pradesh's Eluru district,
- **Popcorn maize is a specialised form of Zea mays selected for kernel expansion after heating.**
- High-expansion hybrids are bred for larger popped volume, which is a key quality parameter in the popcorn industry.
- **Non-GMO seeds are developed through conventional breeding methods and do not contain genetically modified traits**

Q27. Consider the following statements regarding Escherichia coli (E. coli):
1. E. coli is commonly found in the intestines of humans and animals.
2. E. coli infections are limited to the digestive system.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Escherichia coli (E.coli) is a bacterial strain that is commonly found in the intestines of people and animals, fecal waste of cattle and humans.
- The most common manner in which this bacteria contaminates water is **if there is a leak in the sewage pipelines in a locality.**
- Unlike other disease-causing bacteria, E. coli can cause an **infection even if you ingest only small amounts.**
- Consumption of water contaminated with E.coli can cause **diarrhoea, digestive issues, urinary tract infection and vomiting.**

Q28. Consider the following statements regarding the Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope:
1. It is named after Nancy Grace Roman, ESA's first chief astronomer.
2. It can capture an area of sky more than 100 times larger than the Hubble Space Telescope.
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: NASA's Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope has been launched from Florida**
- **Named after Nancy Grace Roman, NASA's first chief astronomer and widely regarded as the "mother of the Hubble Space Telescope."**
- **With a 2.4-metre-wide primary mirror, Roman can capture an area of sky more than 100 times larger than Hubble**

Environment

Q1. Pteris madhusoodananii, recently discovered by Indian botanists, is a new species of:
(a) Moss
(b) Grass
(c) Orchid
(d) Fern
Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** A team of Indian botanists recently discovered a rare new species of fern named **Pteris madhusoodananii within the misty Kolli hills of the Eastern Ghats.**
- It has been immediately classified as **'Critically Endangered' due to its extremely small habitat** and the threat of human encroachment.

Q2. According to the 16th Asiatic Lion Population Estimation, the population of Asiatic lions in India increased to how many in 2025?
(a) 523
(b) 674
(c) 891
(d) 1,021
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** India's Asiatic lion population increased from **523 in 2015 to 891 in 2025**, as recorded in the **16th Asiatic Lion Population Estimation.**
- The species is **found mainly in Gujarat's Gir and Greater Gir landscape**, and its range has expanded from about 30,000 square kilometres in 2020 to nearly 35,000 square kilometres.
- Due to sustained conservation, the IUCN moved the Asiatic lion from **"Endangered" (2008) to Vulnerable (2025) on its Red List.**

Q3. The Kalamati Wildlife Range Office is located in which wildlife sanctuary?
(a) Kaziranga National Park
(b) Sonai Rupai Wildlife Sanctuary
(c) Dibru-Saikhowa National Park
(d) Orang National Park
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Assam Finance Minister recently inaugurated the newly constructed **Kalamati**

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Wildlife Range Office at Sonai Rupai Wildlife Sanctuary in Sonitpur.

- Spread over an area of 220 sq.km., the core area covers 175 sq.km., extending over the foothills of the Himalayan range.
- **The Burhidihing River traces its course through the sanctuary.**

Q4. With reference to the Wild Buffalo, consider the following statements:

1. India is home to more than 90% of the global wild buffalo population.
2. The species is listed as Endangered on the IUCN Red List.
3. It is accorded the highest level of protection under Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** The wild buffalo population plummeting over the last few decades, **the Chhattisgarh Forest Department is planning to translocate wild buffaloes from Assam** and keep them in enclosures at the **Pamed Wildlife Sanctuary, the Udanti Sitanadi Tiger Reserve, and the Indravati Tiger Reserve (ITR).**
- **Wild buffalo is the state animal of Chhattisgarh**.
- India is home to more than 90% of the global wild water buffalo population (3,500-3,700 individuals), mainly in **two disconnected clusters: northeast and central India.**
- In India, the wild buffalo enjoys the highest protection under **Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.**
- The **2016 IUCN Red List** for threatened species places it in **the "endangered" category.**

Q5. The recently launched Clouded Leopard Conservation Action Plan (CAP) has been prepared under which initiative?

(a) Government of India–UNESCO Initiative
(b) Government of India–GEF–UNDP Initiative
(c) Government of India–IUCN Initiative
(d) Government of India–WWF Initiative

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, on the occasion of International Clouded Leopard Day, India has reaffirmed its commitment to the conservation of one of Asia's most elusive wild cats through the newly launched **Clouded Leopard Conservation Action Plan (CAP).**
- It is prepared **under the Government of India–GEF–UNDP initiative.**

Q6. According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), which of the following rainfall criteria defines a cloudburst?

(a) 5 cm or more rainfall in an hour over 20–30 sq. km
(b) 7 cm or more rainfall in an hour over 20–30 sq. km
(c) 10 cm or more rainfall in an hour over 20–30 sq. km
(d) 15 cm or more rainfall in an hour over 20–30 sq. km

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: A cloudburst is an extreme weather phenomenon characterized by an intense and sudden downpour of rain**.
- It can also occur in plains, the phenomenon is most common in hilly regions.
- According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), a **cloudburst occurs when a small area, around 20-30 sq. km, receives 10 cm or more of rain in an hour.**
- Impact: Short spells of very heavy rainfall over a small geographical area can cause widespread destruction.

Q7. According to the recent Supreme Court clarification, mining activities are prohibited within what distance from the boundary of the Asan Wetland Conservation Reserve?

(a) 5 km
(b) 10 km
(c) 15 km
(d) 20 km

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Supreme Court recently clarified that a direction banning mining activities within a 10 km radius of the **Asan wetland conservation reserve, a Ramsar site in Uttarakhand,** would apply to other wetland conservation reserves across the country for the sake of parity.
- It is located in **the Dehradun district of Uttarakhand.**
- The **Asan River, unlike other rivers which flow north to south, flows in a west to east direction.**

Q8. Super Typhoon Dolphin is moving towards which of the following island groups?

(a) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
(b) Lakshadweep Islands
(c) Daito and Ryukyu Islands
(d) Kuril Islands

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Super Typhoon Dolphin**, with sustained winds of **175 kmph** and gusts up to **210 kmph**, is moving towards Japan's **Daito and Ryukyu Islands**.

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- Meteorologists are assessing its potential impact on the **Indian summer monsoon**.
- A **strong western Pacific typhoon** can temporarily alter large-scale atmospheric circulation, disrupting monsoon moisture transport.

Q9. India's first virtual zoo has been established at:
(a) Van Vihar National Park
(b) Maharana Pratap Zoological Garden
(c) Kamla Nehru Zoological Garden
(d) Indira Gandhi Zoological Park
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** India's First Virtual Zoo Opens in Indore at Kamla Nehru Zoological Garden in Madhya Pradesh. Chief Minister Dr Mohan Yadav inaugurated the facility on August 16.
- **The project includes a virtual jungle safari and a 14-D cinema theatre.**
- Both facilities were developed under the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model at a cost of Rs 4.5 crore.

Q10. What is the IUCN conservation status of the babirusa (Babyrousa)?
(a) Endangered
(b) Vulnerable
(c) Near Threatened
(d) Critically Endangered
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Chester Zoo in the UK announced **the birth of Rana**, a **rare babirusa piglet,** amid declining wild populations **threatened by African swine fever, habitat loss, and hunting in Indonesia.**
- The babirusa (genus Babyrousa)—commonly known as **the pig-deer**—is one of the **oldest living and strangest wild pig species.**
- **IUCN Status: Vulnerable**

Q11. What distinguishes Colletes bees from honeybees?
(a) They live in large colonies
(b) They generally nest individually
(c) They build communal hives
(d) They depend exclusively on a single flower species
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, **Colletes bhutanicus has been recorded for the first time in India from Tawang district of Arunachal Pradesh** by scientists of the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI).
- It is a rare solitary **Himalayan plasterer bee, recorded from Arunachal Pradesh for the first time.**
- **Unlike honeybees, Colletes bees are solitary and do not live in large colonies.**

Q12. The Desert Zoological Park and Night Safari, proposed as Asia's first desert-themed drive-through night safari, is being developed in which state?
(a) Rajasthan
(b) Maharashtra
(c) Gujarat
(d) Madhya Pradesh
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: The Central Zoo Authority (CZA)** approved the proposal for the **Desert Zoological Park and Night Safari at Deesa in Gujarat's Banaskantha district** to develop **Asia's first desert-themed drive-through night safari.**
- The proposed Desert Zoological Park and Night Safari is being developed over about 103 hectares of government land at Deesa.

Q13. Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary, recently in the news for the sighting of the Smew, is located in which State?
(a) Arunachal Pradesh
(b) Assam
(c) Meghalaya
(d) West Bengal
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Assam's Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary** recorded its first-ever sighting of the **rare migratory Smew** (Mergellus albellus) during the **7th Kaziranga Waterbird Count 2026**, alongside sightings of the **critically endangered Bengal Florican.**
- Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary is a protected area that forms an **integral part of the contiguous Laokhowa-Burhachapori ecosystem.**

Q14. Carbosulfan has been widely used in the cultivation of which of the following crops?
(a) Paddy, cotton and horticultural crops
(b) Wheat, barley and oats
(c) Tea, coffee and cocoa only
(d) Maize, sorghum and millet only
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: The Central government has proposed a complete ban on Carbosulfan.**
- It is **an insecticide belonging to the carbamate group.**
- It has been **used to control a range of insect pests affecting crops.**
- Its use has been reported across several agricultural sectors, particularly in paddy, cotton and horticultural production.

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Q15. Impatiens nimspurjai, recently named after mountaineer Nirmal "Nimsdai" Purja, is found in which country?

(a) India
(b) Bhutan
(c) Nepal
(d) Myanmar

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** A newly identified Himalayan flowering plant has been **named Impatiens nimspurjai in honour of Nepali mountaineer Nirmal "Nimsdai" Purja.**
- The genus is known locally in Nepal
- The species grows on humid slopes and forest margins at elevations of about 2,800 to 2,900 metres.

Q16. Khijadiya Bird Sanctuary, recently identified as a major breeding site for the Black-necked Stork, is located in which state?

(a) Rajasthan
(b) Gujarat
(c) Maharashtra
(d) Madhya Pradesh

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Khijadiya Bird Sanctuary in Jamnagar, Gujarat**, has been identified as a **major breeding site for the Black-necked Stork.**
- The **sanctuary is a Ramsar site .**
- **Conservation Status --**IUCN status: **"Near Threatened".**

Q17. The newly discovered plant species Doronicum sanctum was found in which Indian state?

(a) Sikkim
(b) Arunachal Pradesh
(c) Himachal Pradesh
(d) Uttarakhand

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Researchers from the CSIR-Institute of Himalayan Bioresource Technology (IHBT) have announced the discovery of a new plant species and named it as Doronicum sanctum.
- It was discovered in the high-altitude wilderness of **Arunachal Pradesh.**
- It is the **new plant species belonging to the sunflower family.**

Q18. Which of the following best describes a waterspout?

(a) A rotating column of air and mist over a water body
(b) A vertical column of ocean water caused by tides
(c) A strong downward current of cold air over the sea
(d) A rotating column of water caused by underwater earthquakes

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: A rare weather phenomenon resembling a waterspout was observed over the Brahmaputra in Assam's Barpeta district**
- A waterspout is a large column of air and mist rotating over a water body.
- It is **less intense and typically lasts for around five minutes — occasionally it can last up to 10 minutes**.
- The average waterspout can be **around 165 feet in diameter, with wind speeds of 100 kilometres per hour.**

Q19. Seemanchali and Madgyal, two indigenous breeds recently registered by ICAR-NBAGR, belong to which livestock category?

(a) Cattle
(b) Sheep
(c) Goat
(d) Buffalo

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) registered 16 new indigenous livestock and dog breeds in 2026.

Category	New Breed	State/Region
Sheep	Madgyal	Maharashtra & Karnataka
Sheep	Seemanchali	Bihar

Q20. Consider the following statements regarding the Periyar Cow:

1. Its milk is valued for its nutritional characteristics and is classified as A2 beta-casein.
2. It is a native cattle breed from Assam.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation: The ICAR National Bureau of Animal Genetic Resources registered Periyar Cow as an indigenous cattle breed**
- It is also locally known as **'Periyar Kullan' (Periyar dwarf), is only the second native cattle breed from Keralam to receive national recognition.**
- Its milk is valued for its nutritional characteristics. Milk is classified as A2 Beta casein, the healthiest variety

Q21. COP17 of the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) was held in:

(a) Nairobi, Kenya
(b) Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia
(c) New Delhi, India
(d) Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

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Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, India **launched its first-ever Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems (ONEs) of India** at the 17th Session of the Conference of the Parties **(COP17) to the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia.**
- India's Guide to Grasslands and ONEs marks an **important step in the direction of strengthening their conservation, restoration, and sustainable management.**

Q22. Consider the following statements regarding Giloy:

1. It is traditionally used in the management of fever and urinary problems.
2. It is native exclusively to the Himalayan region.
3. It is a climbing plant that grows on other trees.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Giloy, the climbing herb found in gardens and forests across India, has found an **unusual patient in Madhya Pradesh**, a **young tigress battling canine distemper,** one of the most dangerous viral diseases affecting wild carnivores.
- **It is a climbing shrub that grows on other trees**, from the botanical family Menispermaceae.
- **It is native to India but also found in China and tropical areas of Australia and Africa.**
- It grows well in **almost all types of soils and under varying climatic conditions.**

Traditionally, giloy is used to treat

- fever
- urinary problems
- asthma
- dysentery
- diarrhea

Q23. The flowering cycle of Neelakurinji is traditionally used by which tribal community in Tamil Nadu as a reference for calculating age?

(a) Toda
(b) Kurumba
(c) Irula
(d) Paliyan

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) has **requested the National Green Tribunal** to **direct Keralam, Tamil Nadu, and Karnataka** to submit an **annual plan of operation** incorporating a **conservation action plan for Neelakurinji** (Strobilanthes kunthiana).
- Neelakurinji is **the purplish flowering shrub which blooms once in 12 years.**
- **Conservation Status:** Listed as **Vulnerable under IUCN Red List**
- The **Paliyan tribes (in Tamil Nadu) use it as a reference to calculate their age**.

Q24. Ammannia telanganensis, recently discovered in India, is a species of:

(a) Flowering plant
(b) Freshwater fish
(c) Fern
(d) Freshwater algae

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Ammannia telanganensis is a new **freshwater flowering plant species discovered in Telangana.**
- The plant grows in wet sandy soils along seasonal streams and on the fringes of water bodies, alongside wetland plants such as Ammannia multiflora and species of Rotala.
- It flowers and **fruits between November and February.**

Q25. Consider the following statements regarding hanging glaciers:

1. They typically terminate above the main valley floor.
2. They are inherently stable due to their elevated position.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Study identified **219 hanging glaciers in Uttarakhand's Alaknanda basin,** warning that **warming and permafrost thaw are increasing break-off risks**, potentially triggering **ice-rock avalanches and outburst floods.**
- A hanging glacier is a glacier that **originates high on a mountain wall or valley flank and terminates abruptly at the edge of a steep precipice or cliff face,** rather than flowing down into a main valley floor.
- The permafrost and subglacial ice adhering the glacier to the steep bedrock bed thaw, **creating basal meltwater that acts as a lubricant and converts stable ice masses into precarious, dynamically unstable hanging bodies.**

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Index / Rankings / Reports

Q1. Consider the following statements regarding Environmental Performance Index (EPI) 2026:

1. India ranked 170th out of 177 countries.
2. EPI is released by the World Economic Forum (WEF).

Which statement(s) given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** The **Environmental Performance Index (EPI)** is a data-driven global benchmark developed by the Yale Center for Environmental Law & Policy, Columbia University's Center for International Earth Science Information Network (CIESIN) and Yale Center for Geospatial Solutions, Yale University with support from the McCall MacBain Foundation.
- In the 2026 Environmental Performance Index (EPI), **Estonia claimed the No. 1 spot** with an overall score of 74.79.
- India ranked second from the bottom, taking the 176th position out of 177 evaluated countries.

Q2. According to the 2026 Barclays Private Clients Hurun India Most Valuable Family Business List, the top two families were _____ and _____.

(a) Birla and Bajaj
(b) Ambani and Birla
(c) Tata and Ambani
(d) Hinduja and Birla

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Barclays Private Clients Hurun India recently released data on the **most valuable family businesses**
- **India's top 300 family businesses are now valued at a massive Rs 138 lakh crore ($1.46 trillion)** combined.
- According to the '2026 Barclays Private Clients Hurun India Most Valuable Family Business List' - **Ambani family, owner of Reliance Industries**, has a net value of Rs 25,82,800 crore claimed the title of the **Most Valuable Family Business**
- **Birla family claimed the second spot** with a net value of Rs 8,13,700 crore

Q3. What is the current global ranking of Jawaharlal Nehru Port among container ports?

(a) 18th
(b) 21st
(c) 24th
(d) 28th

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Mumbai has emerged as the **world's fastest-growing container port.**
- The port has risen to the 21st position globally.
- JNPA was ranked 28th at the end of 2025 and has now moved to 21st place.

Q4. Consider the following statements regarding the IWG 2026 Work from Anywhere Index:

1. Tokyo topped the index.
2. India scored higher than the UK, France and the US on flexible workspace maturity.
3. Mumbai is the only Indian city included in the global ranking.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The first appearance of Mumbai in the **IWG 2026 Work from Anywhere Index has taken place and ranked 50th globally.**
- It is the **only Indian city included in the global ranking** that evaluates destinations suitable for professionals who are combining remote working with traveling.
- **Bangkok led the 2026 index** with 106.5 points, followed by,
- Tokyo – 96.5
- Barcelona – 95.5
- **Mumbai's score of 77**
- India recorded the highest score of 100 on its flexible workspace maturity index, ahead of the UK, France and the US.

Q5. The Information Technology Resilience Index (ITRI) has been introduced by which of the following regulatory bodies?

(a) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
(b) Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
(c) Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA)
(d) Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has introduced an **Information Technology Resilience Index (ITRI) for market infrastructure institutions (MIIs).**
- It is introduced to assess the functioning and resilience of information technology systems of market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), including stock exchanges, depositories and clearing corporations.

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- Aim: It is aimed at strengthening oversight of the resilience of IT systems and identifying emerging weaknesses at an early stage, so that timely corrective measures can be taken

Q6. Who was named to the 2026 TIME100 AI list for her work in "AI for Science"?

(a) Fei-Fei Li
(b) Demis Hassabis
(c) Mira Murati
(d) Anima Anandkumar

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: Anima Anandkumar** is a world-renowned **Indian-born computer scientist** who serves as the **Bren Professor of Computing and Mathematical Sciences at the California Institute of Technology (Caltech).**
- She was recently **named to the 2026 TIME100 AI list, which honors the world's 100 most influential people in artificial intelligence**

International

Q1. The recently signed Mecca Joint Deterrence Agreement involves which three countries?

(a) Saudi Arabia, Iran and Pakistan
(b) Türkiye, Saudi Arabia and Pakistan
(c) Türkiye, Qatar and Pakistan
(d) Saudi Arabia, Egypt and Pakistan

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Turkiye, Saudi Arabia, and Pakistan signed the historic Mecca Joint Deterrence Agreement in Mecca** to establish a collective security and defence mechanism.
- The Mecca Joint Deterrence Agreement is a trilateral defense framework designed to align the military, financial, and strategic deterrence capabilities of three major regional powers—Turkiye, Saudi Arabia, and Pakistan—to safeguard national sovereignty and regional stability.

Q2.Which U.S. state has declared 15 August 2026 as India Day across the state?

(a) California
(b) Texas
(c) New York
(d) Massachusetts

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Massachusetts declared August 15, 2026, as India Day across the state, and Boston issued a similar proclamation for the same date.
- The observance coincides with the 79th anniversary of India's independence from British colonial rule in 1947.

Q3. Which one of the following countries has recently launched a Climate-Funded Citizenship-by-Investment (CBI) Programme, also known as a "Golden Passport" scheme, to finance climate adaptation projects?

(a) Fiji
(b) Kiribati
(c) Naoero
(d) Tuvalu

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Nauru, a small Pacific island nation recently renamed the Republic of Naoero, has launched a Citizenship-by-Investment (CBI) Programme - **"Golden Passport" Scheme** to raise funds for climate adaptation and resilience.
- Introduced last year, the programme allows eligible **foreign nationals to obtain Nauruan citizenship by making a financial contribution.**

Q4. The Arctic Council was established through which declaration?

(a) Stockholm Declaration
(b) Ottawa Declaration
(c) Rio Declaration
(d) Helsinki Declaration

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Recently, the Parliamentary committee on External Affairs has recommended that India should **appoint a Polar Ambassador** and urged the government to seek **"full-fledged membership" of the Arctic council.**
- It was established by the **Ottawa Declaration in 1996.**
- It is an intergovernmental forum for **addressing issues related to the Arctic Region.**
- It is **not a treaty-based international organization** but rather an international forum that operates on the basis of consensus, echoing the **peaceful and cooperative nature of the Arctic Region.**

Q5. The Kuril Islands are at the centre of a territorial dispute between which two countries?

(a) Russia and China
(b) Russia and Japan
(c) Japan and South Korea
(d) Russia and North Korea

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Russian President Vladimir Putin has visited the disputed Kuril Islands for the first time**, travelling to Iturup as Moscow's relations with Japan remain deeply strained over Russia's war in Ukraine.
- **The Kuril Islands is an island group in the Russian Far East that forms the boundary between the Pacific Ocean and the Sea of Okhotsk.**
- Although **Russia administers all the Kuril Islands,** some islands are at the heart of the Russo-Japanese feud known as the Kuril Islands dispute.

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Q6. Which country became the first in the Arab world to abolish the death penalty?

(a) Lebanon
(b) Jordan
(c) Egypt
(d) Tunisia

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Lebanon's parliament **abolished the death penalty, making it the first country in the Arab world** to replace the sentencing with life imprisonment with aggravated hard labour.

Q7. Prime Minister Narendra Modi was recently conferred with Uzbekistan's prestigious 'Oliy Darajali Do'stlik' Order. The term 'Do'stlik' refers to:

(a) Cooperation
(b) Solidarity
(c) Partnership
(d) Friendship

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred with **Uzbekistan's prestigious 'Oliy Darajali Do'stlik' Order,** which he dedicated to the "enduring" bond between India and Uzbekistan.
- **'Dostlik' means friendship**.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi's **36th international state honour**

Q8. France's first major Hindu temple, the BAPS Swaminarayan Hindu Mandir, is located in:

(a) Lyon
(b) Marseille
(c) Bussy-Saint-Georges
(d) Toulouse

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** France is set to welcome its **first major Hindu temple, with the BAPS Swaminarayan Hindu Mandir in Bussy-Saint-Georges, near Paris,** scheduled to be inaugurated in September.
- The historic opening will be marked by a 13-day 'Festival of Culture' from September 2 to 14, 2026.

Q9. The BRICS RI Debate 2026, organised by the BRICS Youth Alliance, was held in which Indian state?

(a) Assam
(b) Sikkim
(c) Meghalaya
(d) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: BRICS Youth Alliance organises the BRICS RI Debate 2026 in Sikkim**
- The BRICS Youth Alliance organised the **BRICS RI Debate 2026 under the theme "BRICS and the Global South: Reforming Global Governance or Reproducing Existing Inequalities**?"
- It featured **postgraduate students discussing global governance, economic justice, and multilateral cooperation**.

Q10. Lake Ontario forms a natural international boundary between which two countries?

(a) United States and Mexico
(b) Canada and Greenland
(c) United States and Canada
(d) Canada and Iceland

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** US President Donald Trump signed an executive order directing federal agencies and the US Geological Survey (USGS) to refer to **Lake Ontario as Lake America** amid **escalating trade tensions and tariff disputes with Canada.**
- Lake Ontario is the **smallest by surface area** and the **easternmost of the five Great Lakes of North America** (Superior, Michigan, Huron, Erie, and Ontario).
- Bordering Nations: **Canada and United States.**

Q11. What book was presented to Prime Minister Narendra Modi by people from various communities in Bishkek?

(a) Kyrgyzstan: A Cultural Journey
(b) Tales of Central Asia
(c) Manas: Kyrgyz Veergatha Kavya
(d) The History of Kyrgyzstan

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi paid tribute to **Mahatma Gandhi at his memorial in Bishkek** ahead of the **26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Leadership Summit.**
- The statue was unveiled by PM Modi during his visit to Kyrgyzstan in 2015.
- The prime minister also met people from various communities in Bishkek and was **presented with a book titled Manas: Kyrgyz Veergatha Kavya.**

Sports

National/International Championship

Q1. India won how many medals in the women's event at the 2026 U17 World Wrestling Championships held in Baku, Azerbaijan?

(a) One gold and two bronze
(b) One silver and two bronze
(c) Two silver and one bronze
(d) Three bronze

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** India's women wrestlers delivered strong podium finishes at the 2026 **U17 World**

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Championships in Baku, Azerbaijan, bringing home a **silver and two bronze medals**
- In U17 World Championships, Indian wrestler **Nikita Sehrawat** settled for a **silver medal** while **Kamna Babal and Garima bagged bronze medals in the women's event in Baku, Azerbaijan.**

Q2. At the World Athletics U20 Championships 2026, Basant Kumar Meghwal won _____ in the high jump with a best clearance of _____.
(a) Gold; 2.18 m
(b) Silver; 2.21 m
(c) Silver; 2.24 m
(d) Bronze; 2.21 m

Answer: (b)
- **Explanation:** Basant Kumar Meghwal's silver in the high jump and Shahnavaz Khan's bronze in the long jump marked a landmark moment for India at the World Athletics U20 Championships 2026.
- Basant Kumar Meghwal became the first Indian athlete to win a high jump medal at the World Athletics U20 Championships**, equalling a personal-best 2.21m.**

Q3. Who won the silver medal in the men's javelin throw at the 2026 World Athletics U20 Championships?
(a) Neeraj Chopra
(b) Sachin Yadav
(c) Kishore Jena
(d) Ashish Yadav

Answer: (d)
- **Explanation:** Ashish Yadav is a 19-year-old Indian javelin thrower from Uttar Pradesh who won silver in the men's javelin at the 2026 World Athletics U-20 Championships in Oregon.
- **He produced a best throw of 74.09m**
- Ashish is now the second Indian to win a javelin medal at the World Athletics U-20 Championships after Neeraj Chopra, who won gold in 2016

Q4. Who became the first Indian to win gold in the Senior Individual Women's event at the Asian Aerobic Gymnastics Championships?
(a) Dipa Karmakar
(b) S. Deepika
(c) Pranati Nayak
(d) Ariha Pangambam

Answer: (d)
- **Explanation:** Ariha Pangambam has become the first Indian ever to win gold in the Senior Individual Women's event at the Asian Aerobic Gymnastics Championships.
- **The 22-year-old from Manipur topped the podium**
- The 2026 Asian Aerobic Gymnastics Championships were held in Tagaytay City, Philippines, from 4 to 7 August 2026
- **scored 19.100 in the final.**

Q5. Who won the silver medal in the men's 65 kg category at the Asian Junior Weightlifting Championships?
(a) Maharajan Arumugapandian
(b) Jeremy Lalrinnunga
(c) Achinta Sheuli
(d) Mirabai Chanu

Answer: (a)
- **Explanation:** Indian weightlifter **Maharajan Arumugapandian** won the silver medal in the men's 65-kilogram category at the **Asian Junior Weightlifting Championships in Tashkent, Uzbekistan.**
- Maharajan produced a personal best total of 285 kilograms, lifting 128 kilograms in the snatch and 157 kilograms in the clean and jerk

Q6. Which of the following correctly represents India's medal tally at the Commonwealth Fencing Championship?
(a) 13 Gold, 8 Silver and 14 Bronze
(b) 12 Gold, 9 Silver and 14 Bronze
(c) 13 Gold, 9 Silver and 13 Bronze
(d) 14 Gold, 8 Silver and 13 Bronze

Answer: (a)
- **Explanation:** India have emerged as the overall champions at the **Commonwealth Fencing Championship**, returning with **35 medals** from the event **held in Lagos, Nigeria.**
- **Indian fencers won 13 gold, 8 silver and 14 bronze medals across the U-23 and senior competitions.**

Q7. Who won the women's 76 kg gold medal at the U20 World Wrestling Championship 2026?
(a) Tanu Sharma
(b) Savita
(c) Chisato Yoshida
(d) Kajal Dhochak

Answer: (d)
- **Explanation:** India's Kajal Dhochak has won her **second consecutive U20 World Wrestling Championship title. She clinched the women's 76-kilogram gold medal .**
- She defeated China's Jingru Sun .
- Tanu Sharma won a silver medal in the women's 72 kg category after losing 3–5 to Japan's Chisato Yoshida.

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Common Wealth Games

Q1. At the Commonwealth Games 2026 held in Glasgow, Indian weightlifter Lovepreet Singh secured a silver medal. In which category did he win the medal?

(a) Men's 96 kg weightlifting
(b) Men's 102 kg weightlifting
(c) Men's +110 kg weightlifting
(d) Men's 109 kg weightlifting

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation: Seema Kaliramna** won the **bronze medal** in **women's discus throw** at the Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow , a best mark of 58.66m
- India's **Lovepreet Singh** came within touching distance of the Commonwealth Games title before settling **for silver in the men's +110kg weightlifting** event, finishing just 1kg behind New Zealand's David Liti in Glasgow
- Lovepreet **registered a combined lift of 388kg**, while Liti clinched gold with 389kg.

Q2. Who won the bronze medal in the women's 63 kg judo category at the Commonwealth Games 2026?

(a) Unnati Sharma
(b) Manu Bhaker
(c) Anush Agarwalla
(d) Antim Panghal

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Indian judoka Unnati Sharma won the **bronze medal** in the women's **63 kg category at the Commonwealth Games**, defeating her opponent and securing victory in just 1 minute and 7 seconds.

Q3. Gulveer Singh created history at the Commonwealth Games 2026 by becoming the first Indian, male or female, to win a medal in which event?

(a) 1500 metres
(b) 5000 metres
(c) 10,000 metres
(d) Marathon

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Gulveer Singh etched his name in Commonwealth Games history, once again, at the 2026 edition in Glasgow after **he became the first Indian, man or woman, to win a medal in the 5000m event**
- He become the first Indian track and field athlete to win multiple medals in a single Games.

Q4. Who among the following Indian athletes won the silver medal in the men's triple jump event at the Commonwealth Games 2026 held in Glasgow?

(a) Selva Prabhu Thirumaran
(b) Praveen Chitravel
(c) Gulveer Singh
(d) Murali Sreeshankar

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Indian athletes Praveen Chitravel and Selva Prabhu Thirumaran secured medals in the **men's triple jump event** at the **Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow**.
- Praveen Chitravel won the **silver medal** with a best jump of **16.58 metres**.
- Selva Prabhu Thirumaran clinched the **bronze medal** after recording a jump of **16.52 metres**, marking his first major international medal.

Q5. Which Indian boxer won the gold medal in the women's 53 kg category at the Commonwealth Games 2026?

(a) Lovlina Borgohain
(b) Preeti Pawar
(c) Jaismine Lamboria
(d) Nikhat Zareen

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Preeti Pawar and Jaismine Lamboria**, who punched **gold in women's 53kg and 57kg categories respectively.** Jadumani Singh had to settle for a **silver in the men's 55kg category.**

Q6. Who among the following became the first Indian athlete to win a medal in the men's decathlon at the Commonwealth Games 2026?

(a) Neeraj Chopra
(b) Avinash Sable
(c) Murali Sreeshankar
(d) Tejaswin Shankar

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Tejaswin Shankar scripted history by becoming the **first Indian athlete to win a medal in the men's decathlon** at a major international multi-sport event, **clinching bronze at the Commonwealth Games 2026.**
- It was his second Commonwealth Games, having won the high jump bronze in the 2022 edition in Birmingham.

Q7. _____ and _____ became India's first-ever judokas to win gold medals at the Commonwealth

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Games 2026 in the _____ and _____ categories, respectively.

(a) Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh; women's 48 kg and men's 60 kg
(b) Yamini Mourya and Harsh Singh; women's 57 kg and men's 60 kg
(c) Asmita Dey and Yamini Mourya; women's 48 kg and women's 57 kg
(d) Unnati Sharma and Harsh Singh; women's 63 kg and men's 60 kg

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** India created history at the Commonwealth Games 2026 in Glasgow as **Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh became the country's first-ever judokas to win gold medals at the Commonwealth Games.**
- Asmita Dey won the **women's 48 kg gold medal** after defeating Heidi Quach of Canada in the final.
- Harsh Singh secured the **men's 60 kg gold medal** by defeating Joshua Katz of Australia, an Olympian and one of the tournament favourites.

Q8. Who won the silver medal in the men's javelin throw at the Commonwealth Games 2026?

(a) Yash Vir Singh
(b) Neeraj Chopra
(c) Kishore Jena
(d) Rohit Yadav

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Neeraj Chopra settled for the silver medal in the men's javelin throw event at the Commonwealth Games 2026 with a best effort of 85.83m in the final at the Scotstoun Stadium in Glasgow.
- India's Yash Vir Singh logged a new personal best of 85.41m, final throw to claim the bronze medal on his CWG debut.

Q9. Consider the following statements regarding the 2026 Commonwealth Games:

1. India's all-time Commonwealth Games medal tally has crossed 600 medals.
2. India won 13 gold medals at the 2026 Commonwealth Games.
3. Australia finished at the top of the medal tally.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** The **2026 Commonwealth Games** concluded, with **Scotland** officially handing over the **Commonwealth Games Flag** and the **Ceremonial Baton** to **India**, host of the landmark **2030 centenary edition**.
- The **2030 Commonwealth Games** will be hosted in **Ahmedabad, Gujarat**, making **India** only the **second country after Australia** to host the Commonwealth Games **more than once**.
- Australia finished the 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow at the top of the medal tally, followed by England and Canada
- Overall, India's all-time **Commonwealth Games medal tally** now stands at **602 medals (215 gold, 207 silver, 180 bronze)**, placing them fourth in the all-time rankings behind Australia, England, and Canada.
- India finished the 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow with 39 total medals, including 13 gold, 17 silver, and 9 bronze medal

Tennis

Q1. Which Indian pair won the doubles title at the Bonn Open 2026?

(a) Ramkumar Ramanathan and Vijay Sundar Prashanth
(b) Yuki Bhambri and Saketh Myneni
(c) Rohan Bopanna and Yuki Bhambri
(d) Jeevan Nedunchezhiyan and N. Sriram Balaji

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** In tennis, **India's Ramkumar Ramanathan and Vijay Sundar Prashanth clinched the doubles title at the Bonn Open 2026.**
- This title marks **Ramkumar's second ATP Challenger doubles trophy of the year.**

Q2. Who won the 2026 Canadian Open men's singles title?

(a) Brandon Nakashima
(b) Rafael Nadal
(c) Novak Djokovic
(d) Ben Shelton

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: American tennis player Ben Shelton** successfully **defended his Canadian Open title by defeating fellow American Brandon Nakashima** in the final of the National Bank Open in Montreal.
- **Shelton became the first Canadian Open champion since Novak Djokovic in 2016 to win the tournament without dropping a set.**

Q3. Which player won the 2026 Canadian Open women's singles title?

(a) Elena Rybakina
(b) Iga Swiatek
(c) Aryna Sabalenka
(d) Coco Gauff

Answer: (b)

Explanation: In Canadian Open Tennis, **Iga Swiatek of Poland** defeated second seed Elena Rybakina in

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straight sets **to claim the Women's Singles title in Toronto**

Table Tennis

Q1. The Women's Singles title at the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships was won by:

(a) Sreeja Akula
(b) Syndrela Das
(c) Yashaswini Ghorpade
(d) Sutirtha Mukherjee

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Ankur Bhattacharjee and Yashaswini Ghorpade clinched the men's and women's singles title with contrasting wins at the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships
- **The seven-day championship was held at the Thyagaraj Stadium from July 27 to August 2.**

Q2. Which country won both the men's and women's team titles at the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships 2026?

(a) Malaysia
(b) India
(c) Singapore
(d) England

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: India won both the men's and women's team titles at the Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships 2026 after beating Malaysia** in the respective finals at the Thyagraj Stadium in New Delhi
- The championships run from July 27 to August 2,

Q3. Who won the Under-15 girls' singles title at the UTT National Ranking Table Tennis tournament?

(a) Prateek Tulsani
(b) Tanishka Kalbhairav
(c) Diya Chitale
(d) Suhana Saini

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation: Tanishka Kalbhairav** of Karnataka and **Prateek Tulsani** of Maharashtra won the **under-15 girls' and boys' singles titles,** respectively, at the season-opening **UTT National Ranking Table Tennis tournament in Kanpur.**

Squash

Q1. Who won the Budapest Open 2026 squash title?

(a) Balázs Farkas
(b) Velavan Senthilkumar
(c) Saurav Ghosal
(d) Abhay Singh

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** India's **Velavan Senthilkumar** won his **maiden PSA Copper-level squash title** after beating Hungarian No. 1 Balázs Farkas in the Budapest Open 2026 final
- **Squash will make its Olympic debut at LA 2028**, and the men's and women's singles champions at the Asian Games 2026 will earn qualification spots for the Olympics.

Badminton

Q1. Who became the first Indian badminton player to win the Korea Masters title 2026?

(a) PV Sindhu
(b) Devika Sihag
(c) Tanvi Sharma
(d) Ashmita Chaliha

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation: Ashmita Chaliha won her first BWF World Tour title** after completing a comeback win over China's Han Qian Xi in the women's singles at the BWF Korea Masters 2026.
- **become the first Indian to win the Korea Masters - a BWF Super 300 tournament.**
- She joins an elite group of Indian women's singles players to have won BWF Super 300 or higher-level badminton titles, **alongside Olympic medallists Saina Nehwal and PV Sindhu, as well as Devika Sihag and Tanvi Sharma.**

Q2. Tanvi Sharma became the first Indian women's singles player to win the Taipei Open title since _____.

(a) Saina Nehwal
(b) P. V. Sindhu
(c) Jwala Gutta
(d) Ashwini Ponnappa

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Teen Indian sensation **Tanvi Sharma** won her maiden BWF World Tour title after defeating Vietnam'in the women's singles final of the **Taipei Open Super 300 badminton tournament in Taipei.**
- Tanvi also became the **first Indian to win the women's singles title at the Taipei Open since Saina Nehwal,** who had lifted the trophy in 2008.

Q3. Which Indian pair won the bronze medal in women's doubles at the BWF Badminton World Championships 2026?

(a) Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa
(b) Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand
(c) P. V. Sindhu and Saina Nehwal
(d) Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty

Answer: (b)

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- **Explanation:** India's **Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand** have etched their names in history by clinching the **bronze medal at the BWF Badminton World Championships.**
- They have become **only the second Indian women's doubles pair to win a World Championship medal,**

Cricket

Q1. The 2026 Irani Cup is scheduled to be hosted in which State/Union Territory?

(a) Ladakh
(b) Chandigarh
(c) Jammu and Kashmir
(d) Puducherry

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Jammu and Kashmir is scheduled to host the Irani Cup match at Sher-I-Kashmir Stadium in Srinagar from 1 to 5 October 2026.
- The fixture will be played between **Jammu and Kashmir and the Rest of India in a five-day first-class format.**
- The Irani Cup is a first-class cricket match **played between the Ranji Trophy champions and the Rest of India team.**

Q2. Rishabh Pant recently became the first Indian and fourth player overall to achieve which milestone in Test cricket?

(a) 100 Test matches as a wicketkeeper-batter
(b) 100 sixes in Test cricket
(c) 100 dismissals as a wicketkeeper
(d) 100 sixes in international cricket

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Wicketkeeper-batter **Rishabh Pant became the first Indian player and fourth in the world to complete the rare milestone of 100 sixes in Test cricket** during the fourth day of the opening game against Sri Lanka.
- Pant also became **the fastest to 100 maximums in only his 51st game while former England skipper Ben Stokes had reached the mark in his 82nd Test.**

Q3. At what age did Vaibhav Sooryavanshi become the youngest player to score a half-century in Duleep Trophy history?

(a) 15 years and 23 days
(b) 15 years and 157 days
(c) 16 years and 23 days
(d) 16 years and 307 days

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Teenage sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi etched his name into the record books, becoming the **youngest player to score a half-century in Duleep Trophy history at just 15 years and 157 days.**

Hockey

Q1. Which country won the FIH Men's Hockey World Cup 2026?

(a) Germany
(b) Argentina
(c) Netherlands
(d) Spain

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** In the **FIH Men's Hockey World Cup 2026**, **Germany retained the World Cup title with a 1-0 win over Spain** in the final at the Belfius Hockey Arena in Wavre, **Belgium.**
- **Spain, appearing in their first World Cup final since 1998,**

Chess

Q1. Who won the open title at the 2026 British Chess Championships?

(a) Shreyas Royal
(b) Bodhana Sivanandan
(c) Gukesh Dommaraju
(d) Praggnanandhaa Rameshbabu

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Indian-origin chess prodigies Bodhana Sivanandan and Shreyas Royal created history by winning titles at the 2026 British Chess Championships.
- **Bodhana Sivanandan became Britain's youngest-ever Women's Chess Champion at the age of 11.**
- **Shreyas Royal** won the **British Championship open title, becoming the youngest-ever British Chess Champion at 17.**

Q2. Who recently won the Grand Chess Tour St. Louis Rapid and Blitz title in the United States?

(a) D. Gukesh
(b) Magnus Carlsen
(c) R. Praggnanandhaa
(d) Hikaru Nakamura

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Indian grandmaster R. Praggnanandhaa has clinched the Grand Chess Tour St. Louis Rapid and Blitz title in the United States.
- finished with 23.5 points.
- Earlier in June, **Praggnanandhaa scripted history by claiming the Norway Chess 2026 crown in Oslo**

Q3. Who became the first Indian to win the Grand Chess Tour?

(a) Gukesh D
(b) Arjun Erigaisi

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(c) R. Praggnanandhaa
(d) Vidit Gujrathi
Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Indian Grandmaster R. Praggnanandhaa created history, becoming **the first Indian to win the Grand Chess Tour** after **defeating defending champion Fabiano Caruana at St. Louis in the US.**
- The Grand Chess Tour is an elite circuit spanning **Classical, Rapid and Blitz events with the world's best players and a total prize pool of $2 million.**

Q4. Who won the Open gold medal at the Asian Junior Blitz Chess Championship?
(a) R Praggnanandhaa
(b) Vignesh Vermula
(c) Arjun Erigaisi
(d) Nihal Sarin
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Indian chess players **Vignesh Vermula and Saranya Devi won the Open and Girls' gold medals**, respectively, in **the Asian Junior Blitz Chess Championship.**
- The Asian Junior Chess Championship is a **continental chess event for junior players from Asia.**
- This tournament was organized by the Maharashtra Chess Association

Q5. Who won the Esports World Cup (EWC) chess title for the second consecutive year?
(a) Denis Lazavik
(b) Magnus Carlsen
(c) Hikaru Nakamura
(d) Fabiano Caruana
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen has won the Esports World Cup (EWC) chess title for the second consecutive year.
- Representing Team Liquid, the 35-year-old Norwegian remained completely undefeated throughout the entire tournament.
- Runner-up : Denis Lazavik

Q6. Who won the Group A title at the Kanizsa Open 2026 in Hungary?
(a) R. Praggnanandhaa
(b) Pranesh M
(c) Arjun Erigaisi
(d) Nihal Sarin
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** India's 19-year-old Grandmaster Pranesh M clinched the Group A title at the prestigious Kanizsa Open 2026 in Nagykanizsa, Hungary,
- The Tamil Nadu player, who hails from Karaikudi, is rated 2673 and ranked 44th in the latest FIDE rankings for August 2026.

Football

Q1. Match the Durand Cup 2026 awards with the respective players:
Codes:

Column I – Award	Column II – Player
1. Golden Glove	A. Edmund Lalrinkdika
2. Golden Boot	B. Vishal Kaith
3. Golden Ball	C. Alaaeddine Ajaraie

(a) 1-B, 2-C, 3-A
(b) 1-C, 2-A, 3-B
(c) 1-A, 2-B, 3-C
(d) 1-B, 2-A, 3-C
Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** East Bengal have won the Durand Cup for the 17th time, equalling Mohun Bagan's record as the most succesfull team in the 139-year history of the tournament.
- **Venue: the final held at Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan (Salt Lake Stadium) in Kolkata**
- **Golden Glove** - Vishal Kaith (Mohun Bagan Super Giant)
- **Golden Boot** - Alaaeddine Ajaraie (NorthEast United)
- **Golden Ball** - Edmund Lalrinkdika (East Bengal)

Athletics

Q1. What position did Neeraj Chopra secure in the men's javelin throw at the Lausanne Diamond League 2026?
(a) First
(b) Second
(c) Third
(d) Fourth
Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** Ace Indian javelin thrower Neeraj Chopra finished **second at the Lausanne Diamond League** with a season-best throw of **88.05 metres**, just nine centimetres behind Sri Lanka's Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage, who won with 88.14 metres.

Miscellaneous

Q1. At the 11th All India Police Judo Cluster Championship 2026, Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)

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emerged as the overall champion. What was SSB's medal tally in the championship?

(a) 24 Gold, 20 Silver and 23 Bronze medals
(b) 25 Gold, 16 Silver and 25 Bronze medals
(c) 10 Gold, 21 Silver and 26 Bronze medals
(d) 20 Gold, 24 Silver and 23 Bronze medals

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The 11th All India Police Judo Cluster Championship 2026 concluded on 30 July 2026 at Hyderabad in Telangana.
- The event was held from **23 July to 30 July 2026** at the GMC Balayogi Indoor Stadium in Gachibowli and was **hosted by the Central Industrial Security Force** under the aegis of the All-India Police Sports Control Board.
- **Sashastra Seema Bal** finished as the **overall champion** with 24 gold, 20 silver, and 23 bronze medals for 203 points.

Q2. Which NCC Directorate emerged as the overall champion of the Inter Directorate Sports Shooting Competition (IDSSC) 2026?

(a) Maharashtra Directorate
(b) Karnataka and Goa Directorate
(c) Uttar Pradesh Directorate
(d) Tamil Nadu Directorate

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** The Uttar Pradesh NCC Directorate emerged as the **overall champion of the Inter Directorate Sports Shooting Competition (IDSSC) 2026,** which concluded in Tiruchi, Tamil Nadu
- **The Maharashtra Directorate** finished as the **first runner-up** while the Karnataka and Goa Directorate secured the second runner-up position.

Q3. Harshita Jakhar, recently seen in the news, became the first Indian woman to:

(a) Win a medal at the UCI Road World Championships
(b) Qualify for the Olympic Road Race
(c) Win the Asian Road Cycling Championship
(d) Participate in the Tour de France Femmes

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Young cyclist Harshita Jakhar rode into history books by becoming the first Indian woman to be a part of the Tour de France Femmes in Switzerland.
- **She is 19-year-old Hailing from Rajasthan .**
- The event started on 1st of this month in Lausanne and will end on 9th August in Nice.

Q4. Which state will host the Asian Rafting Championships 2026?

(a) Sikkim
(b) Assam
(c) Uttarakhand
(d) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: (d)

- **Explanation:** Boleng in Siang district of Arunachal Pradesh will host the **Asian Rafting Championships 2026 from 5 October to 9 October 2026.**
- The five-day event will take place on the **Simang River, a Class III+ tributary of the Siang River,** and will bring paddlers from across Asia to compete in white-water rafting events.

Q5. Which of the following was the medal tally of the Indian team at the International Linguistics Olympiad (IOL) 2026?

(a) 2 Gold, 2 Silver and 1 Bronze
(b) 1 Gold, 3 Bronze and 1 Honourable Mention
(c) 1 Gold, 2 Silver and 2 Bronze
(d) 3 Gold and 2 Bronze

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Language Technologies Research Centre (LTRC) at IIIT Hyderabad mentored the eight-member Indian contingent at the **International Linguistics Olympiad (IOL) 2026, held in Romania.**
- **The Indian team secured one gold medal, three bronze medals, and one honourable mention.**
- India has been participating in the International Linguistics Olympiad since 2009.

Q6. What was India's medal composition at the UCI Parasport Denmark Grand Prix 2026?

(a) 2 Gold, 5 Silver, 5 Bronze
(b) 3 Gold, 4 Silver, 5 Bronze
(c) 2 Gold, 4 Silver, 6 Bronze
(d) 1 Gold, 5 Silver, 6 Bronze

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Indian para-cyclists won **12 medals at the UCI Parasport Denmark Grand Prix in Odense, Denmark,** that began on 7 August 2026 and ended on 10 August 2026.
- The Indian tally included **2 gold, 5 silver and 5 bronze medals in para-cycling events.**
- The UCI Parasport Denmark Grand Prix was a track cycling competition under the Union Cycliste Internationale framework.

Q7. Which boat won the 72nd Nehru Trophy Boat Race held at Punnamada Lake?

(a) Nadubhagom Chundan
(b) Karichal Chundan
(c) Aromal Chundan
(d) Payippad Chundan

Answer: (c)

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- **Explanation:** In Keralam, **Aromal Chundan has won the 72nd Nehru Trophy Boat Race at Punnamada Lake in Alappuzha**.
- Aromal Chundan crossed the finish **line in 4 minutes, 23 seconds, and 328 milliseconds to secure the coveted trophy.**

Q8. At the World Humanoid Robot Games, a humanoid robot completed the 100-metre sprint in _____ seconds, surpassing Usain Bolt's world record of _____ seconds.

(a) 9.39; 9.58
(b) 9.58; 9.39
(c) 9.69; 9.58
(d) 10.01; 9.69

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** Chinese humanoid robots broke records set by humans, including beating Usain Bolt's 100-meter sprint world record**, in World Humanoid Robot Games in Beijing**
- At a 100-meter sprint, **a humanoid robot achieved a result of 9.39 seconds, beating the human record of 9.58 seconds set by Jamaican athlete Bolt in 2009.**

Q9. The 'Khelo India Samvad – Khel Ki Baat PM Ke Saath' programme is being organised in which of the following States/Union Territory?

(a) Punjab, Haryana and Chandigarh
(b) Punjab, Himachal Pradesh and Delhi
(c) Haryana, Rajasthan and Chandigarh
(d) Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Haryana

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Union Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports is organising **'Khelo India Samvad – Khel Ki Baat PM Ke Saath**' in two colleges in **every district of Punjab and Haryana and the Union Territory of Chandigarh** on August 27 with an aim to **connect youth with the national vision of sports, fitness and youth-led nation building.**

Q10. The Asian Open Short Track Speed Skating Trophy 2026 is being held in which Indian state?

(a) Himachal Pradesh
(b) Sikkim
(c) Uttarakhand
(d) Arunachal Pradesh

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami inaugurated the Asian Open Short Track Speed Skating Trophy 2026 at **Maharana Pratap Sports Complex in Dehradun.**
- The competition is scheduled from August 17 to 20
- A total of 272 players from **14 Asian countries are participating in the event, including 130 Indian players.**
- **HOST – India, Uttarakhand**

Q11. Who has been appointed as the assistant coach of the India Under-17 women's national football team?

(a) Joakim Alexandersson
(b) Anthony Andrews
(c) Manolo Marquez
(d) Khalid Jamil

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The All India Football Federation (AIFF) has appointed **Anthony Andrews as the assistant coach of the India Under-17 women's national team,** with Joakim Alexandersson continuing as the head coach.
- Andrews also serves as **head coach of East Bengal FC and will continue to hold that position too.**

Q12. Grand Master Trilok Subba, who has been selected to represent India at the World Taekwondo Poomsae Championship, belongs to which State?

(a) Arunachal Pradesh
(b) Manipur
(c) Sikkim
(d) Meghalaya

Answer: (c)

- **Explanation:** Taekwondo player **Grand Master Trilok Subba, from Sikkim,** has been selected **to represent India at the World Taekwondo Poomsae Championship in Chuncheon, South Korea.**
- The Championship is scheduled to take place from **16th to 20th September.**

Banking / Finance

Q1. The cross-border payment facility through Favara and UPI was launched between India and:

(a) Maldives
(b) Nepal
(c) Sri Lanka
(d) Bhutan

Answer: (a)

- **Explanation:** The Maldives has launched real-time cross-border fund transfers to India through the **integration of its instant payment system, Favara, with India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI).**
- under the new facility, individuals in the **Maldives can transfer money in real time to beneficiaries in India.**

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- It added that transactions are initiated in Maldivian Rufiyaa and are credited directly in Indian Rupees to UPI-enabled bank accounts.

Q2. The Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) rate, as announced in the latest RBI monetary policy, is:

(a) 4.75%
(b) 5.00%
(c) 5.25%
(d) 5.50%

Answer: (b)

- **Explanation:** The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced its monetary policy
- The RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra-led Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) held its third bi-monthly policy meeting for FY27 from August 3 to August 5
- The policy **repo rate unchanged at 5.25% and maintain a 'neutral' stance.**
- The **Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) rate at 5%**, while keeping the **Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) rate and the bank rate unchanged at 5.5%.**









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